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5 COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM,
6 U.S. HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES,
7 WASHINGTON, D.C.
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11 INTERVIEW OF: WILLIAM H. GATES, III
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15 Wednesday, June 10, 2026
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17 Washington, D.C.
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20 The interview in the above matter was held in Room 2154, Rayburn House Office Building,
21 commencing at 10:00 a.m.

22 Present: Representatives Comer, Higgins, Timmons, Boebert, Crane, Perry, Burchett,
23 McGuire, Burlison, Garcia, Krishnamoorthi, Lynch, Subramanyam, Walkinshaw, Crockett, Ansari,
24 Randall, Khanna, Stansbury, Frost, and Bell.

1 Appearances:

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5 For the COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM:

6
7 DANIEL ASHWORTH, GENERAL COUNSEL

8 BRITTANY BRIGNAC, SENIOR COUNSEL

9 HANNAH CATHEY, PROFESSIONAL STAFF MEMBER

10 MALLORY COGAR, CHIEF CLERK AND DEPUTY DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS

11 JESSICA COLLINS, COMMUNICATIONS DIRECTOR

12 JACK EMMER, CHIEF COUNSEL FOR INVESTIGATIONS

13 RYAN GIACHETTI, CHIEF COUNSEL

14 BILLY GRANT, DEPUTY CHIEF COUNSEL FOR INVESTIGATIONS

15 AUSTIN HACKER, DEPUTY COMMUNICATIONS DIRECTOR

16 WILL HARNICE, PROFESSIONAL STAFF MEMBER

17 KYLIE HINOJOSA, PROFESSIONAL STAFF MEMBER AND ADMINISTRATIVE CLERK

18 MARK MARIN, STAFF DIRECTOR

19 MELVIN SOTO, DIGITAL DIRECTOR

20 PETER SPECTRE, DIRECTOR FOR OVERSIGHT

21 ELLISON TOLAN, COUNSEL

22 ASHLEE VINYARD, DEPUTY STAFF DIRECTOR

23 [REDACTED], MINORITY DEPUTY STAFF DIRECTOR

24 [REDACTED], MINORITY POLICY DIRECTOR

25 [REDACTED], MINORITY DEPUTY PRESS SECRETARY

- 1 [REDACTED], MINORITY STAFF DIRECTOR
- 2 [REDACTED], MINORITY COMMUNICATIONS DIRECTOR
- 3 [REDACTED], MINORITY RESEARCH ASSISTANT
- 4 [REDACTED], MINORITY RESEARCH ANALYST
- 5 [REDACTED], MINORITY INTERN
- 6 [REDACTED], MINORITY SENIOR COUNSEL
- 7 [REDACTED], MINORITY PRESS SECRETARY
- 8 [REDACTED], MINORITY SENIOR COUNSEL
- 9 [REDACTED], MINORITY FELLOW
- 10 [REDACTED], MINORITY SENIOR ADVISOR
- 11 [REDACTED], MINORITY LEGAL INTERN
- 12 [REDACTED], MINORITY CHIEF COUNSEL

13

14

15 For WILLIAM H. GATES, III:

16

17 JOHN MORAN

18 McGuireWoods

19

20 TOM CLARE

21 MEGAN MCGUIGGAN

22 Clare Locke LLP

23

24 ROB NABORS

25

1 Mr. Spectre. This is a transcribed interview of Mr. William H. Gates, III, conducted by the
2 House Committee on Oversight and Government Reform under the authority granted to it pursuant
3 to House rule X. Accordingly, House rule X grants the Committee broad jurisdiction for the
4 Committee to conduct investigations of any matter at any time.

5 This interview was requested by Chairman James Comer as part of the Committee's
6 investigation into the circumstances and subsequent investigations into the crimes of Jeffrey Epstein
7 and Ghislaine Maxwell, the operation of sex trafficking rings and the ways for the Federal
8 Government to effectively combat them, the ways in which Mr. Epstein and Ms. Maxwell sought to
9 curry favor and exercise influence to protect their illegal activities, and potential violations of ethics
10 rules related to elected officials.

11 Can the witness please state his name and spell his last name for the record?

12 Mr. Gates. William Henry Gates, III. G-a-t-e-s.

13 Mr. Spectre. Thank you, sir.

14 I want to thank Mr. Gates for appearing here voluntarily today. My name is Peter Spectre,
15 and I am the director of oversight for Chairman James Comer.

16 Under the Committee on Oversight and Government Reforms rules, you are allowed to have
17 counsel present to advise you during this interview. Do you have counsel representing you in a
18 personal capacity present with you today?

19 Mr. Gates. I do.

20 Mr. Spectre. Will counsel please identify themselves for the record?

21 Mr. Moran. John Moran, McGuireWoods.

22 Mr. Clare. Tom Clare, Clare Locke LLP.

23 Mr. Spectre. Thank you.

24 For the record, starting with the majority staff, can the additional staff members please
25 introduce themselves with their name, title, and affiliation?

1 Mr. Grant. Billy Grant, deputy chief counsel for investigations for Chairman Comer.

2 Mr. Emmer. Jack Emmer, chief counsel for investigations for Chairman Comer.

3 Mr. Ashworth. Daniel Ashworth, general counsel for Chairman Comer.

4 Mr. Giachetti. Ryan Giachetti, chief counsel for Chairman Comer.

5 Mr. Harnice. Will Harnice, professional staff member for Chairman Comer.

6 Ms. Cathey. Hannah Cathey, professional staff member for Chairman Comer.

7 Ms. Brignac. Brittany Brignac, senior counsel for Chairman Comer.

8 Ms. Tolan. Ellison Tolan, counsel for Chairman Comer.

9 Ms. Cogar. Mallory Cogar, director of operations and chief clerk, Chairman Comer.

10 Ms. Hinojosa. Kylie Hinojosa, professional staff member and administrative clerk for
11 Chairman Comer.

12 Mr. Hacker. Austin Hacker, deputy communications director, Chairman Comer.

13 Ms. Vinyard. Ashlee Vinyard, deputy staff director for Chairman Comer.

14 Mr. Soto. Melvin Soto, digital director, Chairman Comer.

15 Ms. Collins. Jessica Collins, communications director, Chairman Comer.

16 Mr. Marin. Mark Marin, staff director, Chairman Comer.

17 [REDACTED], research assistant, Ranking Member Garcia.

18 [REDACTED], senior counsel, Ranking Member Garcia.

19 [REDACTED], research analyst, Ranking Member Garcia.

20 [REDACTED], chief counsel, Ranking Member Garcia.

21 [REDACTED], staff director, Ranking Member Garcia.

22 [REDACTED], press secretary, Ranking Member Garcia.

23 [REDACTED], deputy press secretary, Ranking Member Garcia.

24 [REDACTED], clerk intern, Ranking Member Garcia.

25 [REDACTED], senior advisor for Ranking Member Garcia.

1 [REDACTED] [REDACTED], legal intern, Ranking Member Garcia.

2 [REDACTED] [REDACTED], legal intern, Ranking Member Garcia.

3 [REDACTED] [REDACTED], fellow, Ranking Member Garcia.

4 [REDACTED] [REDACTED], senior counsel, Ranking Member Garcia.

5 Mr. Spectre. Thank you.

6 Starting with the majority, can the members of the Committee please introduce themselves?

7 Chairman Comer. James Comer, chairman, House Oversight, Kentucky.

8 Mr. Higgins. Clay Higgins, Louisiana.

9 Mr. Crane. Eli Crane, Arizona.

10 Mr. Perry. Scott Perry, Pennsylvania's 10th.

11 Mr. Subramanyam. Minority Congressman Suhas Subramanyam, Virginia's 10th District.

12 Mr. Spectre. Thank you all.

13 Mr. Gates, before we begin, I would like to go over the ground rules for this interview.

14 The questioning will proceed in rounds. The majority will ask questions for up to an hour
15 and then the minority will have an opportunity to ask questions for up to an hour if they choose. To
16 the extent members have questions for the witness, they will be propounded during their side's
17 respective rounds. The clock will stop if you need to confer with counsel, when your counsel is
18 speaking, and when members or staff are speaking during the opposing side's rounds of questions.
19 We will alternate back and forth until there are no more questions. Do you understand?

20 Mr. Gates. I do.

21 Mr. Spectre. There is a court reporter taking down everything I say and everything you say
22 to make a written record of the interview. For the record to be clear, please wait until the staffer
23 questioning you finishes each question before you begin your answer, and the staffer will wait until
24 you finish your response before proceeding to the next question.

25 Further, to ensure the court reporter can properly record this interview, please speak clearly,

1 concisely, and slowly. Also, the court reporter cannot record nonverbal answers, such as nodding
2 or shaking your head, so it is important that you answer each question with an audible, verbal
3 answer.

4 Exhibits may be entered into the record. Majority exhibits will be identified numerically.
5 Minority exhibits will be identified alphabetically.

6 We want you to answer our questions in the most complete and truthful manner possible, so
7 we will take our time. If you have any questions or do not fully understand our question, please let
8 us know and we will attempt to clarify, add context to, or rephrase our questions.

9 If we ask about specific conversations or events in the past and you are unable to recall the
10 exact words or details, you should testify to the substance of those conversations or events to the
11 best of your recollection. If you recall only a part of a conversation or event, you should give us
12 your best recollection of those events or parts of conversations that you do recall. Do you
13 understand?

14 Mr. Gates. I do.

15 Mr. Spectre. Although you are here voluntarily, you are required by law pursuant to Title 18
16 of the United States Code, Section 1001, to answer questions from Congress truthfully. This also
17 applies to questions posed by congressional staff in this interview. Do you understand?

18 Mr. Gates. Yes.

19 Mr. Spectre. If at any time you knowingly make false statements, you could be subject to
20 criminal prosecution. Do you understand?

21 Mr. Gates. I do.

22 Mr. Spectre. This includes both knowingly providing false testimony but also stating that
23 you do not recall or remember something when, in fact, you do. Do you understand?

24 Mr. Gates. I do.

25 Mr. Spectre. Furthermore, you cannot tell half truths or exclude information necessary to

1 make your statements accurate. You are required to provide all information that would make your
2 response truthful. A deliberate failure to disclose information can constitute a false statement.

3 Do you understand?

4 Mr. Gates. I do.

5 Mr. Spectre. Is there any reason you are unable to provide truthful testimony in today's
6 interview?

7 Mr. Gates. There's none.

8 Mr. Spectre. Please note that if you wish to assert a privilege over any statement today,
9 that assertion must comply with the rules of the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.
10 Pursuant to that, Committee rule 16(c)(1) states, For the chair to consider assertions of privilege over
11 testimony or statements, witnesses or entities must clearly state the specific privilege being asserted
12 and the reason for the assertion on or before the scheduled date of testimony or appearance. Do
13 you understand?

14 Mr. Gates. Somewhat.

15 Mr. Spectre. Ordinarily, we take a 5-minute break at the end of each hour of questioning,
16 but if you need a longer break or a break before that, please let us know and we'll be happy to
17 accommodate. However, to the extent that there is a pending question, we would ask that you
18 finish answering the question before we take the break. Do you understand?

19 Mr. Gates. I do.

20 Mr. Spectre. Do you have any other questions before we begin?

21 Mr. Gates. I do not.

22 Mr. Spectre. I do understand you have an opening statement that you'd like to read for the
23 record. Is that right?

24 Mr. Gates. Yes.

25 Mr. Spectre. You may go ahead.

1 Mr. Gates. Mr. Chairman, Ranking Member, members of the Committee, thank you for the
2 opportunity to appear before you today. I am here to answer your questions about my interactions
3 with Jeffrey Epstein and to help contribute to the Committee's important work. I support the
4 release of all the Epstein files and sincerely hope that through your efforts and those of others
5 advocating on their behalf, the survivors of Epstein's crimes, Epstein's crimes, can get the justice that
6 they deserve.

7 At the outset, I want to state very clearly I never witnessed nor had any indication that
8 Epstein was engaged in ongoing criminal conduct. I never went to his island, his ranch, or his
9 Florida home. I have never victimized anyone. While he may have sought to foster a personal
10 relationship, I was never interested in that and never reciprocated.

11 I was introduced to Epstein in 2011 through people I trusted in my professional and
12 philanthropic work. Epstein claimed that he could raise billions of dollars for global health from
13 people for whom he provided tax and estate services. I recall being aware that Epstein had faced
14 prior legal issues, but I did not fully understand the extent of the crimes he committed. I accepted
15 the introduction without applying the scrutiny I should have.

16 For almost two decades, my full-time focus has been global health and education. I've been
17 guided by the belief that all lives have equal value and that every child should have the chance to live
18 a healthy life, no matter where they were born. I have committed all my resources and my time to
19 this effort, but my wealth alone cannot fill the enormous funding gap that remains. This is why
20 trying to encourage others of significant means to invest in global health has become such an
21 important element of my work.

22 My interactions with Epstein began with a limited number of preliminary meetings, three in
23 2011 and two in 2012, during which I talked about the goals of my work. We began more extensive
24 conversations in 2013 and 2014. The discussions focused on identifying potential giving structures
25 such as donor advice funds and how to enroll individuals he claimed were interested in making

1 significant contributions. I made it clear to Epstein from the outset that he would never play a role
2 in any of the work or receive any compensation.

3 In 2014, after Epstein brought together a group he described as potential donors, I realized
4 that our prior discussions, which should have translated into meaningful philanthropic support, were
5 a dead end. It was clear that no one in the group was interested enough to move forward. At that
6 point, I concluded Epstein would never deliver on his promises. I told him we would go no further
7 and stopped communicating or meeting with him. No vehicle for charitable giving was ever created
8 and no funds were raised. Our interactions ended in December 2014, 4 years before new reports in
9 the press and unsealed court documents shed additional light on the extent of his crimes.

10 It was during the same time period that an employee was in the process of transitioning out
11 of my private office. This employee engaged Epstein to negotiate and advise him on the terms of
12 the separation. I did not ask nor did I want or need Epstein to be involved in this matter. His
13 involvement resulted in email exchanges, calls, and meetings with members of my team and me.
14 However, the agreement we ultimately reached was not any different from what was previously
15 agreed upon months in advance of Epstein inserting himself.

16 It was after this that I learned Epstein had become aware of sensitive information about my
17 personal life, including the fact that I had been unfaithful in my marriage. These affairs had nothing
18 to do with my interactions with Epstein, but they were painful for my family. As the public can now
19 see based on what has been released in the files, Epstein was working to use information about my
20 infidelities, in addition to many lies that he layered on top, to pressure me to reengage with him.
21 He was unsuccessful in this effort, but it shows some of the ways he tried to leverage his interactions
22 with me to further his agenda.

23 I should never have met with Epstein in the first place. Based on what I know now, I
24 understand that even if he had delivered the donors he promised, it would not have justified
25 associating with him. I see now that he sought to build an image of legitimacy around himself using

1 connections to reputable and powerful people to deflect scrutiny and attempt to rehabilitate his
2 reputation. I was so focused on the possibility of raising funds for global health that I allowed that
3 goal to override my better judgment. That is a sobering realization and it has reinforced for me the
4 importance of being more attentive to how access and reputation can be manipulated by people
5 acting in bad faith.

6 In the work I do, reputation is the basis for developing partnerships that save lives. Meeting
7 with Epstein was a grave error in judgment and put this work at risk. His behavior was antithetical
8 to all my efforts to contribute to a world where everyone has a chance to live a healthy and
9 productive life. If the time I spent with Epstein lent him credibility, I am deeply sorry. I've learned
10 a significant lesson and am now far more careful about who I engage with, even in a limited capacity.

11 I look forward to answering all your questions about my interactions with Epstein and the
12 topics identified in the Chairman's invitation to appear today. The Committee's work is essential.
13 It is my sincere hope that those harmed by Epstein's crimes will receive the justice they deserve.

14 Thank you.

15 Mr. Spectre. Thank you, Mr. Gates.

16 We've had a couple of extra members join. Starting with the majority, can you please
17 introduce yourself for the record?

18 Ms. Boebert. Lauren Boebert.

19 Mr. Burlison. Eric Burlison.

20 Mr. Lynch. Congressman Steve Lynch, Eighth Congressional District of Massachusetts.

21 Mr. Spectre. Thank you.

22 The time reads 10:15, and the majority's time will begin now.

23 EXAMINATION

24 BY MR. SPECTRE:

25 Q Mr. Gates, I want to thank you again for coming here voluntarily to answer our

1 questions today. I want to start by very, very briefly discussing your background. I know, of
2 course, you've had a very long and very, very successful career, but can you provide the Committee
3 with a very brief summary of your career up until now?

4 A Yeah. I was born in 1955. I went to high school in Seattle, graduated. I attended
5 Harvard College for a few years, but did not complete a degree. I founded Microsoft in 1975. I
6 stayed as CEO of Microsoft through the year 2000. I stayed as chief technical adviser through 2008.
7 So 2008 ended my full-time work at Microsoft.

8 Overlapping that, I created the Gates Foundation in the year 2000, so I gave a substantial gift
9 of Microsoft stock in the year 2000. And so between 2000 and 2008, I was full-time Microsoft,
10 part-time Gates Foundation. 2008, I ceased my full-time work at Microsoft and began full time as
11 chairman of the Gates Foundation. And since 2008 that's been my primary effort. I still give some
12 advice to Microsoft. I have some energy innovation work under the term Breakthrough Energy, but
13 my full-time work is the work of the Gates Foundation, which involves areas like education, global
14 health, agriculture, financial services, and so that's my primary work today. I turned 70 last year.

15 Q Thank you. And to be clear, do you hold any official positions at any of your other -- do
16 you currently hold any positions at any of your other ventures besides the Gates Foundation?

17 A Yeah. I have some title with Breakthrough Energy. I'm not sure what that is. I have
18 an entity called Gates Ventures that is my private office, and I have a group that manages
19 investments on my behalf and the foundation trust's behalf called Cascade. So I think that that's all
20 of my official roles.

21 Q Thank you. And we'll get more, of course, into your interactions with Mr. Epstein a
22 little bit later. But just to be clear for the record, your opening statement indicated that your
23 relationship with him, your interactions with him occurred between 2011 and 2014 -- late 2014. Is
24 that right?

25 A That's right.

1 Q So for the entirety of that time, you were -- your primary role was at the Gates
2 Foundation. Is that right?

3 A Yeah. I mean, I was doing the whole mix of things I do, but, yes, at all times since 2008
4 that's been my primary role.

5 Q And you were not -- you didn't have a formal job at Microsoft during the time you knew
6 Mr. Epstein. Is that right?

7 A No.

8 Q And at this point philanthropy is your full-time endeavor. Is that right?

9 A That's right. For some of the energy innovation work, I use private investment vehicles
10 and even the foundation itself often uses investments as part of its overall strategy, but the
11 work -- the aim of the work is philanthropic.

12 Q Thank you. And, again, we'll get deeper into this a little bit later, but I just want to do a
13 high level --

14 Mr. Lynch. We can hear the question -- we can hear the answer. We can't hear the
15 questions at all. Thank you.

16 Mr. Emmer. We've had another member join. Can they please announce themselves for
17 the record?

18 Mr. Timmons. William Timmons, South Carolina Fourth Congressional District.

19 BY MR. SPECTRE:

20 Q Mr. Gates, when did you first meet Jeffrey Epstein?

21 A It was in January 2011 that I had a dinner with him.

22 Q And was that at Mr. Epstein's home?

23 A His home in New York, yes.

24 Q Can you describe the circumstances that led you to attending that dinner?

25 A Dr. Nikolic, who worked for me, said that since I was out in New York I might be

1 interested in having a dinner with him, and so that got scheduled.

2 Q He said you might be interested in it. Did he say why you might be interested in it?

3 A He probably gave me a brief description that -- about Epstein.

4 Q Do you recall what that description entailed?

5 A No, I do not.

6 Q What did you discuss in your first interaction with Mr. Epstein?

7 A You know, it was a dinner that I would have talked about what I was doing. He would
8 have mentioned a number of scientists and people that he spent time talking to. You know, it was
9 kind of an introductory dinner that I don't remember all the specifics.

10 Q So he was sort of giving you an outline of the powerful people he knew? Is that what
11 you mean by that?

12 A More intellectual, you know, professors or science people, as well as some business
13 leaders. I don't know if it was that night or some other time, but he did talk about that he provided
14 advice to lots of billionaires.

15 Q Do you recall any specific names that he mentioned to you?

16 A Not at that time. You know, he talked about Wall Street billionaires, he talked about
17 Middle East billionaires. He made it sound very extensive.

18 Q Did you get the sense that he was offering you some kind of service?

19 A No.

20 Q Why do you think he was telling you about these people he worked with?

21 A Maybe for me to have a good impression of him. You know, at some point, I don't
22 think that first night, the idea that some of those people might give money to global health came up.

23 Q I know you said you don't recall exactly the description that Dr. Nikolic gave you about
24 Mr. Epstein, but do you recall what, if anything, you knew about Mr. Epstein in general before you
25 met him for the first time?

1 A I was aware that he had a criminal conviction.

2 Q How were you aware of that?

3 A I'm not sure. Either I looked it up or somebody told me.

4 Q Did Dr. Nikolic tell you that?

5 A I'm not sure.

6 Q Do you recall knowing at that time what the criminal conviction was for?

7 A I knew that it was of a sexual nature, but, no, I don't think I knew -- dug into the
8 specifics, although I probably should have.

9 Q Would you normally look into people's backgrounds before you met with them? Was
10 this an uncommon way of handling it?

11 A I don't have a formal process for people I meet.

12 Q Did you ask Mr. Epstein about this conviction at that time?

13 A I did not bring it up during that dinner.

14 Q And he didn't bring it up either?

15 A No.

16 Q Did anyone ever raise concerns to you about Mr. Epstein with regard to that conviction
17 or anything else in 2011?

18 A Well, throughout the time I spent with Epstein, the concern about his reputation was
19 voiced by me and by other people, so there was an awareness that he had a bad reputation
20 stemming from his criminal conviction.

21 Q And are you saying you were aware of these concerns early on or are you describing
22 conversations that occurred later in your relationship with Mr. Epstein?

23 A I'd say both.

24 Q So you were aware he had a bad reputation and he had some sort of sex-related
25 conviction at the time you first entered into contact with him?

1 A That's right.

2 Q What were your first impressions of Mr. Epstein?

3 A Well, he talked about a lot of scientists that he would talk to or business leaders he
4 would talk to, and he made that sound fairly extensive, you know, across a wide range of topics. So
5 he seemed like he was a bit of a dilettante.

6 Q What do you mean by that?

7 A Somebody who focuses time on a large number of subject areas and new people who
8 are deeply engaged in those areas.

9 Q So he made a good impression?

10 A You know, he's kind of a unique person even, you know, based on the limited
11 knowledge I have -- had at the time. It was kind of a unique thing to have this large house in
12 Manhattan and to mention quite a wide range of people from both business and academic areas. I
13 would say, you know, I thought he was unusual.

14 Q Who else was with you at this first dinner you had with Mr. Epstein in 2011?

15 A For the dinner itself, just Dr. Nikolic.

16 Q Were other people traveling with you for that? Is that what you meant?

17 A No.

18 Q So at the dinner, you were with Dr. Nikolic, Mr. Epstein, and nobody else was at the
19 dinner?

20 A That's right.

21 Q What did you understand his job or career to be when you met him?

22 A I'm not sure if it was that night, but over time, he suggested that he provided tax advice
23 and advice on wills to a wide variety of people, both from Wall Street, from the Middle East, you
24 know, that he was in a position of trust with a number of wealthy people.

25 Q And you said you didn't get the sense he was offering you any kind of service, so he

1 wasn't offering you tax or estate services of any kind?

2 A No. There came a time later where he brought up that, you know, he could help on
3 taxes, and I rather sternly rebuffed that effort.

4 Q Sure. And we can get more into that a little bit later. So at this point, meeting him
5 for the first time in 2011, did you understand him to already be wealthy at that point?

6 A Well, certainly the -- you know, the -- just the house alone represented a significant
7 amount of wealth. I'd never seen -- I don't think to this day I've seen a private house in Manhattan
8 that's quite that spacious.

9 Q Did you have any idea at that time how he had acquired his money?

10 A No. To this day, I find that a bit confusing.

11 Q And, again, we'll get a little bit deeper into your interactions with Mr. Epstein later, but
12 just for now, could you briefly characterize the nature of the relationship that you had with Mr.
13 Epstein between 2011 and 2014? Was he a friend? Was he a business associate?

14 A No, he certainly wasn't a friend. You know, he made an effort to extend the
15 relationship with various invitations, but, you know, he -- eventually, you know, as I talked about my
16 work in global health for the Gates Foundation, he suggested that he could raise substantial amounts
17 of money from people that he knew to help with that endeavor, and that became the primary focus
18 out in 2013. 2011, we just had, you know, two dinners, one where it was with Jes Staley and Larry
19 Summers, one where he was just dropping by. So, you know, three encounters in 2011.

20 Then over a year passes and I see him twice in late 2012. And then it's in I think spring 2013
21 where this purported availability of people who when they would sit and talk about their wills, their
22 taxes, that as part of that process they would realize they had a significant amount of excess money
23 and hopefully they would want to give that philanthropically and hopefully they would consider
24 giving that to global health. And so he -- that became the focus in spring of 2013.

25 Q So you said he would give invitations for things. Were these social functions or

1 philanthropic or otherwise?

2 A No, they weren't social. I mean, there was one time at the end of a dinner, David
3 Blaine came, and so that was a lighter thing. He's a magician. But the meetings were always
4 about the world and, you know, what was going on. Obviously, when somebody like Larry Summers
5 or Jes Staley is there, they're talking about what they see in the world, what they expect, so it's a
6 wide ranging discussion.

7 Q So did you ever socialize with Jeffrey Epstein?

8 A Not -- no, I would not say I was socializing with him. I was at a dinner where a wide
9 range of serious topics came up. When he, for example, invited me to come to his island, that
10 would have been socializing, and that -- I didn't do that. You know, one time in Paris he asked me
11 to go to a show and I said that would not be a good idea. I chose not to do that.

12 Q So he did invite you to a couple of social functions and you just rejected them?

13 A He did many things to try and deepen the relationship, including the various invitations.

14 Q Did you ever discuss sexual behavior of any kind with Jeffrey Epstein?

15 A No.

16 Q Did you ever witness Jeffrey Epstein engaging in sexual contact of any kind?

17 A No.

18 Q Did you ever witness Epstein receive a massage from a young woman or a girl?

19 A No.

20 Q Were there often young women or girls at the places where you would meet with
21 Epstein?

22 A No. The only time anyone who was I'd call a girl was around was, after that first
23 dinner, Eva Dubin came and she had her daughter with her. Other than that, there were no young
24 women at any of the times I saw Epstein.

25 Q So none of his -- a number of Epstein's employees, we understand, were younger

1 women. Did you ever meet any of those people?

2 A I was not introduced to them, but, you know, like, when you go to the New York thing, I
3 think they open the door. Jeffrey -- Mr. Epstein had what appeared to be administrative assistants
4 with him, and the extent of my contact with them was that, you know, they were there. As I would
5 go into a meeting, they never attended any meeting that I was in. There were several occasions
6 where Mr. Epstein asked me to be photographed with them at the end of the meeting. I was not
7 introduced to them as part of that. That was quite brief. One of the admins stayed when David
8 Blaine did one of his tricks, so she was standing around then. And there was also a time when I
9 took a flight from Newark to Palm Beach and Jeffrey had two admin assistants with him who sat in
10 the front cabin, but so I saw them as I walked on to the plane and as I walked off of the plane.

11 And so other than the admins who were around, you know, who appeared to be women, I
12 believe they did not look to be underage. I think I fully described any contact with the women
13 around Epstein.

14 Q Thank you. Did you ever engage in sexual contact of any kind in the presence of
15 Jeffrey Epstein?

16 A No.

17 Q Did you ever engage in sexual contact with a person introduced to you by or affiliated
18 with Jeffrey Epstein?

19 A No.

20 Q Did Jeffrey Epstein or any of his associates ever offer you a young woman or girl for the
21 purposes of sex?

22 A No.

23 Q Did you ever receive a massage that was arranged by Jeffrey Epstein or any of his staff
24 or associates?

25 A No.

1 Q We already discussed that you are aware that he had been convicted of a sex crime, but
2 to be clear, at that time were you aware that he was a registered sex offender?

3 A I was not.

4 Q Do you recall when you first learned that he was a registered sex offender?

5 A You know, my -- it's really 2018 when a Miami newspaper described the sort of
6 extensive and horrific details of what he had done before his 2008, 2009 conviction that I became
7 aware of the extent of his crimes, and I believe that's when I first knew that he'd actually registered
8 as a sex offender.

9 Q And so you ended your relationship with Mr. Epstein in late 2014, as you've mentioned
10 today, and you just said you learned that he was a sex offender and more of the extent of his crimes
11 in 2018. To be clear, did you have any interactions with Mr. Epstein after 2014?

12 A I did not.

13 Q Did you have any communications with Mr. Epstein directly or through an intermediary
14 during that time?

15 A Yeah. Right after 2014, there was an email he sent to me -- after 2014, I read -- he sent
16 me quite a bit of emails. The majority of emails he sent to me, actually, were after I'd cut off all
17 contact. Most of those I did not read, but in the early period, there were some that I did read.
18 One of those sought reimbursement for what he purported was expenses that he paid with a woman
19 who he became aware of was a woman who I'd had an affair with. And I communicated to my key
20 person, top person at Gates Ventures, Larry Cohen, that we were never going to pay anything. And
21 so in that sense, I did have indirect communication with him, and I think that was in the months after
22 I cut off direct contact.

23 Q Okay. We'll get into that a little bit more later, but just a few questions about that.
24 So this person that you had had the affair with, is that Mila Antonova?

25 A Yes.

1 Q And so you said you directed your staff to not reimburse Mr. Epstein for the payments
2 he was requesting. They were, you said, reimbursements for expenses he was covering for Ms.
3 Antonova. Is that right?

4 A That's what he represented.

5 Q Why would he want you to reimburse him for that?

6 A You know, I viewed it as a tactic to reengage with me. I'd never asked him to do
7 anything with respect to the person we're discussing, so I was rather surprised. That was the first
8 time I knew explicitly that he'd become aware of that affair.

9 Q So you did not know until -- I'm sorry, so this was in 2014 that we're discussing now?

10 A Yeah. Late 2014, maybe into early 2015 where he's seeking reimbursement.

11 Q So you did not know until late 2014 or early 2015 that Jeffrey Epstein was aware of any
12 of your affairs or just this affair?

13 A In the termination or exit discussion relative to Dr. Nikolic, which is as early as I think
14 spring 2013, Mr. Epstein made some veiled references that made me wonder whether he had
15 become aware, which, you know, the only way I can imagine that would have happened was through
16 Dr. Nikolic, of either one or two affairs that I'd had that Dr. Nikolic was aware of. But until the
17 specific reimbursement requests, it was a veiled type of thing where he would say, you know, we
18 should all want to remain friends.

19 Q Do you know what exactly the expenses he had paid for for Ms. Antonova were?

20 A I have no idea. You know, he -- he wasn't an honest person, so understanding did he
21 pay those expenses or not, I have no knowledge.

22 Q And we'll talk a little bit more about that a little bit later, so we can go ahead and move
23 along.

24 Mr. Emmer. We've had another member join. Can you please announce himself for the
25 record?

1 Mr. Walkinshaw. James Walkinshaw, 11th District of Virginia.

2 Mr. Spectre. Thank you, Mr. Gates. And, again, we'll come back to some of those topics.
3 And my apologies, we're probably going to bounce around a little bit. We're going to try to have
4 some sort of -- some semblance of chronology here.

5 Mr. Emmer. We've had another member join. Can he please announce himself for the
6 record?

7 Mr. Burlison. Congressman Eric Burlison, Missouri.

8 BY MR. SPECTRE:

9 Q So we've already begun talking about Dr. Nikolic, but for the record, who is Dr. Nikolic?

10 A Dr. Nikolic, he is a person who worked at the Gates Foundation on the diagnostic
11 strategy for a period, then he left the Gates Foundation and came to work in my private office, which
12 was one time called bgC3. It's been renamed to Gates Ventures. It's the same private office. So
13 he worked there as -- I think his title was science adviser, from something like 2010 until
14 through -- when was his last day? End of 2013? Yeah, until the end of 2013.

15 Q And just very briefly because we're going to be discussing his employment dispute, but
16 why did he leave his employment at the end of 2013? Just briefly. Did you fire him? Did he
17 resign? What exactly occurred?

18 A Dr. Nikolic, when he worked for me, had decided that he wanted to become a venture
19 capitalist, and so he had said, hey, you know, working for you, I can just make a salary, I understand
20 about biotech companies, which ones are going to be successful. I think both in terms of impact
21 and making money, that's where I should go.

22 And so more than a year before he left, we talked about that. I said, you know, why don't
23 you stay another year, you can make some -- up to three investments during the time you're with
24 me, you know, sort of a practice venture capital-type investment, and we'll share the profit of those
25 investments.

1 So Dr. Nikolic, you know, had decided that he was moving on and going to venture capital.
2 His actual exit was somewhat accelerated by the fact that I shared with my wife at the time that he
3 was aware of affairs that I had, and she and I discussed that I should probably have him leave sooner
4 rather than later. So that was a factor in terms of the timing of his exit.

5 Q So, in summary, he was already -- kind of had, you know, one foot out the door to some
6 degree, but it was accelerated by this disclosure of your affairs to your then wife Melinda French
7 Gates. Is that right?

8 A That's right. I mean, I don't know what would have happened if I hadn't given him the
9 opportunity to make the investments, and he was sort of saying that he wanted to go and do that,
10 and so I think I extended the amount of time he stayed with me by letting him make up to three
11 investments.

12 Q Would you say that Dr. Nikolic was one of your closest advisers?

13 A I have a lot of advisers, but he, as my science adviser at Gates Ventures, he was a
14 valuable adviser to me.

15 Q Did you see him as purely a professional? Was it purely a professional relationship or
16 was he a friend to you as well?

17 A That was a professional relationship. I mean, where you draw the line there, I was
18 friendly with Dr. Nikolic, but I did not socialize with him. He didn't come to my house, I didn't go to
19 his house.

20 Q When was the last time you communicated with Dr. Nikolic?

21 A Many years ago.

22 Q Can you give me an estimate? Was it in 2014 when he left employment or was it after
23 that?

24 A There was a MIT advisory committee for some of the work the foundation was doing
25 with MIT, and he stayed on that committee for, I think, a year after he left, and that was probably the

1 last direct communication I had with him was in those couple of years where he stayed on the
2 advisory committee, and no communication since then.

3 Q We've already discussed Mr. Nikolic -- Dr. Nikolic, of course, introduced you to Mr.
4 Epstein. So, in your words, can you characterize Dr. Nikolic's relationship with Mr. Epstein or at
5 least your understanding of their relationship?

6 A Well, during the time I knew Epstein, I thought it was a -- just he had met him before I
7 had and that he was kind of organizing the visits that took place. In looking at the email documents
8 that came out in January, to my surprise, I now see that he had quite an extensive relationship with
9 Mr. Epstein. So I was not aware of that at all during the time that I met with Epstein 2011 to 2014.

10 Q Are you aware that Dr. Nikolic was ultimately named in one of -- in Mr. Epstein's final
11 will and testament?

12 A I've seen that in the press.

13 Q So you learned about that much later in the press?

14 A I hope it's an accurate thing. It was a press report that mentioned that.

15 Q But you have no firsthand knowledge of that?

16 A None.

17 Q Did that surprise you when you read it?

18 A A lot.

19 [Gates Majority Exhibit No. 1

20 was marked for identification.]

21 BY MR. SPECTRE:

22 Q I'd like to enter into the record majority exhibit 1, which is an email that Epstein sent to
23 Dr. Nikolic on June 16th, 2013. The bates number on this document is EFTA00873874. And just
24 for the record, all of the Bates numbers that begin with EFTA are documents that the Department of
25 Justice released pursuant to the Epstein Files Transparency Act.

1 I will give you a second to look at it, but I will note that I'll be reading much of or all of it into
2 the record, so you don't need to read the entire thing. The first question is, have you seen these
3 emails before?

4 A Yeah, okay. I mean, I may have seen these when they came in out January, but not
5 before that.

6 Q So you don't recall ever seeing these emails prior to the Epstein Files Transparency Act
7 released by the DOJ?

8 A I did not.

9 Q In the first email, so the email at the bottom of the page, that is an email from Mr.
10 Epstein. Context clues from the rest of the document indicate that that was sent to Boris Nikolic
11 but, of course, that is redacted on the document. He sent it to Boris on Sunday, June 16th, at 12:02.
12 It reads, "to me," and then it looks like a draft of a statement or an email that says, "Bill, I am in tears
13 as I write this. I have barely slept for 3 days. I am devastated beyond words. I find myself losing
14 my best friend and my career all in one day by no fault of my own. As your friend, I suggest you
15 carefully reconsider your alternatives. If Melinda decides to file for divorce, I will, of course, stand
16 by you and help any way I can. I want to see you happy, truly. Difficult choices no matter what.
17 As you know, I'm going in for a delicate surgery on my eyes on Tuesday. This timing could not be
18 worse. I will be totally out of it for a few days. I hope you are able to convince Melinda to allow
19 me to continue doing my job, a job you described as I could not have done better. I hope to ask her
20 face-to-face to change her mind. I have done nothing wrong."

21 And the email continues, but just for the record there, in 2013 when this email was sent, were
22 you and your then wife Melinda considering a divorce?

23 A No.

24 Q Why would Mr. Epstein or Dr. Nikolic be under the impression that you were?

25 A Well, I never would have discussed anything relating to that subject with Mr. Epstein. I

1 told Boris -- Dr. Nikolic, sorry -- that I'd shared the information about the two affairs, and he may
2 have thought, you know, that meant our marriage was at risk. It was certainly a deeply troubling
3 thing for my wife, but the -- at this time there was not a -- any discussion of divorce.

4 Q It seems in this draft that's written from Dr. Nikolic's perspective that he may have
5 believed that Melinda was the one who wanted him to leave his job, and I think you characterized it
6 earlier as kind of a back-and-forth discussion with your then wife. Was it Melinda's discussion to
7 ask Dr. Nikolic to accelerate his departure or was it a mutual decision between the two of you?

8 A It was a mutual decision. I agreed with Melinda that having him leave pretty soon was
9 the best thing, and so that's what I did. And that was a quicker departure than would have
10 happened otherwise.

11 Q I'll continue reading the draft email. It continues, "However, I recognize the fact that it
12 might not be possible at this time. I also realize I will need a lawyer to review any agreement we
13 might enter into, but I don't trust any with so much sensitive info. I have asked Jeffrey to oversee
14 and negotiate for me and have given him power of attorney to act on my behalf. He also needed to
15 be my health proxy during my operation. I have informed him of all the details surrounding our
16 dilemma. I trust him 100 percent. My communication with him is privileged. No worry. He
17 has agreed to act as my financial and legal representative. You can trust him. He has dealt with
18 very similar problems in the past. Obviously, he hasn't given me the details. I would greatly
19 appreciate you and he talking directly. He does not know Larry and cannot be open with him. He
20 doesn't like or trust PR people. This is a terrible circumstance in which we find ourselves, but I am
21 confident of our friendship and I know you know how devoted I am to you."

22 And I will say, I asked you if you've seen these emails before the release, but I'll be more
23 specific. Have you seen any email or other type of message that is similar to that draft I just read to
24 you? Did you receive something like that in 2013?

25 A Never. Never anything even close.

1 Q So Dr. Nikolic and Mr. Epstein are communicating about something that they might send
2 to you, and it sounds like they didn't. Is that right?

3 A I never received anything like that.

4 Q In the second email, so the middle email that Dr. Nikolic writes back to Mr. Epstein at
5 12:12 on June 16th, 2013, Dr. Nikolic seems to say, "this is great. My only worry is whether I should
6 send him now or tell him when I see him on Monday. He is still trying to make it work with
7 Melinda. He's having next round of negotiation with her next weekend. If all fails, then it is a
8 negotiation for a next steps. If I send it right now, it reads that I accepted, it is all over. Finally, I
9 can't put something such as divorce in an email. If she reads, she will go extra steps to be as nasty
10 as possible. Also, I think that my chances of convincing him to talk to you are higher if I do it in
11 person and not over the email. So how about hold this -- so how about you hold this for 8 days?
12 Thank you, B."

13 So sounds like Mr. Nikolic agrees with the perspective denoted in Mr. Epstein's draft and that
14 he would be more interested, though, in having the conversation with you face-to-face. Did he
15 have any sort of conversation with you face-to-face during this time like this?

16 A But I've never seen this email so, I mean, you can ask me questions, but I add no value.

17 Q So I guess I'll be more specific. The -- I understand you've testified you've not seen the
18 email. Did Dr. Nikolic approach you and communicate these same feelings in person, so not over
19 email?

20 A No.

21 Q In the draft email -- again, understanding that you have not seen it until much later -- Dr.
22 Nikolic is implying that he has entrusted Jeffrey Epstein with sensitive information seemingly with
23 relation to you and that he has given Epstein power of attorney to act on his behalf, that he will be
24 his financial and legal representative. So were you aware that Jeffrey Epstein was going to be
25 acting as a legal or financial representative for Dr. Nikolic?

1 A Well, he wasn't a lawyer, so I'm not sure how a nonlawyer becomes someone's legal
2 representative. Eventually, Dr. Nikolic did communicate to me that he was involving Epstein in the
3 discussion of the -- of Dr. Nikolic's exit, and he -- I forget exactly, but he sent -- he told me that he
4 was involving Epstein.

5 Q Again, you didn't receive this email, but it seems what they're trying to get across to you
6 is that, while you're correct that Jeffrey Epstein was not, in fact, a lawyer, they are representing him
7 to have some sort of privileged communication with Dr. Nikolic seemingly in a way to make it seem
8 like the sensitive information that -- the sensitive information that Mr. Epstein knows about is
9 privileged. Did you ever have a conversation like that with Dr. Nikolic?

10 A No. How could it be privileged?

11 Q I am just as confused as you are, but I guess what I'm asking is, did they represent to you
12 that it could be privileged?

13 A I told you that in terms of awareness of the affairs that I had, there was no explicit
14 reference to that, but there was some what you would call veiled reference to it in the form of, hey,
15 we should all want to be friends. It's only later when Epstein is talking about his reimbursements to
16 a specific woman that I was aware that -- I became fully aware of that. There was a point in the
17 discussions with Boris where I, you know, I said I'm not going to be influenced by what you might or
18 might not know or say. But, again, this email is complete news to me.

19 Q Okay. The top of the email, I won't read this entire one, but it -- it seems to imply that
20 you had already given Dr. Nikolic some kind of offer, probably related to his departure. Had you
21 already given Dr. Nikolic some kind of exit package or offer in June of 2013?

22 A Yeah. There was a prior agreement about -- he ended up making two investments on
23 our mutual behalf. You know, I'd authorized him to make three, but he made two. So there was,
24 you know, putting into writing how we would handle his payment for his share of those, and then
25 just the termination agreement. So that was all known before he engaged Epstein in the exit

1 discussions.

2 [Gates Majority Exhibit No. 2
3 was marked for identification.]

4 BY MR. SPECTRE:

5 Q Okay. Thank you. I will now enter into the record majority exhibit 2, which is an
6 email from Mr. Epstein to himself on July 18th, 2013. This is marked as Bates number
7 EFTA01966988. And I'll note for the record that there are a few similar versions of these emails
8 throughout the files, I think, with things being forwarded along. I'll be referencing this version and
9 asking you questions about it. Some of the other ones are just cut off, so --

10 A I don't know what you mean "forwarded along."

11 Q The -- within the Epstein files, there are duplicates for various reasons, and I'm just
12 referencing that I'm using this particular EFTA number for the record.

13 A Okay.

14 Mr. Emmer. And while you're reviewing, we've had more members and staff join. Can
15 they please identify themselves for the record?

16 Mr. Garcia. Robert Garcia, Ranking Member.

17 [REDACTED], Representative Garcia.

18 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Congressman Raja Krishnamoorthi from Illinois.

19 BY MR. SPECTRE:

20 Q Mr. Gates, have you seen this email before?

21 A No. I mean, I would have seen it when it was released in January as part of the Epstein
22 files, but prior to that, no.

23 Q So this appears to be a draft email or statement that Epstein may have written -- he at
24 least sent it to himself -- from the perspective of Dr. Nikolic. Is that fair?

25 A I add no value to that.

1 Q Well, can we agree that this is not the perspective of Jeffrey Epstein? It's clearly
2 written from the perspective of somebody else. Is that fair?

3 A You're asking me to speculate on this?

4 Q So I will read it into the record then. It is, again, sent Thursday, July 18th, 2013, at
5 12:39, from Jeffrey Epstein to himself. However, the email reads, quote, "I have decided to resign
6 my position effective immediately with BG3 and the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation. I have not
7 come to this decision quickly or without a great deal of thought. During the past few weeks, I have
8 been caught up in a severe marital dispute between Melinda and Bill."

9 I will stop reading there for a second. But given majority exhibit 1 which we were just
10 discussing and the fact that Mr. Epstein and Dr. Nikolic were clearly discussing a marital dispute of
11 some kind between you and Melinda, is it fair to say that this is a email that was intended to have
12 been sent by Dr. Nikolic?

13 A I don't know. It was never sent by Dr. Nikolic. That's all I bring to this.

14 Q Sure. I can continue reading. "I have the greatest respect for my friend of 7 years,
15 and I wish them both well. In my role as his right hand, I have been asked on multiple occasions
16 and, in hindsight, wrongly acquiesced into participating in things that have ranged from the morally
17 inappropriate to the ethically unsound and had been repeatedly asked to do other things that get
18 near and potentially over the line into the illegal. Though it was kindly suggested that I make a
19 transition to a new position after my 6 years of service and that Bill would, in his words, give me a
20 generous package, I feel it would be dishonest to myself and my future from helping Bill to get drugs
21 in order to deal with consequences of sex with Russian girls, to facilitating his illicit trysts with
22 married women, to being asked to provide Adderall for bridge tournaments. I feel I owe it to my
23 friends and future colleagues to admit a moral failure, to ask forgiveness, and to move on with my
24 life."

1 [11:00 a.m.]

2 BY MR. SPECTRE:

3 Q So again, I understand you did not receive this email, so I'll just begin to discuss the facts
4 in the email. I've already asked you this, I asked you if you had been considering a divorce with
5 Melinda in 2013. I'll ask it a different way, were you having a marital dispute of some kind with
6 your then wife Melinda French Gates.

7 A Well, certainly the fact that I told Melinda during this time frame about the two affairs,
8 that was very distressing to her, but at that time there was no explicit mention of getting divorced.
9 It may have occurred to Melinda at that point, but it was not a subject of discussion.

10 Q But you were having a marital dispute at the time. Is that fair?

11 A I wouldn't call it a marital dispute. You could say it was a marital crisis because she
12 became aware of bad behavior on my part.

13 Q Sure. Was this dispute that is referenced in this email -- or how about this --

14 A I have no idea.

15 Q Sure. The discussions you had with Melinda at that time about your infidelity, were
16 those ultimately relevant to your divorce in 2021?

17 A You would have to ask her, but I imagine that they were, yes.

18 Q How did Dr. Nikolic know of your marital -- of your dispute with Melinda?

19 A I never discussed that topic with him. I did tell him that I -- she was aware of the
20 affairs, and that I shared with her that he was also aware of the affairs.

21 Q When did you tell Melinda about the affairs?

22 A That would have been in the spring of 2013.

23 Q And when did you tell Dr. Nikolic that you had told Melinda about the affairs?

24 A Around the same time.

25 Q Shortly thereafter?

1 A Right. And, you know, that was part of my telling him that his employment was not
2 going to continue.

3 Q So is it possible, then, that Dr. Nikolic, while you didn't tell him that you were -- you
4 didn't say you were considering a divorce, as you said, you weren't, but is it possible that Dr. Nikolic
5 read into what you were telling him to believe that Melinda was the reason he was being let go and
6 that he needed to fix things with you. Is that fair?

7 A Well, it's not clear to me that Dr. Nikolic ever saw these emails. But, you know, Dr.
8 Nikolic may have inferred from the fact that I said that I, you know, discussed the affairs, he may
9 have speculated about what that was doing in terms of my marriage.

10 Q Do you have any other suggestion of how Jeffrey Epstein would know about your affairs,
11 or the other details in this email, except for through Dr. Nikolic?

12 A I believe he found out about the two affairs through Dr. Nikolic.

13 Mr. Moran. And just to be clear, you asked about the other details.

14 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I'm not commenting on that.

15 BY MR. SPECTRE:

16 Q Sure.

17 A I believe that he found out about the affairs through Dr. Nikolic.

18 Q Did you ever ask Dr. Nikolic to do anything morally inappropriate or unethically
19 unsound?

20 A Well, he was involved -- he knew that I had spent time with the women I had affairs
21 with, so only in that sense.

22 Q How did he know that?

23 A You know, one time it was a scheduling thing, when we were in London where I -- I said
24 to him I was going to disappear and wanted him to show that I was meeting with him at that time.

25 Q So you used him as an alibi to meet with a woman. Is that fair?

1 A That's correct.

2 Q Did he know the name of the woman at the time?

3 A At some point I mentioned the name, yes.

4 Q Did you ever ask Dr. Nikolic to do anything that was potentially illegal?

5 A No.

6 Q Did Dr. Nikolic ever assist you in acquiring drugs?

7 A No.

8 Q Did you ever ask him to acquire you drugs?

9 A No.

10 Q Was Dr. Nikolic a medical doctor?

11 A I think he was a research doctor.

12 Q Did he have prescribing authority, do you know?

13 A I don't understand that.

14 Q To be clear, you don't understand the question, or you don't understand prescribing
15 authority?

16 A I'm not sure whether he had prescribing authority. It never came up.

17 Q So do you have any guesses as to why Dr. Nikolic or Jeffrey Epstein believed that you
18 had asked Dr. Nikolic to acquire drugs for you?

19 A I don't have any awareness that Dr. Nikolic ever saw this email. Is that -- are you
20 suggesting he did?

21 Q I'm asking you if you have any context you can share of why either Epstein or Nikolic
22 believed that.

23 A I don't.

24 Q You've already acknowledged that you engaged in infidelity. We have discussed one of
25 the two, one of the two women that you've acknowledged. Who is the second woman?

1 A Her name is Karima Nigmatulina.

2 Mr. Moran. And I'll just say as we go forward, you know, as you've seen, Mr. Gates is here
3 addressing obviously very sensitive topics with the committee as they relate to Jeffrey Epstein. We
4 know there's also a lot of public interest in the details of these private affairs that aren't pertinent to
5 Jeffrey Epstein who had no involvement in those other than learning about them after the fact.
6 And so, Mr. Gates will probably seek to decline to divulge details that are not related to Jeffrey
7 Epstein, as is his right. But as you've seen, so far he's here to answer the committee's questions,
8 and we appreciate that the committee has handled this sensitively.

9 Mr. Spectre. Thank you.

10 BY MR. SPECTRE:

11 Q Were both of these women Russian?

12 A Yes.

13 Q Again, the draft email, which I understand you have not seen, refers to sex with Russian
14 girls. Just for the record, how old were these two women during the time of your affairs, roughly?

15 A One was in her 20s. One was in her 30s.

16 Q So they were both adults?

17 A Yes.

18 Mr. Emmer. We have had another member join, can he please announce himself for the
19 record?

20 Mr. Burchett. Tim Burchett, Tennessee's 2nd District.

21 BY MR. SPECTRE:

22 Q Did you also engage in, again, the email refers to, quote, illicit trysts with married
23 women, did you have any other affairs besides these two women that we've just discussed?

24 A The only affairs that Dr. Nikolic were aware of were the two that we've discussed.

25 Q But there were other extramarital affairs?

1 A None with any connection to Epstein that he became aware of, or that had any
2 connection to him.

3 Q How do you know that?

4 A I guess I'll never know that because he's dead.

5 Q So that's the reason I'm asking about these other ones is you've already testified today
6 that you didn't know that these two women did have any affiliation with Jeffrey Epstein, and many of
7 these details we've only since learned from the Department of Justice's release.

8 So I do think additional context about any other extra marital affairs, especially during the
9 time period you knew Jeffrey Epstein, are relevant to the committee's inquiry?

10 Mr. Moran. With respect, I'm able to say Mr. Gates is in the best position to help the
11 committee understand what was connected to Mr. Epstein, and I think he's done his best to do that.

12 BY MR. SPECTRE:

13 Q So Dr. Nikolic knew of the two affairs with these two Russian women and that's it?

14 A Yes.

15 Q Did you ever contract a sexually transmitted infection during any of your extra marital
16 affairs?

17 A No.

18 Q Not in these two, or any potential other ones?

19 A No.

20 Q Do you have any guess as to why Dr. Nikolic or Jeffrey Epstein may have believed that
21 you did?

22 A Maybe they thought that was a good way to blackmail someone.

23 Q Did you have a scare of some kind and it turned out not to be a sexually transmitted
24 infection?

25 A I never had an STD.

1 Q Did you ever communicate to Dr. Nikolic that you were worried that you might?

2 A It's possible I said something like that, which later turned into the lie that I actually had
3 an STD.

4 Q Do you recall a specific discussion?

5 A I do not.

6 Q But it's possible that you did?

7 A Yes.

8 Q And again, for the record, you did not ask Dr. Nikolic in his capacity as a doctor, or in any
9 other capacity, to acquire drugs, antibiotics of any kind?

10 A No. He was not a prescribing doctor.

11 Q Okay. Mr. Higgins, I understand you have a couple questions you would like to ask.

12 Mr. Higgins. I have one question. Mr. Gates, you described the relationship as
13 manipulation, betrayal, coercion, threat of blackmail, dishonesty, Dr. Nikolic was your closest
14 associate, we understand. Have you come to believe that Dr. Nikolic conspired with Jeffrey Epstein
15 prior to your dinner meeting in 2011 and planned, to some extent, an effort to draw you into the
16 Epstein web? Has that come to be your perception of what happened?

17 Mr. Gates. I don't know what you mean by web. I have said that --

18 Mr. Higgins. The Epstein web of deceitful manipulation, and seeking power and leverage
19 with people of wealth and influence across the world.

20 Mr. Gates. Can you restate the question? It sounds very open-ended.

21 Mr. Higgins. The question is, have you come to believe in retrospect, and in reading these
22 emails that have been revealed, and some greatly surprise you, as you said, and having gone through
23 that relationship and resisted efforts to draw you into more deeply social relationships, resisted
24 efforts by Epstein to coerce you into allowing him into a deeper role with some things that you
25 regretted doing in life, have you come to see that Dr. Nikolic -- do you believe that Dr. Nikolic

1 conspired or met with Epstein prior to your dinner meeting in 2011 and said, I think maybe I can get, I
2 can get Bill in front of you and maybe we can draw him in?

3 Mr. Gates. I don't believe that happened.

4 Mr. Higgins. You don't believe that happened.

5 Mr. Gates. No, I don't think Dr. Nikolic was part of the broad set of things that you
6 described.

7 Mr. Higgins. Okay. Thank you. That's my only question.

8 Mr. Emmer. We've had another member join. Can he please announce himself for the
9 record?

10 Mr. McGuire. Congressman John McGuire, Virginia 5th District.

11 Mr. Emmer. Thank you.

12 BY MR. SPECTRE:

13 Q Mr. Gates, we're coming up near the end of our hour, so I just want to ask a couple of
14 brief questions to follow up on. So we've discussed the names of two women that you had affairs
15 with. You've already said they were both Russian. I believe in previous press statements, other
16 public statements you described one as a bridge player, and the other as a nuclear scientist, or
17 something of the sort. Is that fair?

18 A That's fair.

19 Q And so was Mila, she was the bridge player? Is that correct?

20 A Mila Antonova I met at a bridge tournament, and she was a serious bridge player.

21 Q And Karima was the nuclear scientist. Is that right?

22 A That's right.

23 Q You described at least one instance of how Dr. Nikolic was aware of your infidelity, and
24 it related to a meeting, a meet-up that you had in London, I believe you said. Was it the bridge
25 player, or was it the nuclear scientist that you were meeting up with at that time?

1 A That was the nuclear scientist.

2 Q How did Dr. Nikolic come to learn of the bridge player?

3 A There was a time after I finished a dinner in California where the bridge player was
4 meeting me, and because I was delayed, Dr. Nikolic met her and stood with her, was with her until I
5 arrived.

6 Q So once Dr. Nikolic had become aware of each of these two affairs, was this
7 something -- what was the situation between the two of you? Was it the kind of thing where you
8 knew he knew, and he knew that you knew that he knew, but did you talk about it? Did you talk
9 about it openly, or was it just like you both knew the situation and chose not to talk about it?

10 A I don't remember talking about it until, you know, during the exit period, as I said, there
11 were the veiled illusions, and I in an email took that on very directly.

12 Q Again, we've already discussed sort of potential for other extra marital affairs, but just
13 to be clear for the record, is it your testimony that you had no other romantic or sexual relationships
14 with any woman associated with Jeffrey Epstein?

15 A That's right.

16 Q And I asked you how you knew that, and you said you could never really be sure. Is
17 that your testimony as well?

18 A No. I'm sorry. Go back.

19 Q I asked you how you knew that no other woman you may have had a sexual or romantic
20 relationship with had any connection to Jeffrey Epstein. I asked you how you were sure about that,
21 and you said, Well, you guess you can't be sure. Is that right?

22 A I'm quite sure.

23 Q How?

24 A You know, I think that Epstein, when he was writing emails to himself, took every
25 potential negative thing he knew, and some that are completely false, and he put those into draft

1 emails to himself. And as we see from the email release, the only specific things he refers to are the
2 affair with the nuclear scientist, and the affair with the bridge player. And so I think if in some
3 weird way he discovered anything negative to say about me, we would have seen that in the emails
4 that he sent to himself.

5 Mr. Spectre. Thank you very much. We can go off the record.

6 Mr. Clare. If I could, before we do that, if I could just offer one thing.

7 Mr. Spectre. Sure.

8 Mr. Clare. For the committee's benefit. This line of questioning has been about these
9 emails that Epstein sent to himself, and obviously there's a lot of interest in how those things came
10 about. In the course of preparing for this hearing, and working with Mr. Gates, we did identify a
11 situation where Epstein did send an email to himself purporting to memorialize something that Mr.
12 Gates said, completely unrelated to this topic of affairs, but we do see within hours of Mr. Epstein
13 receiving an email from Mr. Gates, Epstein drafting one of these emails to himself purporting to
14 memorialize it and changing significantly the substance of it.

15 And so it may shed light, and if the committee is interested, I'm happy to provide those Bates
16 numbers, and, you know, whether it's for today or another time, we would be happy to brief you on
17 it, but it seems relevant to the question of what Epstein does when he drafts these emails to himself.

18 The email, the authentic one that Mr. Gates sent to Epstein has the Bates number
19 EFTA01936299, and then the email that is Epstein to Epstein that comes a few hours later where he
20 is purporting to memorialize what Mr. Gates told him, but changing the substance of it, is
21 EFTA01936283. So we leave that for the committee's consideration.

22 Mr. Spectre. Thank you. We can go off the record.

23 [Recess.]

24 BY MR. [REDACTED]

25 Q And we can go on the record. Mr. Gates, good morning.

1 A Good morning.

2 Q My name is [REDACTED], I am an attorney for the minority, and I will be asking most of
3 our questions today. In the course of doing so, I'm likely going to touch on some of the issues that
4 my majority colleagues covered with you in the previous round. In doing so, I don't want to make
5 you repeat yourself, I just want to make sure that we have a clear record at the end of this
6 proceeding.

7 Mr. Garcia. Can you speak into the microphone?

8 Mr. [REDACTED]: Sure. Is this better?

9 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

10 Q Okay. Apologies. I'm going to start, if I could, by talking about a few of the
11 individuals whom we understand have been connected with Microsoft, or with the Gates
12 Foundation, and whom we understand had relationships with Jeffrey Epstein. You spoke at length
13 with my majority colleagues about Mr. Nikolic. If I could start with him, just a couple of quick
14 questions. Did he ever mention anything to you about Jeffrey Epstein's proclivity for young women,
15 or for teenage girls?

16 A No. Dr. Nikolic.

17 Q Dr. Nikolic. Thank you. And did Dr. Nikolic ever mention anything to you about
18 Jeffrey Epstein's sexual relationships with young women or girls?

19 A No.

20 Q The next individual I would like to ask you about is Steven Sinofsky. Who is Mr.
21 Sinofsky?

22 A Steven Sinofsky worked in senior engineering positions at Microsoft for a long time.

23 Q And when did you meet Mr. Sinofsky?

24 A Long time ago. Early in his Microsoft career, he served in a job as technical assistant to
25 me.

1 Q Did you become aware at some point that Mr. Sinofsky had a relationship with Jeffrey
2 Epstein?

3 A No.

4 Q Did you ever become aware of Jeffrey Epstein providing professional services of any
5 kind to Mr. Sinofsky?

6 A Through the press this year.

7 Q Not prior to that?

8 A Not prior.

9 Q Did Mr. Sinofsky ever mention anything to you about Jeffrey Epstein's proclivity for
10 young women, or teenage girls?

11 A We never -- the name Epstein ever came up in any conversation I had with Mr. Sinofsky.

12 Q And as we understand, in April of 2013, Jeffrey Epstein was helping Mr. Sinofsky
13 negotiate his exit package from Microsoft. Is that something that you were aware of?

14 A Not at all.

15 Q And then moving on to the next individual, Melanie Walker. And before I proceed with
16 my questions, I'm going to ask the court reporter to mark as exhibit A a Wall Street Journal article of
17 June 7th, 2026, titled, The Hidden Figure With Close Ties to Bill Gates and Jeffrey Epstein.
18 Mr. Gates, I'm not going to ask you any questions about this article, but I understand that one or
19 more of our members will later in the hour?

20 A Okay.

21 Q I just wanted to enter it into the record.

22 [Gates Minority Exhibit A
23 was marked for identification.]

24 BY MR. [REDACTED]

25 Q Can you tell us, who is Melanie Walker?

1 A Dr. Walker worked at the Gates Foundation for a period, then she worked for the World
2 Bank for a period. She's also an advanced brain surgeon.

3 Q When did you first meet Dr. Walker?

4 A Would have been when she was at the Gates Foundation.

5 Q And when did she start working at the Gates Foundation?

6 A I'm not sure. 2007. Something like that. I'm not sure.

7 Q Were you aware at the time she started work at the Gates Foundation that she had a
8 prior relationship with Jeffrey Epstein?

9 A No, although she did send me mail after my first dinner with Epstein asking my
10 impressions, so I was aware that she knew Epstein.

11 Q And that was the first dinner you discussed earlier in 2011?

12 A That's right.

13 Q Did Dr. Walker ever mention anything to you about Jeffrey Epstein's proclivity for young
14 women, or teenage girls?

15 A No.

16 Q I'm going to ask the court reporter to mark as exhibit B a text exchange.

17 [Gates Minority Exhibit B
18 was marked for identification.]

19 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

20 Q It is from various dates in September 2017, Bates number EFTA01620736 through 742.
21 And Mr. Gates, please take all the time you need to review this exhibit. I'm only going to be
22 focusing on the last page that's Bates number 742.

23 The names of the participants in this conversation don't appear in the document. We
24 understand that they are Jeffrey Epstein and Dr. Walker. And looking at the page 742, the chat at
25 the top reads, "Larry will join my mtg tmr afternoon w BG at the bgC3 office -- Larry also invited two

1 junior staffers. Larry will not join and is not aware of other meetings. But he's starting to really
2 get annoying. Are there any signals I can send or words I can use to let him and BG know I'm not
3 messing around? Any words I can use w Larry directly or w him and BG."

4 And right below we understand to be Jeffrey Epstein's response, "With bg, all you would have
5 to say, is you should know that I've told Jeffrey everything -- everything."

6 Understanding that you were not a participant in this conversation, have you seen this
7 exchange before?

8 A Only when it was released as part of the Epstein files in January.

9 Q Do you have any understanding as to what Jeffrey Epstein was referring to here by the
10 word, "everything"?

11 A I don't have any value to add here.

12 Q And again, on the same page, the following text reads, "I am worried he will
13 immediately retaliate against me." And what we, again, understand to be Jeffrey Epstein's
14 response, "You can always say I also like blue dresses," colon, closed paren, which I take to be a
15 smiley face emoji. Do you have any understanding as to what Mr. Epstein was referring to there by
16 the reference blue dresses?

17 A We can both speculate.

18 Mr. [REDACTED]. Can you speculate for us? In your opinion, what do you think they were
19 referencing?

20 Mr. Gates. It appears to be a reference to the Monica Lewinsky affair, or whatever you call
21 it, with President Clinton.

22 Mr. [REDACTED]. And you have -- strike that. During your relationship with Mr. Epstein, did you
23 two ever discuss a blue dress?

24 Mr. Gates. No.

25 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

1 Q No further questions on this document.

2 A Okay.

3 Q Dr. Walker has reportedly claimed that Jeffrey Epstein introduced her to two
4 professional contacts who sexually propositioned her. Are you familiar with Dr. Walker's claim?

5 A Not at all.

6 Q Did Dr. Walker ever warn you about Jeffrey Epstein?

7 A Certainly not during the time I knew Mr. Epstein.

8 Q The Wall Street Journal, I'll represent, reported that in August of 2014 Dr. Walker sent
9 you what appeared to be a warning about Epstein stating that you should maintain, quote, a healthy
10 distance for anything of a personal nature, unquote, when dealing with Jeffrey Epstein. Do you
11 recall that email?

12 A I do not. Are you sure you have the date correct?

13 Q This is as reported by The Wall Street Journal, so I can't confirm their reporting, but
14 that's what --

15 A Okay.

16 Q And you don't recall Dr. Walker ever saying anything to you in that vein about Jeffrey
17 Epstein?

18 A Not during the time that I knew Epstein, no.

19 Q Subsequent to the time that you knew Epstein?

20 A You know, in 2017 his name may have come up, and I said the whole Epstein thing was
21 confusing to me, and she didn't really shed much additional light on my confusion.

22 Q What was the context of that discussion?

23 A You know, she had left the employ of the Gates Foundation and was doing some
24 scientific consulting work for me, and so during that time period it briefly came up.

25 Q And when you said the Epstein situation was confusing to you, what were you referring

1 to by situation?

2 A What was Epstein's thing, how did he make money, what was his -- what was he trying
3 to do? To this day, I don't find a fully satisfactory explanation of, you know, how he got his wealth,
4 and a variety of things.

5 Q You spoke in some detail during the previous round about your various meetings with
6 Jeffrey Epstein between 2011 and 2014. If I could, I would like to just walk through some of those
7 in particular with you in a bit more detail using some documents that we have obtained.

8 I will ask the court reporter to mark as exhibit C an email dated January 28th, 2011, with the
9 subject line -- I'm sorry. With no subject line.

10 [Gates Minority Exhibit C

11 was marked for identification.]

12 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

13 Q The text of the email reads, "Hey," redacted, "Bill Gates and Boris Nikolic is coming for
14 dinner at 71st this Monday and Tuesday night. Both nights! JE asked if you could take off work to
15 help work the dinner. It is only 3-4 people, but he would like you there. Does this work for you?"

16 And to our understanding, Mr. Gates, you are not on this email, but I'm interested in the
17 reference to both nights. Do you recall meeting with Jeffrey Epstein on two consecutive nights in
18 January?

19 A I did not.

20 Q So to your knowledge, to that extent, this email is inaccurate?

21 A That's right.

22 Q And just to be clear, the email refers to three to four people expected for one or both of
23 those dinners. Is that the number of people you recall being there?

24 A I think the January 31st dinner was during the dinner just myself, Dr. Nikolic and Mr.
25 Epstein.

1 Q And outside of the dinner, do you recall anyone else being present?

2 A Yes. That's the time when Eva Dubin and her daughter dropped by after the dinner.

3 Q I understand from your testimony in the previous rounds that Jeffrey Epstein extended
4 an invitation for you to visit his island, Little Saint James. Is that correct?

5 A I think on several occasions he did.

6 Q And you never accepted that invitation?

7 A I never did.

8 Q And why was that?

9 A It wasn't of interest to me.

10 Q Was there something in particular that was off putting about the idea for you?

11 A My time is quite valuable, and I didn't think it was interesting. It wasn't the kind of
12 relationship we had.

13 Mr. [REDACTED]. Did he mention why he was inviting you to his island?

14 Mr. Gates. I guess to expand our relationship, to have a social element to it. I'm not sure.

15 Mr. [REDACTED]. And to be clear, there was no specific purpose, it was to meet with Epstein,
16 generally speaking, but there wasn't an event you were going to at his island?

17 Mr. Gates. No. Or that I was invited to.

18 Mr. [REDACTED] You were invited to. Excuse me.

19 Mr. Gates. I never went to the island.

20 BY Mr. [REDACTED]:

21 Q Continuing chronologically, 2012, do you recall specific meetings with Jeffrey Epstein in
22 2012?

23 A Yeah, I saw him for two dinners in the fall of 2012.

24 Q Where did those dinners take place?

25 A Both at his place in New York City.

1 Q And can you tell us respectively who was in attendance at those two dinners?

2 A Maybe I should look at a document to --

3 [Discussion off the record.]

4 Mr. Gates. Okay. Sorry. Okay. Yeah, let me correct what I said. One of the 2012
5 meetings was at the New York City Four Seasons, and the other, during the General Assembly week,
6 was at his residence.

7 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

8 Q And refreshing your recollection based on the chronology you just looked at?

9 A That's right.

10 Q Can we start with the Four Seasons meeting, who was there?

11 A I think that's another meeting where Eva Dubin and a friend of hers dropped by, but
12 they were not part of the meeting.

13 Q What to your understanding was Ms. Dubin's relationship to Jeffrey Epstein?

14 A It appeared that they were friends.

15 Q And then the second 2012 meeting was at Jeffrey Epstein's residence, if I understand
16 correctly?

17 A That's right.

18 Q And who was in attendance at that meeting?

19 A He brought along two Norwegians, one who's Terje Rod-Larsen, and the other is Jagland
20 something.

21 Q Something Norwegian?

22 A Something Jagland.

23 Q Anyone else?

24 A I think Dr. Nikolic was at that dinner.

25 Q What was the topic of discussion at that dinner?

1 A Well, you know, it was generally about the World. One of those men had been the
2 number two at the United Nations, I think under Kofi Annan, and the other gentleman I think had
3 been a Prime Minister of Norway, and various other political-type things. So the dinner would have
4 discussed, you know, their views of the World. You know, I would have talked about my
5 Foundation work, including things like Polio eradication. It was, you know, the first time that I met
6 either of those two men.

7 Q The Four Seasons dinner --

8 A Not dinner.

9 Q Meeting.

10 A Meeting.

11 Q Meeting, what was the topic of discussion at that meeting?

12 A I'm not sure that I recall the specifics of that. You know, I hadn't seen Epstein for well
13 over a year, so I may have updated him on what I was up to.

14 Q And then, again, proceeding chronologically, moving into 2013, do you recall specific
15 meetings that you had with Jeffrey Epstein during that year?

16 A I met with him that year, yes.

17 Q Do you recall meeting with him at the Westin in California at some point during 2013?

18 A No.

19 Q No? If I could ask the court reporter to mark as Exhibit D an email, which we
20 understand to have been prepared by one of Mr. Epstein's assistants containing his schedule from
21 February and March 2013.

22 [Gates Minority Exhibit D

23 was marked for identification.]

24 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

25 Q Mr. Gates, please take all the time you need to review this document. Once again, it's

1 not one in which you are a participant.

2 A It looks like I may have had a Skype call with him at this time.

3 Q During 2013?

4 A Yes.

5 Q Do you recall the subject of that Skype call?

6 A I know in 2013, his representation that he could raise billions, or tens of billions for
7 global health became a significant subject of discussion.

8 Mr. [REDACTED]. Was there anyone else on that call?

9 Mr. Gates. I'm not sure.

10 BY MR. [REDACTED]

11 Q And that call took place during a period of time where you still thought that Mr. Epstein
12 might plausibly raise the sums that he was representing to you?

13 A That's right. Through, you know, I would say September, I mistakenly took him at his
14 word, then I became quite skeptical. But through September 2014, I was still hoping that it
15 would -- that billions would be raised for global health.

16 Q Referring back to Exhibit D, if I could, I would just like to walk through some of these
17 entries which refer to you and meetings that you had, according to this document, with Jeffrey
18 Epstein.

19 So I'm looking at the top, the entry for Wednesday, February 27th, 2013, there is reference to
20 an appointment from 2:00 to 3:30 p.m. with you at the Four Seasons. Do you recall having a
21 meeting with Mr. Epstein at the Four Seasons on that date?

22 [Discussion off the record.]

23 Mr. Gates. Yeah. The only thing we show on February of that year, which, you know, my
24 calendar is kept pretty precisely, all we show is a Skype call on, I believe, February 27th. Oh, no.
25 Okay. We're in 2013.

1 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

2 Q 2013.

3 A That's funny because there was a Skype call in 2014 on February 27th, so I apologize.
4 That confused me. No, it looks like there was a meeting at the Four Seasons on the 27th, and then
5 a dinner later that night at Epstein's residence in New York City. Sorry.

6 Q No problem. I appreciate the clarification. I'll walk through those in a moment.
7 Just for clarity of the record, the Skype call that we discussed a few minutes ago, that took place
8 during February of 2014?

9 A That's right. And I looked and saw February 27th and I thought that must be it, but
10 that's just a mistake I made. February 27th, what my calendar shows, and I'm sure it's correct, is
11 that I met with him at the Four Seasons during the day, and that there was a dinner at his house that
12 night.

13 Q Okay. So with respect to the Four Seasons' meeting on February 27th of 2013, who,
14 other than yourself, was in attendance at that meeting?

15 A I think --

16 Q If anyone.

17 A I mentioned that I think that was the time that Eva Dubin and a friend came by. They
18 weren't part of the meeting, but there was a meeting.

19 Q Do you recall the name of Ms. Dubin's friend?

20 A I don't.

21 Q And again, the topic of discussion at that meeting?

22 A You know, this is -- you're getting to the period where there's a lot of focus on whether
23 money can be raised for global health, so that would have been the primary topic.

24 Q Just looking at a couple of entries above, on February 27th, there's a notation,
25 12:20 p.m., and apologies, I'm almost certainly going to mispronounce this name, [REDACTED],

1 for the court reporter, [REDACTED], to arrive JFK by Virgin Atlantic 3, and at the end of the
2 entry it says, Four Seasons to meet up with you, referring to Epstein, at 2:00 p.m.

3 [Discussion off the record.]

4 Mr. Gates. Okay. Yeah. Go ahead.

5 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

6 Q Do you recall an individual by that name attending the Four Seasons meeting?

7 A No.

8 Q And then the 10:15 p.m. meeting reflected in this calendar, that, if I understand
9 correctly, took place at Mr. Gates' residence?

10 A No.

11 Q I'm sorry. Mr. Epstein's residence.

12 A There was no -- I don't think there was a 10:15 meeting. There was a -- I thought it
13 was earlier than that.

14 Q And was that a dinner?

15 A I think so, yes.

16 Q And do you recall who attended that dinner?

17 A I think that was another time where Terje Rod-Larsen and Jagland Thorbjorn -- Jagland is
18 his last name -- Thorbjorn Jagland attended the dinner. And that's also the dinner where -- he
19 invited us over and David Blaine came and did a few magic tricks.

20 Q You were asked in a previous round about the presence of young women during these
21 various interactions. Do you recall any young women being present at Mr. Gates' home on the
22 evening of February 27th?

23 A Mr. Epstein's home. Not my home. When David Blaine did his magic trick, there
24 was -- or tricks, there was one of those admin people standing around as that was being done, but I
25 was not introduced to her.

1 Q Moving ahead chronologically, the entry for February 28th, again, referring to Exhibit D,
2 starts with the notation, "Reminder: Bill Gates in New York." And then further down at 2:00 p.m.,
3 "TENTATIVE Appt w/Bill Gates." Do you recall another meeting with Jeffrey Epstein at 2:00 p.m. on
4 that date?

5 A No, I didn't meet with him on that day.

6 Mr. Clare. Did not?

7 Mr. Gates. Did not.

8 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

9 Q And were you still in New York on February 28th, or had you left town?

10 A I probably was there.

11 Q And then moving ahead to the entry for Friday, March 1st, 2013, there is a notation,
12 "1:00 p.m. LUNCH w/Bill Gates and Woody Allen." Do you recall having lunch with Mr. Epstein and
13 Woody Allen?

14 A I've never met Woody Allen. I did not ever have lunch, so this never took place.

15 Q And then immediately below, "TBD maybe fly to PB today/tonight, Bill Gates to fly with
16 you maybe," and four question marks. Assuming PB refers to Palm Beach, did you fly to Palm Beach
17 with Mr. Epstein on March 1st?

18 A Yeah, March 1st or 2nd I did, yes.

19 Q What was the purpose of the trip to Palm Beach?

20 A It was just to -- Mr. Epstein, you know, was seeking more time to talk to me, and I was
21 going to Wellington, Florida, to see my daughter, and so he suggested, because I had a very full
22 schedule, that we fly together to Palm Beach, which we did. It was not his 727, but we flew on a
23 different plane to Palm Beach.

24 Q A private plane, I take it?

25 A A private plane. And I don't know if he owned it or chartered it or what, but it was a

1 Gulfstream, not a -- the well-known 727.

2 Q Was anyone else on that flight with the two of you?

3 A Yes. He had, of course, there was a pilot on the flight, presumably.

4 Q Presumably and hopefully, yes.

5 A And I believe there were two admin assistants who sat in the first cabin during the flight.

6 Q Okay. Were you introduced to either of those admin assistants?

7 A I was not.

8 Q Were they both female?

9 A Yes.

10 Q Relatively young?

11 A I wouldn't -- I would say they weren't underaged. I think there was a photo taken we
12 could look at. But they appeared to be adult women to me.

13 Q Did you have any understanding that Jeffrey Epstein had a relationship of any kind with
14 either of those two women beyond an employment relationship?

15 A No.

16 Q Did you witness any sexual activity or sexual abuse on the plane?

17 A Never.

18 Q And when you got to Palm Beach, did you stay with Jeffrey Epstein at his house?

19 A I did not. I never went to his Palm Beach house. As soon as the plane landed, my
20 security team met me there and I went to another location in Florida, which is Wellington.

21 Q And was this trip to Palm Beach the only time that you flew on a plane with Jeffrey
22 Epstein?

23 A That's right.

24 Q You referred during the previous round with the majority, if I understood correctly, that
25 you met at some point in 2013 with Jeffrey Epstein in Paris, France. Is that correct?

1 A Yes.

2 Q Okay. And what was the purpose of that trip?

3 A I didn't take -- I was in Paris for other things, and there was an afternoon where I went
4 over to, I think, a place that he owned in Paris and spent a few hours with him that afternoon.

5 Q And what did you discuss with him that afternoon?

6 A You know, the substantive discussion would have been about the possibility of raising
7 money philanthropically. You know, we possibly touched on -- I think the French Open was going
8 on at that time.

9 Q Was anyone else present in the apartment during your meeting?

10 A Yeah, I mean, there were definitely staff people there, including a chef who cooked a lot
11 of food and served it to us at a time when we weren't hungry. And I forget, I think Dr. Nikolic was
12 there. I don't think Mr. Cohen was there. But, yes, there was a meeting.

13 Q Is the name Jean-Luc Brunel familiar to you?

14 A Through the press only.

15 Q Do you recall Mr. Brunel being present at that meeting?

16 A He was not. I never ever met him.

17 Q I'm going to ask the court reporter to mark as Exhibit E an email from Mr. Nikolic to you
18 dated June 8th, 2013. And for the record, this email thread bears the Bates number EFTA00873390
19 through 92.

20 [Gates Minority Exhibit E
21 was marked for identification.]

22 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

23 Q Mr. Gates, do you recall this email?

24 A I have a recollection, yes.

25 Q You referred, as I remember, during the first hour to an invitation that was extended to

1 you while you were in Paris, which you declined. Does this email thread refer to that invitation?

2 A It does.

3 Q Just a couple of questions about the substance of this exchange. I'm looking at Mr.
4 Nikolic's email to you on the page that bears the Bates number 91 at the end, the second page of this
5 exhibit, and he writes, "Have you ever been in legendary Crazy Horse in Paris? It is one of those
6 erotic upscale elegant shows -- it is fun if you have never been."

7 And then skipping to the end of his email, "Most likely we can go after backstage and meet
8 some artists as Jeffrey dated a few of them."

9 And then your reply in the next email up above at 4:18 p.m., "I will be too tired to do this and
10 wouldn't want to take the risk." What risk exactly were you referring to here?

11 A I think in general going to a show of erotic nature is -- I just don't choose to do that. I
12 don't think it would be helpful for my reputation. In my early 20s, I probably went to a show like
13 this once or twice, but here I'm saying that I believe it would be a mistake for me to accept this
14 invitation. You know, just another example of where there was kind of an attempt to draw me into
15 a more social relationship.

16 Q You had a concern about potential reputational harm in the event that you were
17 spotted?

18 A Right. And it wasn't consistent with the relationship I had with Epstein. We never
19 did anything of a entertainment or relaxing nature, and so this would have been a change in the
20 relationship that I chose not to make.

21 Q Was there anything specific to Jeffrey Epstein that led you not to want to attend this
22 event?

23 A Yeah, I guess not only is my appearing at an erotic event a risk to my reputation, it
24 would be compounded by appearing with somebody who, although I didn't know the full extent of it,
25 had been convicted of a sexually-related crime.

1 Q And was that on your mind when you wrote this reply to Mr. Nikolic?

2 A Certainly.

3 Q Mr. Gates, I have no more questions for the moment, but I understand that some of our
4 members have questions for you at this point.

5 Mr. [REDACTED]. And before we turn it over to members, for those new members who just arrived,
6 can you please introduce yourself for the record?

7 Ms. Randall. Congresswoman Emily Randall, Washington's 6th District.

8 Ms. Ansari. Yassamin Ansari, Arizona's 3rd District.

9 Mr. Khanna. Ro Khanna, California.

10 Mr. Burchett. Tim Burchett, Tennessee. Do we need to do this every time we walk in?

11 Mr. [REDACTED]. Not every time.

12 Mr. Burchett. Okay. Cool. All right. Thank you.

13 Ms. Stansbury. Melanie Stansbury, New Mexico 1st.

14 Mr. Garcia. Great. Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Gates, thank you for being here today,
15 and for your cooperation in answering questions.

16 Obviously, this investigation for us is about getting to Jeffrey Epstein's crimes, accountability
17 and justice for the survivors. I think you acknowledged that at the start.

18 I have a couple of questions, but I wanted to also just ask you, look, I think everyone
19 recognizes that you have built incredible companies, your Foundation, the work that's happened
20 across the World, you have done an enormous amount of good for a lot of people globally, and so I
21 do want to recognize -- I want to recognize that and it's appreciated.

22 Because we're looking to get justice and having an investigation that at the end of the day is
23 about survivors, in your interactions with Mr. Epstein, in which you described some, and you will
24 throughout the day, as we seek to getting better understanding of how we can learn exactly what
25 happened and who was responsible, can you suggest, and you are an incredibly brilliant person,

1 obviously, in your interactions with Mr. Epstein, could you suggest, or do you have any suggestions of
2 who are people within his orbit, whether they were assistants you may have interacted with, staff
3 that you may have seen, that we should be asking questions of to get additional information? If you
4 were to give our committee some thoughts about folks that we should be talking to in this
5 investigation, is there anyone that you could suggest, or that you would suggest? Whether you
6 remember their names or not, but folks within Jeffrey Epstein's orbit that you think could have
7 information vital to this investigation?

8 Mr. Gates. You know, I'm really not sure because his illegal activities didn't come up and
9 weren't happening when I was ever there.

10 And I mentioned that in my second dinner, Jes Staley and Larry Summers were present, and
11 I've said in subsequent dinners the two Norwegian gentlemen were present. Later on in 2014, as I
12 pushed Epstein on who were these people that he had this close professional relationship relative
13 their taxes and their will and, therefore, what they might be doing philanthropically, he had me meet
14 with a number of men. But I don't want to cast any aspersion on those men because I don't have
15 specific knowledge of any of these men's bad behavior. But, you know, those were some of the
16 people who were around.

17 And, you know, part of the reason that I foolishly spent time with Epstein was seeing those
18 other well-known people in his orbit, that had an influence on me. But I'm not blaming them, and I
19 do feel bad that my spending time with them may have furnished his reputation to some degree.

1 [12:12 p.m.]

2 Mr. Garcia. What about employees of Epstein, so not necessarily, you know, men or
3 individuals that were in the public limelight or that had broad reputations, but what about
4 employees or people around Epstein that worked for him or there was a perception that they worked
5 for him that wouldn't be -- that, if you had to make a judgment, would be important for us to speak
6 with? Who would you recommend us to speak with?

7 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I was never introduced to any employees of Epstein. As I've said, they
8 were there to open the door. One of the people stayed for the David Blaine magic tricks. There
9 were the two admin assistants who were on the plane flight. In almost every time I saw Epstein, he
10 either had one or two what appeared to be admin assistants with him. They were all women.
11 They all appeared to be adult women. We can go through the various times he had me take photos
12 with these people, but I was never introduced to them. So I wouldn't have a lot of insight to which
13 ones might help the Committee.

14 Mr. Garcia. Thank you. And, Mr. Gates, I know that you have said, and I just want to
15 quote, "To be clear, I never spent any time with victims, the women around him." I know that you
16 have said that -- have been quoted as saying that. But you are aware that many of Epstein's
17 assistants who were around were actually victimized?

18 Mr. Gates. Yeah, that's a very good point. I never spent time with any women who I was
19 aware were victims, and so that's why I've enumerated very carefully when I ever saw any of those
20 admin assistants, because, tragically, as you say, it appears in the press now that some of those
21 women were indeed victims. So, to that degree, you know, for the photos, for sitting on the plane
22 or standing there during the magic trick, I may have been in the presence of victims.

23 Mr. Garcia. Okay. No, I appreciate that clarification. I think that's an important one to
24 make. And then, just lastly, I know that you said earlier that you felt your association with Epstein
25 was a huge mistake. Just to expand on that, for the record, can you expand on that what you mean

1 exactly by that? What was the mistake?

2 Mr. Gates. Yeah. I hope I capture all the ways that it was a mistake. It was a mistake to
3 spend time with him because, in the end, it led to nothing. You know, I'm still not sure to this day if
4 he sincerely thought that, in fact, billions would appear that would be dedicated to Global Health. I
5 think so, because, you know, there were meetings talking about literally the structure of
6 donor-advised funds that might be attractive to the donors, but it was a mistake because it was a
7 dead end.

8 It was a mistake because of his prior conviction. It's even more of a mistake when I read, in
9 2018, that basically he had not served an appropriate penalty for the things he had done, and then,
10 even more so, as I read that, even after 2009, perhaps even during the time 2011 to 2014 when I was
11 meeting with him, that there were ongoing crimes. And so you can say it's easy to say now, but let
12 me tell you: This is one of the larger mistakes I've made was to risk my reputation and the
13 reputation of the foundation by engaging in these meetings.

14 Mr. Garcia. Mr. Khanna.

15 Mr. Khanna. Thank you.

16 Thank you, Mr. Gates, for being here. Did Jeffrey Epstein use Dr. Melanie Walker to get
17 access to you?

18 Mr. Gates. No.

19 Mr. Khanna. Did Epstein use Walker to reach her foundation advisors or other powerful
20 people around you?

21 Mr. Gates. I'm sorry, say again.

22 Mr. Khanna. Did Epstein use Dr. Walker to reach her foundation advisors or other powerful
23 people around you?

24 Mr. Gates. Well, Dr. Walker was an employee of the Gates Foundation doing work there for,
25 I think, something like 3 years. Then she went to work at the World Bank, and then she did some

1 consulting for my private office. But, you know, that's what I knew that she was engaged in.

2 Mr. Khanna. Did Epstein ever receive information about you through her?

3 Mr. Gates. It appears, reading the emails, the answer to that is yes, but I had no awareness
4 of it at the time.

5 Mr. Khanna. Dr. Walker told you that Epstein was very discrete, and the world's most
6 gorgeous people hang around Jeffrey. He was already a convicted sex offender at the time. Why
7 did you continue to maintain a relationship with him?

8 Mr. Gates. Well, as I've said, I felt that, working with Epstein in the limited role -- which I
9 was clear to him that is simply being referring me to people who would give, never contemplating
10 and being explicit that he would have no role and that he would not be compensated -- I made the
11 mistake in judgment that continuing to spend time with him to try and raise that money for Global
12 Health was a valuable use of my time.

13 Mr. Khanna. Well, where would you have gotten the money, from him directly or his --

14 Mr. Gates. No, not from him, but rather -- when somebody is, you know, thinking about
15 their will and their taxes, you know, that's when they really think, "Okay, I have -- particularly people
16 of great wealth, "that I have money that's leftover that perhaps I should give philanthropically."
17 And so I believed -- and he represented -- that with a number of billionaires, including Wall Street
18 billionaires and Middle East billionaires, he had that type of relationship where there was somebody
19 staking out their overall estate plan. And I believe that was a case where literally billions, and he
20 specifically said this to me, which, of course, ended up not happening, but he said that we could raise
21 billions --

22 Mr. Khanna. Two more --

23 Mr. Gates. I'm sorry.

24 Mr. Khanna. Two more quick questions because my time is about -- given that what we've
25 seen, the behavior of what I call this Epstein class and all these billionaires, would you at least be for

1 a 5 percent tax on these billionaires to deal with wealth inequality? Could you at least say you're
2 open to something like that?

3 Mr. Gates. Well, I certainly believe that the U.S. has to find a way of taxing very rich people
4 at a far higher level than they do today. You know, I probably paid more in taxes than anyone. I
5 paid over \$14 billion. I think it's unfortunate that the current taxation vehicles don't raise more
6 money from people of great wealth, including people like myself.

7 Mr. Khanna. My last question is, did Mr. Epstein ever introduce you to any young women or
8 girls?

9 Mr. Gates. Never.

10 Mr. Khanna. Thank you.

11 Mr. Garcia. Congressman Lynch.

12 Mr. Lynch. Thank you, Mr. Gates. Earlier, Democratic counsel asked you if you recalled an
13 email that you received that was sent to you by Melanie Walker that warned you about Mr. Epstein.
14 You did not recall that, and you asked if there might be a specific date. I looked it up, and it's
15 August 14 -- I'm sorry, August of 2014. Walker sent you a -- appeared to be a warning, and it said
16 that you should maintain a, quote, "healthy distance from anything of a personal nature when
17 dealing with Epstein." Do you recall that now?

18 Mr. Gates. No. If you have a copy of the email, I'd be glad to see it.

19 Mr. Lynch. Yeah, okay. All right. No.

20 Mr. Gates. But let me comment on that. I did maintain some distance from Epstein.

21 Mr. Lynch. Yeah.

22 Mr. Gates. It was a mistake to meet with him. And, by August 2014, you know, this is a
23 month before he finally does name specific people who we meet with in September, and none of
24 those appear to be prospects. Then there's one further meeting in December, and then I cut off all
25 ties with Epstein at that point.

1 Mr. Lynch. I understand that. But, from the very beginning of your relationship, he was a
2 registered sex offender.

3 Mr. Gates. I didn't know he was a registered sex offender, but I did know that he had been
4 guilty of a sexually related crime.

5 Mr. Lynch. Well, let me just go back to Melanie Walker. Melanie Walker really worked
6 your staff pretty hard in terms of pushing Jeffrey Epstein. And, in one email to you, she describes
7 him as her best friend. Also, Melanie Walker really pumped Epstein with Dr. Nikolic and also Larry
8 Cohen. She went to Alex Freedman (ph) pushing Jeffrey Epstein, also established a relationship
9 with Prince Andrew as well.

10 You know, sort of following up with Mr. Khanna's questions, I saw her as someone who really
11 pushed Epstein into your orbit and actually made those connections. And, you know, when you
12 were asked who you thought might've shared the information about your infidelity, I thought of her.
13 I did not think of Dr. Nikolic, because it was consistent with every -- she was an accolade of Epstein
14 from the very beginning, gave him credit for suggesting she go to medical school. Could you talk a
15 little about your relationship with Ms. Walker, because I think, in response to the ranking member's
16 question, and I think she might be someone that this Committee would want to talk to?

17 Mr. Gates. Yeah. During the time I knew Epstein, between 2011 and 2014, the only time
18 her name came up with Epstein was that at that first dinner he mentioned that he knew her. And,
19 subsequently, all the meetings over the rest of the years, her name did not come up with him. In
20 terms of her, she did send me an email after that first dinner asking about my impressions, which I
21 responded to, but --

22 Mr. Lynch. Did she ever tell you that she was his science adviser or that she had lived in his
23 buildings?

24 Mr. Gates. I wasn't aware of that, but I do believe that's now publicly known.

25 Mr. Lynch. Yeah. I'm just curious about --

1 Mr. Gates. No, I did not know that.

2 Mr. Lynch. Okay. All right. That's all I've got. Thank you.

3 Ms. Stansbury. All right. Good morning. Hi. I'm Melanie Stansbury. I represent New
4 Mexico's First Congressional District, and I do appreciate you being here today. What I'd like to
5 focus on during my time this morning is really to understand a little bit more about Mr. Epstein's
6 world as you understood it because I think it will help us cut through some of the noise, especially in
7 a truth commission that we're conducting in New Mexico to understand what he was doing there and
8 what his interests were and how that allowed him access to abuse women.

9 So you're one of the few people we've been able to talk to about what Epstein was [inaudible]
10 scientifically. Through your conversations with him, through these meetings that you had during
11 that time, what was Epstein interested in in the science world?

12 Mr. Gates. We never got into any depth on that, but he mentioned a number of people, you
13 know, professors at universities, that he would talk to about varying scientific things. You know,
14 some of those are names that I knew. He appeared to be a dilettante who, you know, would talk to
15 lots of people in different fields. You know, that's different than my own approach, which is to pick
16 software and be very focused on that --

17 Ms. Stansbury. Yeah.

18 Mr. Gates. -- now to pick Global Health.

19 Ms. Stansbury. Let me reframe the question a little bit. You met with him multiple times
20 to discuss the opportunities for philanthropy and investment in scientific endeavors as well as Global
21 Health.

22 Mr. Gates. No.

23 Ms. Stansbury. That's not what you said?

24 Mr. Gates. All the entire focus was raising money for Global Health. Now, work for Global
25 Health can include creating new vaccines or things --

1 Ms. Stansbury. So what was the --

2 Mr. Gates. -- that have a scientific component to them.

3 Ms. Stansbury. Okay. So excuse me for using more plain language as opposed to focused
4 language. What was the nature of those conversations? What were the topics that he was
5 interested in?

6 Mr. Gates. You know, he had thoughts about economics. He had thoughts about
7 psychology, you know, various macroeconomic things.

8 Ms. Stansbury. Were specific investment opportunities discussed?

9 Mr. Gates. No, I never -- I was never a coinvestor with Epstein. The focus was
10 philanthropic money.

11 Ms. Stansbury. Okay. I think we're talking around the same thing. So philanthropic
12 money to invest in what?

13 Mr. Gates. In Global Health.

14 Ms. Stansbury. But what specifically, sir?

15 Mr. Gates. Epstein wasn't knowledgeable about Global Health. So the Gates Foundation,
16 which is deeply involved in Global Health, you know, when there's additional money coming from
17 philanthropists, were able to provide advice to make sure that money has very high impact. But
18 none of that specifically was discussed -- the idea of where it would go to wasn't discussed with
19 Epstein.

20 Ms. Stansbury. Oh, Okay. So the nature of these conversations was more pitching him and
21 his associates on getting wealthy donors to invest in your ventures?

22 Mr. Gates. If money had been forthcoming --

23 Ms. Stansbury. Yes.

24 Mr. Gates. -- it would've gone to things like the Global Alliance for Vaccines, which buys
25 vaccines for children, or the Global Fund --

1 Ms. Stansbury. But you were --

2 Mr. Gates. I'm sorry?

3 Ms. Stansbury. You were essentially pitching him to invest?

4 Mr. Gates. I didn't pitch him. He told me that he had this close professional relationship
5 with people, who at the time they were deciding what to do with all of their wealth --

6 Ms. Stansbury. Yeah.

7 Mr. Gates. -- was a context where he could suggest to them that that money could have a
8 very powerful effect if it was dedicated to Global Health.

9 Ms. Stansbury. Okay. So your motivation in attending these meetings is you saw an
10 opportunity to potentially bring other donors in to bringing their wealth to invest in your ventures.
11 Is that a fair assessment?

12 Mr. Gates. Not invest, to give money away. And they're not my ventures. GAVI is an
13 independent organization; Global Fund is an independent organization.

14 Ms. Stansbury. I'm using the word "invest" colloquially, so --

15 Mr. Gates. Okay. I'm sorry to be picky.

16 Ms. Stansbury. -- to be philanthropic givers.

17 Mr. Gates. Good point.

18 Ms. Stansbury. Okay.

19 Mr. Gates. Good point.

20 Ms. Stansbury. To be donors to your philanthropic endeavors, okay.

21 Mr. Gates. Well, again, this may be picky, but they're not mine, you know. The Gates
22 Foundation --

23 Ms. Stansbury. I got you.

24 Mr. Gates. -- gives money to GAVI --

25 Ms. Stansbury. Yes.

1 Mr. Gates. -- but there are many other donors to the Global Alliance for Vaccines.

2 Ms. Stansbury. I got you. Okay. This is why you're a tech person; you're very precise.
3 I'm using imprecise and a nontechnical language. So you've already established this morning that
4 you were familiar with the fact that he had been convicted of a sexual crime. You've already
5 established this morning that you were familiar that Mr. Epstein had this reputation, and you were
6 concerned about it because you've already said you didn't want to be seen with him in a place that
7 might affect your reputation.

8 So I think that what I -- what many of us don't understand is, why did people like you continue
9 to associate with him? Like why did your interest in accessing donors that he might know override
10 your own moral compass of like "maybe I shouldn't associate with this convicted sex offender"?

11 Mr. Gates. Yeah.

12 Ms. Stansbury. I know you feel bad about it, but tell us like what went through your head
13 where you're like, "Okay, yeah, I'll go have six meetings with him over these years."

14 Mr. Gates. Well, I've certainly -- you know, I'd met with people who'd been convicted of
15 crimes and served their time. And, in my understanding, I did not understand that justice had not
16 been done. It was a mistake to meet with him. I did feel at the time that, by narrowly defining his
17 role as simply referring us to people who would give philanthropically to Global Health, that he
18 would have no role in those things, and he would receive no compensation. I justified that getting
19 billions of dollars for Global Health was worth spending time with him, and that was a complete dead
20 end.

21 Ms. Stansbury. And so, in your mind, the ends justified the means?

22 Mr. Gates. No. I think that goes too strongly. But, during the whole time, 2011 to 2014,
23 there was a, you know, constant consideration of, "Okay, let's make sure it's a very narrow role."
24 And people would discuss, you know, is this going to come through or not; should we still engage or
25 not? That was a consideration, and I made the final judgment to keep meeting with him, which was

1 a mistake.

2 Ms. Stansbury. Let me just say, as we close things out, and I know there's other questions,
3 you keep referring to the women that you did interact with in his orbit as being adult women. We
4 have interviewed a number of his assistants, including one of his assistants who did work for Epstein
5 as an adult woman, who was raped and sexually assaulted during her time. And so Epstein didn't
6 just commit crimes against children; he was committing active crimes against these admin assistants
7 that you met.

8 And so, when you have said multiple times this morning you did not meet victims, you did not
9 see women that he may have -- we do not believe that is so. We believe that this was completely
10 normalized in his world as he was interacting with rich and powerful people. And so I hope that you
11 can reframe that you may have actually witnessed abuse by these women being in his world, even if
12 you did not witness the acts of abuse. So --

13 Mr. Gates. You're saying that -- I didn't -- I never witnessed any abuse.

14 Ms. Stansbury. Okay, sir. We know that his assistants were being abused actively by him.

15 Mr. Gates. I'm very sorry to hear that.

16 Ms. Stansbury. Yes. So, thank you.

17 Ms. Crockett. For purposes of the record, Jasmine Crockett, Texas.

18 Mr. Garcia. I think we're probably out of time now, so we can wrap it up.

19 Mr. [REDACTED]. We'll go off the record. Thank you.

20 [Recess.]

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[1:02 p.m.]

Mr. Spectre. We can go on the record.

Mr. Gates, during the majority's first hour, we discussed one draft email that was sent by Mr. Epstein to himself. There is a second somewhat similar email. I will enter that into the record as majority exhibit 3.

[Gates Majority Exhibit No. 3
was marked for identification.]

BY MR. SPECTRE:

Q It is an email also from July 18, 2013; this time at 1:33 p.m. It's Bates marked as EFTA 01967528. I'll give you a second to look at it. Have you seen this email before?

A Only as part of the release of the Epstein files.

Q So you had not seen this email until it was released publicly by the Department of Justice. Is that right?

A That's right.

Q Had you seen any email that was similar to it or close to it, or you'd seen nothing like this before?

A Nothing like this.

Q What was your reaction when you saw this in the Epstein files?

A It looked like -- it looks like Epstein is suggesting -- well, it's an email to himself. So who knows if he ever sent it to Dr. Nikolic, but it looks like he's musing on using a mixture of facts and falsities as an effort, almost like a blackmail, to advance some goal in improving Dr. Nikolic's negotiating position as part of his exit from my employ.

Q I will read parts of the email into the record starting with -- near the top. It's at the third sentence. "You have decided to discharge me from my job; had Larry, your PR person, tell me

1 that I engaged in morally inappropriate behavior; and then asked me to be the major actor in a
2 coverup so that you can maintain the reputation that you have worked so hard to achieve," end
3 quote.

4 For the record, is it fair to say that the person being referenced here, Larry, your PR person, is
5 that Larry Cohen?

6 A Well, Larry was not my PR person. But, in a word, speculating on a person who,
7 particularly in the emails to himself, you know, generated literally dozens of false things, that
8 sentence may refer to Larry Cohen, but he was not my PR person.

9 Q Fair enough. But was Mr. Cohen involved in any way in the discussions about
10 Mr. Nikolic, Dr. Nikolic's departure?

11 A Yes.

12 Q Thank you. Did you direct Larry Cohen to tell Mr. Nikolic that he had engaged in
13 morally inappropriate behavior?

14 A No.

15 Q Did Larry Cohen, to your knowledge, ever tell Dr. Nikolic that he had engaged in morally
16 inappropriate behavior?

17 A I don't believe so.

18 Q Have you talked to Mr. Cohen about that?

19 A No.

20 Q Have you had any discussions with Mr. Cohen about this email since seeing it in the
21 Epstein files?

22 A No.

23 Q Do you believe that Dr. Nikolic had engaged in any morally inappropriate behavior?

24 A Well, depending on how you characterize his not telling my wife about affairs I'd had,
25 that's the extent of it.

1 Q Did you ever tell Dr. Nikolic explicitly to keep these affairs, his knowledge of these
2 affairs, private?

3 A No, I didn't. In fact, you'll see an email from me where I say during the exit
4 negotiations that, if they're trying to change the terms away from what was agreed to before
5 Epstein's involvement, that we won't reach agreement and if that involves -- I mean, you can pull the
6 exact email, but I say, if that involves things being disclosed about me, I'll just bear that pain, but I'm
7 not going to change my offer to Dr. Nikolic as part of the exit agreement.

8 Q I understand. Let's go back a little further though, when Dr. Nikolic first became aware
9 of these two affairs. At that point in time, I think I asked you earlier if you ever discussed the affairs
10 with Dr. Nikolic. But did you ever initially tell Dr. Nikolic that you expected him to keep this as a
11 secret for you?

12 A I did not.

13 Q You just assumed that he wouldn't share it?

14 A We never discussed it.

15 Q How long from the start of the first affair to when you told Melinda, how long was that?

16 A Probably several years.

17 Q Several years or 7 years? Sorry.

18 A I said several years.

19 Q Several years. So, over the course of those several years, you never had a
20 conversation with Dr. Nikolic asking him to kind of -- to keep this a secret?

21 A I did not.

22 Q I'll continue reading. It's a little bit further down, still near the top. It says, "Larry has
23 now asked me to recommit to a confidentiality agreement and have categorically told me that you
24 were of firm mind that we should no longer have any direct ongoing business relationship, with a
25 total disregard for its impact on the public perception of my reputation. You have requested that I

1 diligently avoid the truth, tell people that Bill will not invest with me, and craft answers that suits
2 yours and Melinda's needs."

3 I think you've already answered part of my questions about this, but I guess I'll ask in a
4 different way: Did you have any -- as part of his position or otherwise, did you have any
5 confidentiality agreement with Dr. Nikolic about anything?

6 A I'm not sure.

7 Q You're not aware of whether you had any legal nondisclosure agreement or anything of
8 the sort with Dr. Nikolic?

9 A I'm not.

10 Q And let me just be clear: You with him or the Gates Foundation or any of the other
11 ventures, do you know if those entities had nondisclosure agreements with Dr. Nikolic?

12 A You know, Dr. Nikolic, I assume, when he worked for the foundation, which had ended,
13 you know, a long time before this, there may be a standard nondisclosure as part of that. I don't
14 know. Likewise, when he joins Gates Ventures, there may be some standard nondisclosure. But I
15 was never part of any discussion about that with anyone, including Dr. Nikolic.

16 Q And, if there was a nondisclosure agreement with Dr. Nikolic that you're not aware of,
17 that wouldn't have anything to do with the affairs. Is that fair to say?

18 A No. As I told you, I sent in an email that, if they were trying to ask for a change in the
19 exit package, then I said I would just bear the pain of whatever disclosures resulted thereafter.

20 BY MR. GRANT:

21 Q And, since the topic of nondisclosure agreements have been brought up, at any point
22 did you or any of your representatives or agents ask anyone to sign a nondisclosure agreement or
23 other agreement in connection to Jeffrey Epstein, Ghislaine Maxwell, or any of their victims?

24 A No.

25 Q And have you or any of your representatives or agents had conversations about

1 nondisclosure agreements with any victims or their lawyers related to Jeffrey Epstein or Ghislaine
2 Maxwell?

3 A No.

4 Q And, at any point, did you or any of your representatives secure a settlement in
5 connection to Jeffrey Epstein, Ghislaine Maxwell, or any of their victims?

6 A No.

7 Q Thank you.

8 BY MR. SPECTRE:

9 Q I will continue reading. I'll read just a portion of this one. It starts with, "I can assure
10 you that, if the shoe was on the other foot, I would would've said, Boris, this is not your fault."

11 Mr. Gates. Can you point out where he is?

12 Mr. Moran. Yep.

13 Mr. Gates. Okay. There you are.

14 BY MR. SPECTRE:

15 Q "I can assure you that if the shoe was on the other foot, I would've said, Boris, this is not
16 your fault. I confessed to Melinda. You didn't. It was in a moment of weakness, and I promise
17 that will do anything within my power to make it right for you. I have more money than anyone
18 needs, and I do my utmost to structure something that you will not be penalized for my error."

19 I'll end reading the quote there, but he goes on to kind of describe what it is that you should
20 have done for Dr. Nikolic. Again, I think I asked you about this a little bit earlier, but it seems to be
21 characterizing the nature of Dr. Nikolic's departure as being about, you know, your confession to
22 your ex-wife, to your then-wife. Did your wife ever meet with Dr. Nikolic directly to discuss this?

23 A Not to my knowledge.

24 Q The next portion that I will read, it's a little bit further down, near the bottom: "What I
25 did receive, however."

1 A Okay. Let's track that. Okay. Here we are.

2 Q "What I did receive, however, was an unfriendly, strongly worded email telling me how
3 employable I am and that I should not look to you for any significant financial help in the future. To
4 add insult to the injury, you then subsequently, with tears in your eyes, implore me to please delete
5 the emails regarding your STD, your request that I provide you antibiotics that you can surreptitiously
6 give to Melinda, and the description of your penis. You also made it clear to me that I am not to
7 refer to" -- redacted -- "as that is another topic that must remain between the two of us. In return
8 for all of these requests, which I would've done without a second thought, I am not to attend
9 meetings with Melinda. I should continue to provide you the same level of service and dedication
10 that I have done so diligently until you are ready to discard me and our friendship sometime after the
11 first of the year."

12 So there's a lot going on here. Just initially, Dr. Nikolic or, again, Mr. Epstein seems to be
13 referring to a strongly worded email that it seems you may have sent to Dr. Nikolic. Do you recall
14 what that might have been?

15 A No. I mean, at some point, I told him that would he have talked to me about leaving to
16 go do venture capital that that would have to happen fairly quickly, because Melinda and I agreed
17 that he should leave my employ.

18 Q Your discussions in person or over email with Dr. Nikolic about his departure, were they,
19 in your view, generally cordial, or was it a contentious interaction?

20 A Well, there's two different times. There's the time before he involves Epstein, where I
21 would say they were cordial. Then he sort of cedes to Epstein, and Epstein -- you know, none of the
22 stuff in this email ever came up, but, at most, he made veiled threats, like "we should remain
23 friends," but I chose not to change the exit offer that I made. And I made it clear that I would bear
24 whatever disclosures came out of our failure to reach a fair exit agreement.

25 Q So, over the course of you not being willing to change your position, things may have

1 gotten a little bit more contentious between --

2 A Not with Dr. Nikolic, but, you know, Epstein actually came out to Seattle one time during
3 these discussions, and, you know, it was weird because I said, you know, I got an offer that treats him
4 fairly, and "if you're here to ask for more than that, I'm not changing it." And, in fact, I did not
5 change it. We reached the agreement, and Dr. Nikolic left my employ.

6 Q We'll get into that meeting in Seattle in a little while. However, I'll note for you now
7 that it seems to have occurred on August 8, 2013. This email is from July 18, 2013. So this email
8 seems to predate whatever that meeting was. I'm just trying to understand, you know, maybe it
9 was a strongly worded email. Maybe it was something in person, but when did the contentious
10 nature of the interactions with Dr. Nikolic or Mr. Epstein arise?

11 A There was never any contentious nature with Dr. Nikolic, and it's hard to characterize
12 the Epstein stuff because there was never a direct threat of any kind. There was always this veiled
13 language like "we should remain friends," you know, which made me wonder what Dr. Nikolic had
14 shared with him. But, as I said, I responded to all of that with a great deal of clarity. You can
15 introduce that email or not.

16 Q So the portion that I had just read, it also makes reference to the fact that you -- the
17 email says that, "you implored me to please delete the emails regarding your STD and your request
18 that I provide you antibiotics that you can surreptitiously give Melinda and the description of your
19 penis." Did you ever tell Dr. Nikolic to delete emails in general?

20 A I did not.

21 Q Did you ever send Dr. Nikolic an email that included the three things I just described?

22 A I never had an STD. I never described my penis to Dr. Nikolic. What's the other one?
23 I've said I may have indicated some concern about whether I had an STD; I don't recall that. But I
24 never had an STD. I never gave medicines to anyone covertly.

25 Q And, just for the record, during the time where you were concerned that you might have

1 an infection, did you ever discuss or consider surreptitiously giving antibiotics to your then-wife?

2 A I did not.

3 Q Thank you. Do you know what the redacted word or words are at the bottom of the
4 page?

5 A It's just black.

6 Q So this redaction was made by the Department of Justice in their release of the Epstein
7 files. Members of the committee have had the opportunity to look underneath of redactions at the
8 Department of Justice. So I will stipulate to you that the redacted words are a name. It's Alice
9 Jacobs, and we understand her full name to be Alice Jacobs Nesselrodt. Do you know who that
10 person is?

11 A I do.

12 Q Who is she?

13 A She's a doctor who does consulting related to health services, I believe.

14 Q Have you ever met her before?

15 A I have.

16 Q Did you meet her in connection with Jeffrey Epstein?

17 A No.

18 Q How did you meet her?

19 A She was at a conference that I went to.

20 Q Do you recall approximately what year?

21 A Before 2010.

22 Q According to the DOJ files, Ms. Nesselrodt appears to have initially made contact with
23 Jeffrey Epstein over email in October 2009, and it seems she was ultimately the one that introduced
24 Epstein and Nikolic. Did you know that?

25 A No. I thought it was -- I mean, what I've read in the press is it was Dr. Walker. I don't

1 know -- I mean, I think even recently a press thing said it was Dr. Walker. But I don't -- I have no
2 knowledge of who did that introduction.

3 Q In one email, she referred to Boris as her, quote, best friend. Did you know that she
4 and Dr. Nikolic were friends at all?

5 A Who?

6 Q In one email, Ms. Nesselrodt, Dr. Nesselrodt, referred to Boris as her best friend. Did
7 you know that Dr. Nesselrodt and Dr. Nikolic were friends?

8 A I knew that they knew each other in a professional context.

9 Q Did you know whether Dr. Nesselrodt knew Mr. Epstein?

10 A No, I have no awareness of that.

11 Q So it says -- I'll read it again for you: "You also made it clear to me that I am not to
12 refer to Alice Jacobs as that is another topic that must remain between the two of us." What do
13 you make of that? What do you think that they're talking about?

14 A They? This is a mail from one man to himself that I've never seen before, so --

15 Q What do you think the --

16 A What does it mean when a man sends a mail to himself -- I'm not sure.

17 Q Sure. As it shows in majority exhibit 1, Dr. Nikolic and Mr. Epstein were coordinating
18 on how to deal with you. I appreciate that you are -- we cannot say for certain what the context of
19 this email is given that it was sent from Mr. Epstein to himself. But it is written from the
20 perspective of Dr. Nikolic, and so I will just ask you the question this way: Do you have any reason
21 to believe that anyone would think that there is something about Alice Jacobs that you needed to
22 keep between yourself and Dr. Nikolic?

23 A Well, there was a time when I had an affair with Dr. Jacobs. So that may fit that
24 category.

25 Q Okay. What year did that begin?

1 A Before 2010.

2 Q And this is why I was asking earlier about your other affairs, which, you know, I can
3 appreciate your perspective that you don't believe any of these people to be connected with Jeffrey
4 Epstein, but it seems he was connected to a lot of people, including Dr. Nesselrodt.

5 A As we sit here today, I'm not aware of the connection between Dr. Jacobs and
6 Mr. Epstein.

7 Q Did you ever have a conversation with Dr. Nikolic about your affair with Dr. Jacobs,
8 Dr. Nesselrodt?

9 A No. No.

10 Q How do you believe that he knew that Dr. Nikolic knew about your affair?

11 A He was friends, you know, a consultant to her. So I'm not completely surprised that he
12 might've been aware of it.

13 Q Is it possible that Mr. Epstein heard it directly from Dr. Nesselrodt?

14 A I doubt that very much. As I said, I'm not aware of any connection between Dr. Jacobs
15 and Epstein.

16 Q Did Dr. -- should we call her Dr. Jacobs or Dr. Nesselrodt?

17 A Let's call her Dr. Jacobs.

18 Q Did Dr. Jacobs, did her name come up in any of the discussions with regard to
19 Dr. Nikolic's departure from his employment?

20 A Never.

21 Q Was your affair with Dr. Jacobs -- did you disclose your affair with Dr. Jacobs to your
22 wife Melinda at the same time you disclosed the two we've already talked about?

23 A That would've been earlier.

24 Q So your wife, Melinda, was aware of the affair with Dr. Jacobs earlier, and then you told
25 her of the two additional affairs at a later date?

1 A That's right.

2 Q Do you recall when approximately you informed your wife about your affair with
3 Dr. Jacobs?

4 A No.

5 Q Did Dr. Nikolic know that Melinda was aware of this affair?

6 A I don't know.

7 Q Thank you. And so, just looking at this email in its entirety, I think you've already used
8 the word "blackmail." I was going to ask you, in reading it, it strikes me as like sort of a shakedown
9 of you. I didn't read the whole thing to you, but there's that long part where the email describes
10 what it is that it wishes you would have done for Boris, including, you know, 30 to 40 percent of
11 \$100 million partnership for \$30 million in today's dollars?

12 A Where are you reading? Yeah, there you are.

13 Q Above that it also says, "I suggest I buy you the house that you so had your heart set
14 on." Did discussions of you purchasing a house for Dr. Nikolic ever come up during negotiations
15 with him?

16 A Not in the negotiations with him, but while he was in my employ, I was aware there was
17 a place in New York he was looking at buying, and he asked me if I would loan him money for that,
18 and I turned him down.

19 Q Do you know the approximate value of that?

20 A No, it could've been -- it was above \$10 million.

21 Q Above \$10 million. Apologies for going out of order here, but, again, just above that
22 30 to 40 percent line and above -- just above that 30 to 40 percent line, it says, "and in addition to
23 5 years of severance." Was there ever a discussion of providing Dr. Nikolic 5 years of his pay as part
24 of his severance?

25 A No.

1 Q Do you know what Dr. Nikolic's annual compensation was approximately?

2 A I would be guessing, you know, above \$100,000, probably below \$200,000.

3 Q So 5 years would be between \$500,000 and \$1 million is what this email is describing in
4 terms of a severance payment?

5 A Well, independent of the email, I can multiply five times \$100,000 and \$200,000 very
6 quickly. So it'd be between \$500,000 and \$1 million.

7 Q And were there any discussions with Dr. Nikolic about a severance payment between
8 \$500,000 and \$1 million?

9 A No.

10 Q I know you've already described it a little bit, but can you explain what the ultimate
11 dollar value of Dr. Nikolic's severance package was?

12 A Well, the biggest economic thing between Dr. Nikolic and Gates Ventures was the
13 sharing of the profit from the two investments that he made. And, you know, we had agreed to
14 share the profits on those investments before he left. That was part of his saying he was going to
15 go to Venture Capital, and my saying, "Okay, why don't you stay for a little longer, and we'll almost
16 do like, you know, almost venture capital type things," which was, you know, very unusual. I didn't
17 do that with employees.

18 And so, you know, his portion of those investments was substantial because I had quite a bit
19 of profit from the investments that were made. And so there's that part, which is not due to his
20 leaving; that was because of the prior verbal agreement between Dr. Nikolic and I. Beyond that, I
21 think he got a fairly standard exit package, which would have been on the order of 6 to 9 months of
22 compensation.

23 Q So fair to say under \$1 million?

24 A For the extra compensation, yes. But the value of the stocks was, you know,
25 substantial, over \$5 million.

1 Mr. Spectre. Ms. Boebert, do you have some questions?

2 Ms. Boebert. Thank you.

3 Thank you, Mr. Gates, for being here today. I have a couple of questions about your
4 involvement with Mr. Epstein in relation to the scientific studies that you were both -- that you work
5 on and that he is intrigued by. Mr. Gates, Epstein was deeply involved in eugenics transhumanism
6 and plans to propagate his own DNA through genetic engineering. During your multiple meetings,
7 did he ever discuss his genetic ambitions, population engineering ideas, or try to tie them to your
8 foundations, vaccine, and Global Health initiatives?

9 Mr. Gates. He did not.

10 Ms. Boebert. None of that ever came up, the talk of vaccines?

11 Mr. Gates. Never came up.

12 Ms. Boebert. Okay. And then so, given Epstein's Harvard genome project involvement
13 with CRISPR, C-R-I-S-P-R, interests around the same time as your meetings, did he ever pitch any
14 ideas with that program to you for DNA research?

15 Mr. Gates. No.

16 Ms. Boebert. Were there ever any other meetings with anyone in his circle that talked
17 about any kind of scientific DNA research that was taking place or vaccines with your Global Health
18 initiative?

19 Mr. Gates. No.

20 Ms. Boebert. When you first started interacting with Jeffrey Epstein -- you are notably one
21 of the most powerful men in the world, and I would say that you have a vast amount of resources.
22 How was there not a vetting process for this relationship to begin, and were there red flags that you
23 had ignored completely or just were completely unaware of?

24 Mr. Gates. Well, I was aware that he had a criminal conviction, as I've discussed.

25 Ms. Boebert. Correct. Because is it true that you began a more formal relationship with

1 Jeffrey Epstein after that conviction?

2 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I think his conviction was in 2008 or 2009, and I first meet him in 2011.

3 Ms. Boebert. Correct. And so, with that criminal conviction, it was enough for him to say
4 that this was a lie or that you would believe that he was innocent in some manner and continue
5 having these meetings with him?

6 Mr. Gates. We didn't discuss his criminal conviction.

7 Ms. Boebert. And it didn't bother you that you were doing business, philanthropy work with
8 a man that had these convictions?

9 Mr. Gates. It was a concern and part of the reason that I defined his potential role quite
10 narrowly and eventually brought it to an end. But I have regret that I didn't factor that into a
11 greater degree.

12 Ms. Boebert. So you never discussed his criminal convictions whatsoever with him?

13 Mr. Gates. No.

14 Ms. Boebert. What were the discussions during your meetings?

15 Mr. Gates. Which meeting?

16 Ms. Boebert. Well, okay, let's take it back. How many meetings overall do you think that
17 you had in person with Jeffrey Epstein?

18 Mr. Gates. Let's see, there were three in 2011 and two in 2012. There's like five or
19 six -- although some of those are Skype calls -- in 2013, and five or six in 2014.

20 Ms. Boebert. Thank you for that detailed response, and I know that you've mentioned that
21 earlier, at least in part. Were the topics generally the same during all of those meetings? I'm
22 aware that you said that sometimes it would've been a year, and so you were kind of recapping what
23 you had been doing for the previous year. But, generally, what were the topics of these meetings?

24 Mr. Gates. Well, I would differentiate -- you know, clearly there were meetings that had to
25 do with Dr. Nikolic's leaving Gates Ventures' employ. There were mostly meetings that talked

1 about the potential for billions of philanthropic donations. Then a number of those meetings there
2 were other people. So like, when Larry Summers is there, we're talking about the economy and
3 what's going on with that; likewise, Jes Staley was at that same dinner.

4 When the two Norwegians are there, we're talking about what's gone on with the United
5 Nations and what's going on in world affairs very generally. You know, so there were a variety of
6 topics, including me talking about my goals in Global Health.

7 Ms. Boebert. So you were talking about your goals in Global Health, and was Epstein ever
8 intrigued and inquiring more about this, and did he ever offer up his own information that he had
9 been studying?

10 Mr. Gates. To my awareness, he wasn't somebody who knew much about Global Health.
11 You know, when he would talk about the various topics that he was a dilettante on, Global Health
12 was never one of those.

13 Ms. Boebert. I guess Global Health, that could be broad. So your meetings with Epstein
14 overlapped with your heavy push on this global vaccines and population-related initiative. And so
15 you're saying that Epstein never had any discussions with you or influenced those areas even
16 indirectly through his network?

17 Mr. Gates. Okay, let's be clear. What initiative are you referring to?

18 Ms. Boebert. Well, your Global Health initiatives, your massive push for vaccines and
19 population-related initiatives.

20 Mr. Gates. What's the connection -- there's no connection. So I'm not understanding what
21 you're referring to. There are vaccines, and we're a funder of GAVI that buys vaccines for children,
22 you know, which is the primary reason childhood death has gone from 10 million a year down to
23 below 5 million a year. That has nothing to do with population.

24 Ms. Boebert. Okay. Well, commas between those topics. So, okay, were you ever talking
25 with him about those vaccines, and did he have any influence in those areas?

1 Mr. Gates. No.

2 Ms. Boebert. Okay. It's just a little difficult because we have powerful people, like
3 yourself, that are claiming they didn't know anything about Epstein's activities that were happening,
4 even if aware of conviction, it wasn't enough of an issue to separate business or personal or have
5 meetings whatsoever, despite, you know, these years of association, people in these powerful
6 positions are saying they absolutely knew nothing. And, as someone who prides himself --

7 Mr. Gates. I can only speak for myself.

8 Ms. Boebert. Correct. Yes, sir. And as someone who prides himself on data and
9 evidence, I just -- I don't know how you explain missing that the victims and court records show that
10 this was going on for so long.

11 Mr. Gates. What was going on for so long?

12 Ms. Boebert. All of Epstein's sex crimes.

13 Mr. Gates. I was not aware of any ongoing crimes.

14 Ms. Boebert. Okay. I think that's all the questions I have for now. Thank you, Mr. Gates.

15 Mr. Moran. And, before we go, Mr. Gates referred to an email exchange where he
16 conveyed to Jeffrey Epstein that, you know, regardless of what Boris was going to say, he wasn't
17 going to change the terms of the deal. We tracked down Bates No. for that, so that's EFTA
18 01964053.

19 Mr. Spectre. Thank you.

20 Mr. Moran. Yeah.

21 Mr. Spectre. Mr. Gates, in the interest of time, I'm going to try not to introduce too many
22 different things here. So I'll try to structure the questions in a way that we can do that, but just let
23 me know if we need to. We discussed earlier that a meeting occurred with Epstein present in
24 Washington. You mentioned that earlier, and I think I told you that our DOJ records indicated that
25 happened on August 8, 2013. Does that sound about right to you?

1 Mr. Moran. Sorry, you said in D.C. or in Washington State?

2 BY MR. SPECTRE:

3 Q Sorry, excuse me, in Seattle.

4 A Yeah, the two Washingtons.

5 Q I call this one D.C.

6 A Yeah, my chronology shows that a meeting took place in Washington State.

7 Q Who else was at this meeting?

8 A You know, I think this is a case where Epstein flew out to Seattle and came to the Gates
9 Ventures office, and so he would've seen both myself and Larry Cohen as part of his being out there.
10 I don't know if Dr. Nikolic was there or not.

11 Q What do you recall about the meeting? What was discussed?

12 A I think that meeting was entirely focused on the terms of Dr. Nikolic's exit.

13 Q And was this a meeting where Mr. Epstein was trying yet again to get additional
14 compensation for Dr. Nikolic and you were refusing? Is that a fair generalization of it?

15 A That's the outcome, yes, that he, despite, you know, sort of veiled things like saying we
16 should remain friends, you know, I had not asked him to be involved in these exit negotiations, and
17 so it was, in the end, kind of a worthless meeting.

18 Mr. Spectre. I'll introduce as majority exhibit 4, this is an email chain.

19 [Gates Majority Exhibit No. 4
20 was marked for identification.]

21 BY MR. SPECTRE:

22 Q The first email, which is at the bottom -- pass this out -- yeah. The first email, which is
23 at the bottom, is from Friday, August 9, 2013, at 10:47 p.m. The Bates No. is EFTA 01959891. So
24 that first email at the bottom again is from Boris Nikolic to Bill Gates, cc Larry Cohen. Subject,
25 "Jeffrey-thank you." The message is on the backside of the page that was passed out. It says,

1 "Bill, yesterday was very difficult for both of us. It would be great if you could write Jeffrey a
2 thank-you note as he flew out here to try to help, and I think he did. I thanked him with my deepest
3 gratitude. I know he saved me. I think he saved us both. Boris."

4 So, given your description of what happened, what do you make of that? Did Mr. Epstein
5 save you and Dr. Nikolic in some way?

6 A He did not.

7 Q What do you think Boris meant by this?

8 A I don't know. I think, at some point, Boris realized that introducing Epstein was a
9 mistake. But, you know, he had asked me, when Epstein did get involved, to send an email to
10 Epstein, which I did, and then here he asks me to send an email to him thanking him, which I went
11 ahead and did.

1 [1:41 p.m.]

2 BY MR. SPECTRE:

3 Q Again, Dr. Nikolic says, "he flew out here to try to help. And I think he did." And your
4 testimony today has sort of been the opposite; it's that Jeffrey Epstein's involvement in these
5 negotiations were useless and accomplished nothing.

6 A Yeah. It's completely provable, because the offer to Boris is the same. What he ends
7 up with is the same, so you know, that's just black and white facts.

8 Q The next email, so the middle email on the first page, you respond to Dr. Nikolic, with
9 Larry Cohen cc'd again. You say, "I agree. Jeffrey was quite helpful and he put in a lot of time in.
10 Without him it would have been harder. I will send him a thank you."

11 So it seems like you're saying something a little different in this email than what you're saying
12 right now. Is that fair?

13 A I would -- I was willing to go along with the narrative that Jeffrey had been helpful. I
14 wanted to get the thing closed. You know, I had decided that Dr. Nikolic should leave my employ.
15 He wanted to say that we made progress. I knew that the offer on the table, I wanted Dr. Nikolic to
16 accept that. So I don't feel these comments were made in sincerity but in the furtherance of, hey,
17 this is Boris' mindset, he now feels good, I -- I think you should bring forward the other email that we
18 referred to because that would give you very helpful context.

19 Q So you said, though, you did ultimately send Mr. Epstein a thank you.

20 A As I was asked to do, yes.

21 Q I'm trying not to flood you with more paper here, so I'll just ask about it generally. Do
22 you recall what you -- what the nature of the thank you was?

23 A I said thank you. I mean, Boris -- both at the start of Epstein's involvement and at the
24 end, he asked me to send an email, which may have actually been my very first email to Mr. Epstein,
25 was the initiation of his involvement in Dr. Nikolic's exit.

1 Q In this thank you email that you sent to Mr. Epstein, you make reference to structuring
2 the payment as a gift and you're discussing how you paid gift taxes on it. Is it your recollection that
3 the severance payment to Dr. Nikolic was structured as a gift? Is that --

4 A No. No. You're confusing something that's absolutely separate.

5 Q Okay.

6 A No connection with Dr. Nikolic's exit. At the time that Dr. Nikolic came to work at the
7 Gates Foundation, he had some ongoing consulting agreements, so this is 5 years, 6 years earlier.
8 And I made, at that time, so that Boris could walk away from those things without a net loss, I made a
9 half million dollar gift to Dr. Nikolic. But that's like 6 years earlier before -- certainly before I met
10 Epstein and I believe before Dr. Nikolic had met Epstein.

11 The reason that came up in the exit discussions was Epstein, having apparently heard about
12 that payment from 6 years ago, tried to insert some doubt about how the taxes hadn't been paid on
13 that. And this was not the only time, but this is where he tried to insert himself as, hey, I could give
14 you tax advice, why don't you send me documents.

15 And, you know, you probably should show me the email, because I was very black and white
16 that I'm the most careful about paying taxes of anyone I know. I have great professionals. I was
17 not going to send him any tax documents. That was structured as a gift. I paid a gift tax. And so
18 we're talking about a half million that's nothing to do with this exit agreement at all.

19 Q Okay. That is helpful context, and for the record, that is what you say at the end of the
20 email. You say, "I will bet I am more careful about gift taxes than almost any other taxpayer."

21 A Yeah. I believe that in my \$14 billion of tax payments, I probably paid more gift taxes
22 than others.

23 Q More than me.

24 Mr. Moran. And I'll just note that the same email ending in Bates number 053 that we
25 referenced earlier contains some of that same exchange about the tax treatment issue as well.

1 Mr. Spectre. Okay.

2 BY MR. SPECTRE:

3 Q Mr. Gates, I want to talk a little bit -- I know we've already talked about it, and I'll try to
4 be brief and not go back over too many of the same things, but the three extramarital affairs that
5 we've now discussed in today's interview. For the first one, I'll -- so Mila Antonova. If it's all right
6 with you, I can refer to her as the bridge player. Is that -- or I can call her Ms. Antonova.

7 A That's fine. Fine.

8 Q I think you said earlier, but do you recall when you first met her?

9 A At a bridge tournament.

10 Q And where was this bridge tournament?

11 A I'm not sure.

12 Q And it was prior to meeting Jeffrey Epstein?

13 A Yes.

14 Q And when -- do you recall when you learned that Ms. Antonova had some sort of
15 interaction with Jeffrey Epstein?

16 A It would have been when he sent mail suggesting that he had reimbursed her or paid for
17 something in connec- -- in relationship to her.

18 Q And this was years -- a couple years after you'd ceased communications with Mr.
19 Epstein. Is that correct?

20 A No. No. It's right at the end or soon after the end. No, I think it's right after the
21 end that he sends an email. And most of the emails he sent me were after I never talked to him
22 again, because he made many attempts to reengage. But he sent me mail about those
23 reimbursements, and then I went to Larry Cohen, who communicated that I didn't feel it was
24 appropriate or I was under any obligation to reimburse him for what he may have done.

25 Q Did anyone else -- who else may have known about your affair -- about this affair?

1 A I don't know who.

2 Q Boris Nikolic, Jeffrey Epstein, and eventually you told your wife. Did anyone else
3 during that period, intervening period, know about it, as far as you know?

4 A Not that I'm aware of. Maybe a therapist, but I guess I can exclude my discussions
5 with therapists.

6 Q And then same sort of questions for Ms. Nigmatulina, the nuclear physicist, as we've
7 discussed earlier. I think when you've talked about this publicly, you said that you met her through
8 business activities. Is that right?

9 A That's right.

10 Q What sort of business activities?

11 A She worked on both disease modeling and nuclear fission work, and I met her in
12 connection with that.

13 Q Work that the Gates Foundation was involved with overlapped with her work?

14 A No, it's not Gates Foundation work. It's work that -- it was either TerraPower work or
15 work that I funded, not connected to the foundation.

16 Q For the record, what is TerraPower?

17 A It's a nuclear fission -- fourth-generation nuclear fission company.

18 Q That you fund or --

19 A I'm a substantial investor in TerraPower.

20 Q Did Ms. Nigmatulina work directly for TerraPower at all?

21 A Yes. I'm a little confused about when she worked on the disease modeling project and
22 when she did some work for TerraPower. I think they may have even overlapped, but after she
23 finished both of those pieces of work is when our affair started.

24 Q And do you recall approximately the year that the affair started?

25 A I mean, I -- I can find out.

1 Q Was it prior to you meeting Jeffrey Epstein?

2 A No, I should look. The only time -- the time I became aware he knew about that affair
3 was when the Epstein files were released this year.

4 Q That's when you found out that Mr. Epstein was aware of this affair, is what you're
5 saying?

6 A Right. In those emails to himself, among the true and false things that he stuck in
7 there, in one of those emails he mentions her name.

8 Q But for the record, the way that you met her through these business activities, it had
9 nothing to do with Jeffrey Epstein in any way?

10 A Nothing. Not in any way.

11 Q And you -- did you ever have a conversation with Ms. Nigmatulina about Jeffrey
12 Epstein?

13 A Never.

14 Q And then same sorts of questions for Dr. Jacobs. You may have said and, I'm sorry, but
15 can you remind me what year approximately your affair with her began?

16 A Before 2010.

17 Q So prior to you ever meeting Jeffrey Epstein?

18 A That's right.

19 Q And so you had no awareness of any relationship or of any relationship between her and
20 Mr. Epstein?

21 A That's right.

22 Q And do you have any awareness of her relationship with Mr. Epstein as you sit here
23 today?

24 A I do not.

25 Q I'll ask you the same question for Ms. Antonova. Sitting here today, do you have any

1 additional context or awareness of her interactions with Mr. Epstein besides what we've talked
2 about?

3 A Well, I read in the press several years ago that she commented that she had met Mr.
4 Epstein and that he'd paid some expenses and that she wasn't aware that that was something he was
5 communicating back to me.

6 Q So the only additional awareness you have about her interactions with Mr. Epstein are
7 through public reporting?

8 A Well, he sends me emails, you know, after I've stopped meeting with him. There's a
9 bunch of emails where he's referring to her, even one time purporting that I had asked him to do
10 these things, which is false. But there's a number of emails from him relating to the woman we're
11 calling the bridge player.

12 Q And I'll ask you the same question for Ms. Nigmatulina. Do you have any other
13 knowledge today about her interactions with or communications with Jeffrey Epstein?

14 A I'd be stunned if there ever were any, so, no, I don't.

15 Q Other than that you now know that he was aware of your affair?

16 A That's right. But that's not communication to her.

17 Q That's correct. I want to talk a little bit more about this blackmail that I think you
18 characterized these draft -- these emails Epstein sent to himself as potential blackmail.

19 A As I see them today, that's, you know, my guess about what he might be thinking about.

20 Q Do you think he was hoping to take a cut of this proposed deal he was offering for Dr.
21 Nikolic?

22 A I'm not aware of that. He may have.

23 Q He never -- did he ever ask you for money directly paid to him or was it always this
24 discussion of money for Dr. Nikolic?

25 A He at one point in kind of a weird email says that I -- he purports that I had said that I

1 was in his debt but that he said I wasn't in his debt. And the truth is I never said he was in his
2 debt -- but despite his saying that he didn't think I was in his debt in that email, he seems to ask for
3 donations to be made in his name to a variety of entities. So that's along those lines of, hey, I
4 helped out with this exit and you owe me even though the email says you don't owe me.

5 Q Did you ever make a donation to any entity in Jeffrey Epstein's name or for him?

6 A Never in his name.

7 Q Did you ever make a donation to any entity that he had asked you to donate to?

8 A Yeah. There's an intersection of the list he sent to me and an institution that I've given
9 to literally for decades through my work at Microsoft, personally and through the foundation, which
10 is MIT. And I did make a \$2 million donation to MIT, I think -- well, I made it -- we can get the
11 date -- during -- overlapping during the -- this period that I knew Epstein.

12 Q Was that donation related in any way to Mr. Epstein or are you saying it's happenstance
13 since you'd already been donating to them?

14 A I'd say the timing was somewhat related; that is, I've given to MIT many times. There's
15 a building there. You know, there's some ongoing medical work, which is absolutely fantastic. But
16 I gave a 2 million donation without, you know, mentioning Mr. Epstein's name, you know, not related
17 to any program he was involved in. And so that was the primary purpose was to help MIT.

18 As a secondary thing, I did tell Mr. Epstein about that donation, hoping that that might factor
19 into his no longer coming to me and asking for donations in his name, which is something I'd been
20 clear I was not going to do.

21 Q So, just to be clear, the donation to MIT was not in response to any blackmail or threats
22 that Mr. Epstein made?

23 A No. The primary purpose was to get resources to MIT who had always used my gifts in
24 a very effective way. There was a secondary thing that I told Epstein about it hoping that would
25 bring to an end this weird set of emails where he acted like I should make a donation in his name.

1 Mr. Grant. And did MIT ever discuss Jeffrey Epstein with you at any point during this
2 donation process?

3 Mr. Gates. No. No. In fact, they did an investigation to make sure that the donation was
4 not Epstein related and found that it was not.

5 Mr. Grant. And did they talk to you as part of that investigation?

6 Mr. Gates. Yes.

7 BY MR. SPECTRE:

8 Q Again, I'll try to avoid too much paper, but a representative for you and the media said
9 that, "Mr. Gates met with Epstein solely for philanthropic purposes. Having failed repeatedly to
10 draw Mr. Gates beyond these matters, Epstein tried unsuccessfully to leverage a past relationship to
11 threaten Mr. Gates."

12 So let's talk about that last part first, he tried unsuccessfully to leverage a past relationship.
13 Is that the three affairs we've discussed or is it something else?

14 A The -- Dr. Jacobs never came up with Mr. Epstein in any way, shape, or form, so it
15 certainly doesn't refer to that. As I said, the -- during that exit period, there was never an explicit,
16 hey, if you don't do something, I will reveal this. There was the veiled type of language, hey, we
17 should all want to be friends. And as I've said, I took that on very explicitly and said, look, if you
18 think you're going to get more money out of this, it's not going to happen, and if that means you go
19 out and talk to people about things, I will just bear the pain of that and deal with it.

20 And so I was -- I was not blackmailed, but, you know, as you look at these emails, you know, it
21 looks like Mr. Epstein's brainstorming was going in that direction.

22 Q And just to be clear, the past relationship that he unsuccessfully tried to leverage, what
23 that refers to is the thinly veiled threats we've already discussed over the course of today's
24 interview?

25 A Relative to the bridge player and the nuclear -- well, at the time, I mean, I wasn't sure

1 what it referred to, but I had to assume there was some chance that the two affairs that Boris was
2 aware of, that he had communicated that to Mr. Epstein.

3 Q And just to clarify also, the beginning part of that statement, "Mr. Gates met with
4 Epstein solely for philanthropic purposes." As we've discussed today, you also met with Mr. Epstein
5 with regard to this dispute with this negotiation with Dr. Nikolic. Is that right?

6 A Yeah. And there were dinners where the philanthropic thing would have come up but
7 wouldn't have necessarily -- you know, when Jes Staley or Larry Summers was there, these U.N.
8 people that I'm meeting for the first time, we would discuss other topics. So the primary topic of
9 the times I spent with Mr. Epstein were my attempt to raise billions for global health, but the -- there
10 were other things, including Dr. Nikolic's exit. You know, when he comes out in August, I doubt we
11 discussed global health at that meeting. I think that was solely focused on this exit.

12 Q And just to be clear, the statement says that you solely met with Mr. Epstein for
13 philanthropic purposes, so that's not true then, right?

14 A I -- it's -- the correct summary would be to say that's the primary reason that I met with
15 him, you know. So if a report is oversimplified, that's a mistake.

16 Q And, again, you've said that you were not blackmailed, and I think maybe what you
17 mean is you were not successfully blackmailed, but it seems to me like Mr. Epstein was trying really
18 hard to blackmail you.

19 A If those emails that contained some truth and some false things were ever sent, then we
20 could say there was an attempt at blackmail. That never happened. You know, I don't know if Dr.
21 Nikolic ever saw those, but I certainly never saw those. Those would have been -- then it would
22 have been black and white that that's what they were attempting to do.

23 What actually happened is they made veiled references that, because of that, you know, I
24 explicitly raised the idea that their disclosing whatever they knew about me, that I would deal with
25 that, and I was not going to raise the offer because of my concerns about what might be behind

1 those veiled references.

2 Q I think that that's correct when you look back at majority exhibit 1 and in the emails that
3 are open discussions between Mr. Epstein and Dr. Nikolic about, you know, an email they might send
4 you to, again, that they ultimately did not. It is more thinly veiled. It only references, as we
5 discussed earlier, sensitive information and a dilemma and trust. It's these thinly veiled threats. Is
6 that kind of what you're talking about, that sort of language?

7 A I think you're referring to an email that I'm not copied on.

8 Q You are not copied on the email, that's correct.

9 A Yeah.

10 Mr. Moran. Is that the type of statement --

11 Mr. Gates. That is the type of statement that Epstein made.

12 Mr. Spectre. Okay. That is -- we will go off the record.

13 [Recess.]

14 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

15 Q Good afternoon, Mr. Gates.

16 A Good afternoon.

17 Q When we left off during our last round together, we were proceeding through the
18 chronology of your meetings with Mr. Epstein. I'd like to continue doing that, if I could.

19 But first, just to step back in time to 2011, and this would be your first meeting with Mr.
20 Epstein at his home in January of 2011. It was reported in Forbes magazine that after visiting
21 Epstein for the first time, you told colleagues in an email the next day that Epstein's -- and I'm
22 quoting from the article -- lifestyle is very different and kind of intriguing, although it would not work
23 for me, unquote. Do you recall telling colleagues that after your initial visit?

24 A Yeah. I sent an email to one person saying that.

25 Q Who was that person?

1 A Dr. Walker.

2 Q And what did you mean by different and intriguing?

3 A Well, as you said, that was the first time I'd ever met Epstein, and during that dinner
4 meeting, he referred to a lot of scientists and economists that he would spend time talking to. You
5 know, I never followed up to see, you know, particularly given what I know about his credibility now,
6 which of those were real and not real. But, you know, my first impression was that he took time
7 being kind of a dilettante, a lot of different science and economic areas, and, you know, I picked
8 particular areas to focus in, software while I was at Microsoft, and global health and education at the
9 foundation.

10 And so, yes, I made the remark that it was -- what I'd heard from him was intriguing but not
11 for me.

12 Q Appreciate that. And then stepping ahead in time, again, back to 2014. Just
13 generally, do you have a recollection of the meetings that you had with Jeffrey Epstein during that
14 year?

15 A I know the last two -- if we want to go through all of them, I should refresh my
16 recollection.

17 Q I think before you do that, I will show you another exhibit, and this will be exhibit F.
18 This is yet another email setting forth Jeffrey Epstein's schedule from September 2014. It refers to
19 some specific meetings I'd like to ask you about.

20 [Gates Minority Exhibit F
21 was marked for identification.]

22 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

23 Q So looking at the first entry at the top of the email from September 8th, 2014, there is a
24 notation for a 10 a.m. meeting with you and Tom Pritzker at the Park Hyatt in New York. Do you
25 recall that meeting?

1 A Yes.

2 Q Okay. What was the purpose of that meeting?

3 A Well, as we got into late 2013 and 2014 and Epstein was focusing on more of the
4 structure of how these purported donations would be handled, I, particularly after fall of 2013, put a
5 lot more pressure on him to identify specifically, you know, which Wall Street or Middle East or other
6 billionaires did he really think were going to make these large donations because, you know, very few
7 people give money to global health and I, you know, wanted to see was he stringing me out or was
8 this legitimate. And in response to that, he said, oh, yeah, there's a bunch, let me set up some
9 meetings with some of the people who may do this giving.

10 And so this series of meetings on September 5th, this is the second to last time that I ever
11 spend time with Epstein, but it's the first time that it's getting concrete that, hey, if this is going to
12 happen, here are the people or some of the people. And he still referred to the Middle East and
13 said, you know, they might be available later, but that didn't amount to anything. So we met with
14 several people on September 5th in New York City.

15 Q And I'll walk through each of these meetings set forth in this exhibit in more detail.
16 But, overall, you know, the first entry, as I noted, refers to a meeting with Tom Pritzker. There's
17 another referring to Leon Black, another to Larry Summers, another to Mort Zuckerman, and another
18 with Kathy Ruemmler.

19 What was your overall assessment at the conclusion of this series of meetings? Were you
20 satisfied that the prospect of securing funding was becoming more concrete or did it still remain
21 nebulous and inchoate in your mind?

22 A Yeah. To be clear, I never saw Larry Summers on this day.

23 Q Sure. And I'll get to that one.

24 A Okay.

25 Q But, yeah, I appreciate the clarification.

1 A No, unfortunately, although these were friendly meetings and, you know, I talked about
2 Gavi and Global Fund and lots of things in global health where lives are being saved, you know, for
3 less than \$2,000 per life saved, it didn't appear any of these people -- the Kathy Ruemmler meeting is
4 of a different nature, which we can talk about, but she was not a potential giver. The other men I
5 met that day were presented as potential givers, and they were very polite, you know, praising the
6 work I was doing in global health, but they clearly -- none of them was at a point where they were
7 deciding to give large additional sums in general and not to global health. They were polite enough
8 to say that, you know, maybe when they got around to doing their full giving plans, they might think
9 about it, but it was a complete disappointment from my point of view, even though it was all very
10 friendly.

11 Q Looking at the second meeting reflected in this schedule, which is an 11:30 meeting at
12 Leon Black's office, did that meeting take place?

13 A Yes, it did.

14 Q Okay. And had you previously met Mr. Black?

15 A I had not.

16 Q Do you have an understanding as to Jeffrey Epstein's relationship with Leon Black?

17 A No. To this day, I find that somewhat unclear.

18 Q Did he make any representations to you in that regard?

19 A Well, Mr. Epstein came along for these meetings, and -- so, you know, Mr. Epstein didn't
20 speak up much in these meetings because it was kind of a chance for me to poll the person about,
21 hey, how are they thinking of philanthropy broadly and did -- you know, were they going to do
22 something substantial and was global health a potential area to give to. And we met a
23 few -- doesn't show it here, but we met a few other people in that office, the Apollo offices where
24 that meeting took place.

25 Q And do you recall who those people were?

1 A We met with Josh Harris for a period. I think I got that name right.

2 Q Anyone else?

3 A No. I mean, there were people around, but the two specific meetings I remember
4 were with Leon Black first and then Josh, a shorter meeting with him later.

5 Q Did you ever become aware of Leon Black engaging in any sort of a sexual relationship
6 with any women or girls connected to Jeffrey Epstein?

7 A No.

8 Q The next meeting in exhibit F is a 12 p.m. meeting with Larry Summers. If I understood
9 you correctly, that meeting did not happen?

10 A Yeah. I don't know anything about that. I never heard his name in connection with
11 the agenda for this day.

12 Q And then the following entry refers to a 2 p.m. meeting with Mort Zuckerman. Did
13 that meeting happen?

14 A Yes.

15 Q Okay. And according to this entry, it took place, if I'm reading it correctly, either at Mr.
16 Gates' residence or at the Four Seasons. Do you recall the location?

17 A It was not at Mr. Epstein's residence is my recollection. I think it was at the Four
18 Seasons.

19 Q And had you previously met Mr. Zuckerman?

20 A I had not.

21 Q Okay. And do you recall the discussion at that meeting?

22 A It was about his philanthropic thinking, and like the others, he was polite and praised
23 the work I was doing without showing a near-term interest in giving substantial sums to global
24 health.

25 Q Was anyone else present at that meeting?

1 A I think Mr. Epstein sat in on that meeting.

2 Q And finally, in this calendar entry, a 3 to 3:30 p.m. meeting with Kathy Ruemmler at the
3 Four Seasons. I take it that meeting did take place?

4 A It did.

5 Q Okay. But you mentioned that that one was not focused on a prospective donation.

6 A That's right.

7 Q Okay. So what was the subject of that meeting?

8 A I'm not quite sure why he added her to the calendar this day. I gave him some
9 discretion on that. I think that meeting, as I recall it, talked about politics and the Trump
10 administration. I think it was more talking about what was going on politically. You know, he may
11 have been working towards suggesting I involve her in some of my work in some way, but that never
12 happened.

13 Oh, sorry, I referred to -- it would have talked about political things, but this is during the
14 Obama Presidency. So it certainly didn't refer to Trump, because I didn't anticipate his future
15 Presidency.

16 Q Thank you. It's my understanding that your former wife had reservations about Jeffrey
17 Epstein and your interaction with him. Is that accurate?

18 A Definitely.

19 Q Did it ever enter your mind or did you ever become aware of Jeffrey Epstein using or
20 attempting to use Kathy Ruemmler to try and assuage those concerns?

21 A My ex-wife Melinda I don't believe ever met with or talked to Kathy Ruemmler.

22 Q No further questions on this exhibit. Thank you.

23 I will, finally, ask the court reporter to mark as exhibit G an email dated January 13th, 2019,
24 from Jeffrey Epstein to you, Bates number EFTAR101795558.

25 [Gates Minority Exhibit G

1 was marked for identification.]

2 Mr. Gates. Which one is it?

3 Mr. [REDACTED]: It's this one.

4 Mr. Gates. Okay.

5 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

6 Q Mr. Gates, have you seen this email before?

7 A I don't think so, no. There came a time where I no longer looked at email from Mr.
8 Epstein to me, and this is in 2019, and my last contact with him was in 2014.

9 Q I'll just read the text of this brief email for the record. "Dec 3rd, 2013, comma, in
10 Wash, D.C., meeting, equal sign, at airport. Larry said you have no recollection or at least he was
11 not aware of your request and our conversations. Odd."

12 Looking at this email today, do you have any understanding as to what meeting Mr. Epstein
13 was referring to here?

14 A Well, I did -- let me look at the chronology to doublecheck this, but I do think I had a
15 meeting with Epstein at the National Airport FBO on that date.

16 Q And do you recall the subject of that meeting?

17 A That would have been about the philanthropic work. I was in D.C. for other reasons.
18 He was asking to meet with me. I was getting on a plane there, and there's a conference room
19 there that we went in and had a fairly brief conversation.

20 Q Do you understand the Larry referred to in the body of this email as Larry Cohen?

21 A Okay. I'm guessing, but, yes, the only thing that would make sense is that that would
22 be Larry Cohen.

23 Q Do you have a recollection of discussing with Mr. Cohen at or about this time your
24 previous interactions with Jeffrey Epstein?

25 A Well, as I've gone through the emails that came out in January, it looks like Epstein was

1 trying to suggest that I had some connection to the payments he made with respect to the bridge
2 player and seemed to be saying to Larry, not in this email, but I think in some prior thing that I saw,
3 that I had requested him to make those payments, and that is completely false.

4 Q And, again, looking at this email as you sit here today, do you understand this
5 communication from Jeffrey Epstein to be part of that context, part of the general --

6 A It could be. I'd be speculating, but it's consistent with that idea.

7 Q All right. Nothing further on this exhibit.

8 Ms. [REDACTED]: Mr. Gates, you have mentioned a couple times today photos that were taken of
9 you and various Epstein assistants and associates. We have some of those photos that were
10 produced to us by Epstein's estate, so we're going to show you some of those and ask you a few
11 questions.

12 Mr. Gates. Okay.

13 Ms. [REDACTED]: I'll start by introducing minority exhibits H and I.

14 [Gates Minority Exhibits H and I
15 were marked for identification.]

16 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

17 Q Mr. Gates, I believe these are both photos of you and a woman named [REDACTED]

18 [REDACTED]. Is that correct?

19 A I have no idea what her name is.

20 Q You were never introduced to her?

21 A I was not.

22 Q But you met her on presumably both of these occasions and others. You were
23 introduced by Epstein. Is that correct?

24 A No. I never met her.

25 Q But you -- but you're standing next to her.

1 A That is correct.

2 Q So it was just for the photo?

3 A At the end of the meeting that -- I don't know if this is the same woman -- and there's
4 both redacted and unredacted versions of this photo. This one I can say is at the National Airport
5 FBO on -- after the December 3rd meeting that I just discussed with your colleague, that at the end of
6 that meeting, she was with Epstein, and as I walked out down this hallway, you can see it says
7 "signature" there, he asked that I take a photo with her, and he took a photo.

8 Mr. [REDACTED]: And, Mr. Gates, for the record, you're describing exhibit H.

9 Ms. [REDACTED]: Yes.

10 Mr. Gates. It says H.

11 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

12 Q So could you just remind us what year this was.

13 A That was 2013, December 3rd, 2013.

14 Q To your recollection, was this the first time you ever encountered her?

15 A I have no idea, but I never spent any meaningful time. I don't recognize her. I was
16 never introduced to her.

17 Q Understood. And then looking at exhibit I, it's another photo of -- I will represent it's
18 the same woman. Where was this photo taken?

19 A Can we look at the chronology? We believe this was taken at the end of a meeting on
20 February 27th, 2013, after a meeting at the Four Seasons.

21 Q Was there anyone else there?

22 A Oh, yeah. There's Epstein and other people, Dr. Nikolic.

23 Q The other people that were attending that meeting.

24 A She was not in the meeting, but at the end of the meeting, this is another case where he
25 asked me to take a photo with one of his assistants, which I did.

1 Q Epstein asked you to?

2 A Yes.

3 Q Did he take the photo?

4 A I think so, yes.

5 Q Understood. And your understanding of their relationship was that she was his
6 administrative assistant. Is that correct?

7 A I knew she came with him and didn't sit in the meeting, and so I made that guess, but I
8 was never told what her connection to Epstein was.

9 Q Understood. And did you ever become aware of Epstein sexually abusing this woman?

10 A No.

11 Q Thank you.

12 I am now going to introduce minority exhibit J.

13 [Gates Minority Exhibit J

14 was marked for identification.]

15 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

16 Q This is a photo of you and a group of individuals. Could you please identify who these
17 people are?

18 A I recognize myself. I don't recognize anyone else in this photo. What do you know
19 about when this was taken?

20 Q I was actually planning to ask you that. We don't have dates with these photos, so --

21 A But do you know who these people are?

22 Q I'm asking you. We are aware that this is the same woman as the previous photos,
23 [REDACTED], but we were hoping that you would identify the other individuals in this photo.

24 Mr. [REDACTED]: Indicating the first woman from the right-hand side of this photo.

25 Mr. Gates. Where is this taken?

1 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

2 Q That is the question that we have for you. We don't have any context when we get
3 these photos. There's no date with them and we aren't aware of where this is being taken. So we
4 were hoping that you could provide some context for us.

5 A I don't recall this photo being taken. I mean, there's kind of distinct stuff in the
6 background. I would assume that if somebody was serious about this, they could figure out where
7 this was taken.

8 Q You have no recollection of being in this room or with these individuals?

9 A No.

10 Q Understood. I will now introduce minority exhibit K.

11 [Gates Minority Exhibit K

12 was marked for identification.]

13 Mr. Moran. Sorry. This has been marked K?

14 Ms. [REDACTED]. K, yes.

15 Mr. Moran. Thank you.

16 Ms. [REDACTED]. Mr. Gates, could you please identify the individuals in this photo?

17 Mr. Gates. It's interesting, all of these are unredacted. On the left is -- I think that's Terje
18 Rod-Larsen. There's a small chance it's Jagland, but that's a Norwegian. Then there's me, then
19 there's one of Epstein's admin assistants, then there's Epstein himself. And we can identify the
20 date -- this is taken, I believe, somewhere in Epstein's New York residence, and this is when after a
21 dinner, David Blaine came over and was doing several magic tricks, and one or two admins stayed
22 while he did those tricks. I was not introduced, so I don't know the name.

23 Mr. [REDACTED]. And, Mr. Gates, just for the record, when you're identifying these individuals,
24 you're moving from left to right across exhibit K.

25 Mr. Gates. That's right. And we think this is after Feb- -- after a dinner February 27, 2013,

1 at Epstein's New York residence.

2 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

3 Q Okay. That makes sense. The only other question I have for you on this photo is you
4 said the admin assistants stayed. They weren't at the dinner and then they came after. Is that
5 correct?

6 A They may have been in another room in the residence. They were not at the dinner.

7 Q And then they came for when Mr. Blaine came.

8 A Well, we went to a different room for the magic trick. That may have been where they
9 had been the whole time. I don't know where they were during the dinner.

10 Q Understood. And this first woman holding the card, I'll represent that that is also
11 [REDACTED] who was in the three previous photos. Are you aware of who the other
12 woman is?

13 A No.

14 Q You weren't introduced to either of them?

15 A I was not.

16 Q Okay. Finally, I will introduce minority exhibit L.

17 [Gates Minority Exhibit L
18 was marked for identification.]

19 BY MS. [REDACTED]:

20 Q Could you please identify the individuals in this photo for me?

21 A Yeah. So the person on the left is me. The person in the middle is Eva Dubin. The
22 person on the right is some friend of Eva Dubin's who I was introduced to, but I don't remember her
23 name.

24 Q Okay. I will represent that that is Karyna Shuliak. That was Epstein's girlfriend at the
25 time.

1 Was this the occasion that you mentioned earlier when Ms. Dubin came to meet you after a
2 meeting?

3 A Yes. This is -- we believe this is in August 20? Is that right? August 20,
4 2011 -- 2012, sorry.

5 Q This is at the Four Seasons. Is that correct?

6 A Yes, I believe so.

7 Q And was this --

8 A After a meeting that they did not attend.

9 Q Was the meeting just and you Mr. Epstein?

10 A No. I think Dr. Nikolic was there.

11 Q Was this the only time that you met Ms. Dubin?

12 A No. Ms. Dubin, you know, she and her husband Glenn are a member of The Giving
13 Pledge. You know, they have a property in North Salem that's near to where my daughter has a
14 property. I've met Eva Dubin at events several times, including, I already mentioned, she came by
15 after the January 31, 2011, the first dinner I had with Mr. Epstein.

16 Q Were those the two occasions that you were with Ms. Dubin and Mr. Epstein together?

17 A That's right.

18 Q Okay.

19 A That was the only times that I saw her in his presence.

20 Q Okay. And did you ever meet this other woman, Ms. Shuliak, ever again? Was this
21 the only time?

22 A I don't believe so.

23 Q Okay. That's all.

24 Mr. [REDACTED]. We're going to have some members ask some questions, but before we do, the
25 members who have just entered the room for the first time, can you please identify yourselves for

1 the record?

2 Mr. Walkinshaw. James Walkinshaw, Virginia's 11th District.

3 Mr. Frost. Maxwell Frost, Florida's 10.

4 Mr. Bell. Wesley Bell, Missouri.

5 Mr. Walkinshaw. Mr. Gates, thank you for being here. And I just want to start by thanking
6 you for your philanthropic work and your work on global health which has saved countless lives.

7 I want to go back. I know there's been some conversation about Melanie Walker. And
8 earlier I know exhibit A was introduced, the article published in The Wall Street Journal on June 7th
9 titled, "The Hidden Figure With Close Ties to Bill Gates and Jeffrey Epstein." And on the bottom of
10 page 4 of that article it reads, Walker has told several people she met Epstein and Trump at the Plaza
11 Hotel in the early 199- -- got it? Okay.

12 Mr. Gates. Yep.

13 Mr. Walkinshaw. -- in the early 1990s after graduating with honors from the University of
14 Texas. In a 2018 email introducing a neurosurgeon to Epstein, she wrote, I've known Jeffrey 28
15 years, and this isn't a joke, Donald Trump introduced us.

16 Did Ms. Walker ever discuss with you her connection to Donald Trump?

17 Mr. Gates. No.

18 Mr. Walkinshaw. So did you have any awareness that Epstein and Ms. Walker were
19 introduced to each other by Donald Trump? Had you ever heard that before you saw this article?

20 Mr. Gates. I have not.

21 Mr. Walkinshaw. Okay. The article also references that Ms. Walker had in her possession
22 potentially embarrassing blue dress emails. On page 9, it describes a back-and-forth between
23 Walker and Epstein apparently, I think, referring to you in September of 2017. The article reads,
24 again on page 9, Walker provided an inventory of her ammunition. Yes, I have blue dress emails
25 and a few other embarrassing things, and, yes, the stories are so eerily similar to all in media that he

1 sounds Weinstein-like. I can't be the only one.

2 Mr. Gates, do you know what these blue dress emails that Ms. Walker is referring to? Do
3 you have any sense of what that is, what they are?

4 Mr. Gates. I think I said earlier the blue dress could be a reference to the Monica Lewinsky
5 affair, but I don't know what a blue dress email would be.

6 Mr. Walkinshaw. Okay. And in your opinion, why do you think Ms. Walker would have
7 shared, potentially, these emails, if they exist, with Mr. Epstein?

8 Mr. Gates. You know, I don't have an explanation for -- that she was in touch with him and
9 saying what she said. I, you know, had a cordial, friendly relationship with Dr. Walker both before
10 and after the time of any of these communications.

11 Mr. Walkinshaw. Okay. Any sense that it may have been part of this Epstein effort to
12 generate leverage or potentially blackmail you perhaps?

13 Mr. Gates. It's possible that Epstein encouraged Dr. Walker to send these emails to him as
14 part of some possible future either blackmail or attempt to reestablish a relationship with me.
15 Remember, this is over 3 years after I completely cut off the relationship, and, you know, it would be
16 consistent with sort of the strange way he was willing to use some truthful things and some lies to try
17 to develop pressure. But I was never made aware of these exchanges and I was not in contact with
18 Epstein in any way, and all of my conversations with Dr. Walker were friendly in nature towards each
19 other. You know, she'd left the foundation, but I continued to talk to her through 2020.

20 Mr. Walkinshaw. Based on what you know now, having maybe reviewed what's in the
21 files -- or some of what's in the files and the reporting around, you know, Epstein's effort perhaps to
22 use the payments he made to gain some leverage over you to achieve the goal perhaps he wanted to
23 achieve, how would you describe -- in your opinion, was he working towards an attempt to blackmail
24 you based on the evidence that we have and what you know and your own knowledge of him and
25 how he operated? Would you use that term?

1 Mr. Gates. No, he never sent me anything that I would call blackmail. As I've said, he
2 made veiled references to things like we should all want to be friends. Now that I see the January
3 release of documents, it appears that in many cases he, at least in emails to himself, was sort of
4 rehearsing how either he or he coaching someone else might choose to blackmail me, but none of
5 those messages were ever sent to me. You know, I never paid Jeffrey Epstein anything. And so it's
6 a bit speculation, but the different things are quite consistent that he would encourage others to try
7 and give him leverage over me, but then that never came to pass.

8 Mr. Walkinshaw. Okay. Because one of the things that I'm wrestling with, and it's not a
9 question for you, but in July of 2025, the Department of Justice issued an unsigned memo in which
10 they said there was no evidence of Epstein blackmailing anyone. And certainly true, based on what
11 we know, he wasn't able to blackmail you, but I think what we have from the files and the reporting
12 seems to suggest he was working towards that or hoping to work towards that.

13 Mr. Gates. He never blackmailed me, but looking at these emails, it raises a serious
14 probability that he contemplated blackmailing me.

15 Mr. Walkinshaw. Yeah. Thank you. That's all I have.

16 Mr. Frost. Thank you.

17 Mr. Gates, why did you choose Jeffrey Epstein specifically to help you with your philanthropy?

18 Mr. Gates. I didn't really choose him. He's the only one who ever came to me and said
19 that he could raise billions or tens of billions of dollars for global health, and that was credible to me,
20 because as I approach people directly about their giving, generally, you know, they're not in the
21 position where they think through retirement, you know, who's going to do giving, what they want to
22 give to their children. And the key time when people think that through is when they're doing their
23 will, you know, how much goes to the children. And then for people who are very rich, hopefully
24 they think of a large sum being available for philanthropy.

25 And it was because of his purported relationship with billionaires or he was part of that tax

1 and will discussion that it seemed credible to me that he might be able to raise or be a referral to
2 help raise billions of dollars for global health.

3 Mr. Frost. So when you say he came to you, did he come to you directly or did he connect
4 with you through somebody else?

5 Mr. Gates. I met him after Dr. Nikolic was -- had met with him. And so I meet him on
6 January 31st, 2011, and then I have a series of meetings with him through 2014.

7 Mr. Frost. Michael Wolff alleges that Jeffrey Epstein advised you on expansion and
8 restructuring of the Gates Foundation. Did Epstein advise you on the Gates Foundation?

9 Mr. Gates. Never.

10 Mr. Frost. There's a Forbes article published on April 8th, 2026, that's titled, quote, "What
11 We Know About Bill Gates' Connection To Jeffrey Epstein -- As Billionaire Prepares To Testify," end
12 quote. And it states, quote, Wolff alleged Epstein had been advising Gates on a vast expansion and
13 restructuring of the Gates Foundation with Epstein proposing a way to leverage the Gates
14 Foundation's resources to accommodate many other fortunes from other billionaires.

15 So are you saying the article's false?

16 Mr. Gates. Completely false. Epstein never ever mentioned to me the organization of the
17 Gates Foundation. It's not something he would have had knowledge of, so it wouldn't have made
18 any sense.

19 Mr. Frost. Between 2013 and 2019, the Gates Foundation was provided \$8 million in grants
20 to the International Peace Institute. Was Epstein involved with these funds at all?

21 Mr. Gates. The only connection between Epstein and that grantee, who did very important
22 work for us in our polio eradication campaign, was that when I was in Strasbourg and Epstein was
23 there at the same time, on that day, the chairman of IPI made a presentation to me. We can pull up
24 what that day is. And it was subsequent to that that the polio team investigated whether IPI could
25 provide valuable help -- yeah, Strasbourg is March 27, 2013. And the foundation developed a

1 relationship working with IPI that extended until -- I think it's ongoing, as far as I know. And that
2 work has been helpful.

3 But other than that one time, I wasn't aware of Epstein having any connection. Now that we
4 see the emails that have come out, Epstein was exchanging email with the chairman of IPI on a
5 number of occasions, but I was not aware of any connection to Epstein other than that first
6 introduction.

7 Mr. Frost. Vanity Fair reported that IPI staff included Epstein on updates about its work with
8 the Gates Foundation, including intelligence about Pakistani Taliban, polio outbreaks, and the
9 existence of chemical weapons in Syria. Why was Epstein privy to that information?

10 Mr. Gates. Really doesn't make any sense to me, but the chairman of IPI, Terje Rod-Larsen,
11 forwarded a number of emails to Epstein. I only know that now because we see that in the January
12 release of emails. And, you know, the -- doing polio eradication in Pakistan and Afghanistan is very
13 complex. IPI had some very good people who helped us there, but Epstein would have had no
14 expertise in that, so I don't understand why the chairman of IPI forwarded those emails.

1 [2:50 p.m.]

2 Mr. Frost. Thank you.

3 Mr. Bell. Good evening, Mr. Gates. Wesley Bell, Missouri's 1st District. I'm going to
4 introduce what has been labeled as minority exhibit M, which is a photo of you, Mr. Epstein, Boris
5 Nikolic, Jes Staley, and Larry Summers. Is that correct?

6 Mr. Gates. Yes.

7 Mr. Bell. And when was this photo taken?

8 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I can give you the date. There it is. No, no, you just went by it.

9 Mr. Moran. No, this is a different one.

10 Mr. Gates. This is a different one?

11 Mr. Moran. Than the one that we just -- than what you just one --

12 Mr. Gates. Okay. But it's on the same night. I mean, there's only one night that these
13 five people are in the same location, so if you'd just tell me that date.

14 Mr. Moran. May 2nd, 2011.

15 Mr. Gates. This is a dinner at Epstein's New York residence on May 2nd, 2011.

16 Mr. Bell. I would like to go piecemeal. So this was May 2nd, and what year?

17 Mr. Gates. 2011.

18 Mr. Bell. 2011? And where was this photo taken?

19 Mr. Gates. This was at Epstein's New York residence.

20 Mr. Bell. And this was a gathering of some sort?

21 Mr. Gates. There was a dinner that all five, and only the five people you see here, had
22 dinner together. And I believe this was after the dinner.

23 Mr. Bell. And what was the purpose of the dinner?

24 Mr. Gates. Yeah, this is the second time that I meet Epstein, and I'm in New York for other
25 things, and we had a dinner. I would say the discussion was pretty broad-ranging with Dr. Summers

1 talking about the economy and a variety of things, Jes Staley talking about his -- a few of the
2 economy things going on, and in all of these meetings, I would have brought up the Foundation work
3 I was doing.

4 Mr. Bell. Okay. But the meeting, the dinner, the purpose of it, what was the original
5 purpose of the meeting?

6 Mr. Gates. You know, this is the second time I meet Epstein, so this idea of going after
7 donors, that really doesn't -- it may have been mentioned casually, but it's not until 2013 that there's
8 any real engagement on that, so it may have come up.

9 You know, I, at the time, thought having a chance to listen to Dr. Summers and Mr. Staley
10 would be educational to me, and I was there for other reasons, and this fit into my schedule, so this
11 was the second time that I saw Mr. Epstein. I saw him one more time that year where he dropped
12 by my office and that, you know, that's the three meetings in 2011. And then a year goes by, and in
13 the fall of 2012, there's two meetings. And then you have to get out into 2013 before there's any
14 additional meetings.

15 Mr. Bell. And just to be clear, other than the economy, or economic discussions, what else
16 was discussed?

17 Mr. Gates. You know, news of the day, where the Foundation was succeeding, what was
18 challenging for the Foundation. Dr. Summers, you know, worked at the World Bank and had been
19 part of a book that was very influential to me called the World Development Report in 1993, which
20 went through why children under five die and broke it down, and that piece of work that he was the
21 head of the project doing that, had a substantial impact on me. And I remember bringing up to him
22 that that influenced my decision to devote philanthropic resources to saving children's lives.

23 Mr. Bell. So at that time you did know Jes Staley?

24 Mr. Gates. No, this is the first time and the last time I ever met Jes Staley. I knew of Jes
25 Staley as a very senior J.P. Morgan officer.

1 Mr. Bell. Did you know Larry Summers?

2 Mr. Gates. I knew a lot about Larry Summers. I'm trying to think if I had met him in person
3 before this dinner. I had never had a dinner with Larry Summers. I may have met him, but this
4 was my first extended conversation with him.

5 Mr. Bell. And Mr. Gates, who else was at this gathering?

6 Mr. Gates. Dr. Nikolic and Mr. Epstein.

7 Mr. Bell. Just the people in this photo?

8 Mr. Gates. Yeah, the dinner was with exactly the five people you see in this photo.

9 Apparently, there's multiple versions of this photo, but --

10 Mr. Bell. So who took the photo?

11 Mr. Gates. Good question. It's clearly not a selfie.

12 Mr. Moran. You don't remember?

13 Mr. Gates. I don't remember. Maybe the cook, maybe an assistant. I'm not sure.

14 Mr. Bell. And then last question, were there any young women present on that occasion?

15 Mr. Gates. None.

16 Mr. Bell. I yield back.

17 Mr. Subramanyam. Thank you, again, for being here. I haven't been here the whole time,
18 so -- today is a busy day, so I apologize if any of the questions I ask you have already been asked, but I
19 will do my best. But I think earlier -- so you've been mentioning that the purpose of knowing
20 Mr. Epstein was he would introduce you to folks who could contribute to the Gates Foundation, and I
21 was just wondering if you could kind of rattle off some of the people he introduced you to? I think I
22 heard Leon Black and Josh Harris and Mort Zuckerman, maybe Tom Pritzker. Is there anyone else
23 he introduced you to for the purpose of supporting the Gates Foundation?

24 Mr. Gates. Well, two things: First, the contributions to Global Health would not have
25 come to the Gates Foundation.

1 Mr. Subramanyam. I see.

2 Mr. Gates. They would have gone to things like the Global Alliance for Vaccines, or the
3 Global Fund, the other endeavors to help Global Health, but not to the Gates Foundation.

4 Mr. Subramanyam. Thank you.

5 Mr. Gates. Secondly, Epstein was pretty vague about specific names for a long time, and
6 that was frustrating to me. And particularly after dinner in fall of 2013 that my ex-wife Melinda
7 came to, she had a very negative reaction to Mr. Epstein and was saying, Look, you know, either get
8 these donations, you know, maybe you should just cut it off now, showing better judgment than I
9 showed, or, you know, make this concrete, and I chose to continue in pursuing it. But then I was
10 very hardcore, Jeffrey, okay, who are these people? Let's meet with them. And there's a lot of
11 delay, but eventually that results in the September 2014 meeting -- is it September -- 2014 meeting
12 where finally for the first time, this is Epstein showing who he thinks might do this, you know,
13 different from his broad illusions to lots of Wall Street billionaires, lots of Middle East billionaires, you
14 know, he had me meet with people who, as I said, were friendly, but didn't fit, that as they were not,
15 in any near term, going to give substantial resources to Global Health activities.

16 Mr. Subramanyam. I apologize. Who are those people again?

17 Mr. Gates. The people I met that day were Leon Black. I don't know if we were scheduled
18 to see Josh Harris, or if he was just in the office there and that was impromptu, but we saw him,
19 Mark Zuckerberg, Tom Pritzker, and that's all.

20 Mr. Subramanyam. Did he ever bring up Les Wexner?

21 Mr. Gates. Ever bring up?

22 Mr. Subramanyam. Les Wexner as someone who would --

23 Mr. Gates. No, that name never came up.

24 Mr. Subramanyam. Okay. And there was one name, one email, and I apologize, I don't
25 have copies of it, I can even give it to you, but there's an email on September 16th, 2013, saying, Did

1 JE want to meet to follow up with, and then redacted, and see if her, redacted, would like to come
2 join JE's meeting with Barak slash Bill Gates. I don't know if this email --

3 Mr. Gates. I should take a look at that.

4 Mr. Subramanyam. Yes. I'll give you a copy.

5 Mr. Gates. I don't remember it.

6 Mr. Subramanyam. You weren't on the email, I believe. But I guess I want to know who
7 Barak is because Barak seems to -- there are a lot of Baraks. It could be Ehud Barak. It could be
8 Barack Obama.

9 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I never met any Baraks in connection with Epstein. There were no Baraks
10 whose names were mentioned, or that I met with.

11 Mr. Subramanyam. Okay. Thank you. And did he, Epstein, ever have you sign an NDA at
12 any point, or have anyone sign an NDA?

13 Mr. Gates. No, I never signed anything in connection with Epstein.

14 Mr. Subramanyam. And did you have him sign an NDA, or anyone else sign an NDA at any
15 point?

16 Mr. Gates. Not Mr. Epstein. I think I mentioned earlier that it may be that when
17 somebody comes into either Gates Ventures employ, or the Foundation they do, but I'm not familiar
18 with what the specific practices are.

19 Mr. Subramanyam. And then did you do any sort of background check on him?

20 Mr. Gates. On whom?

21 Mr. Subramanyam. On Jeffrey Epstein?

22 Mr. Gates. I wish I had done more, but I did enough to know -- did do enough to know that
23 he had been criminally convicted in 2008, or 2009, of a sexually-related offense.

24 Mr. Subramanyam. And since the experience with him, do you do more thorough
25 background checks now?

1 Mr. Gates. Absolutely.

2 Mr. Subramanyam. Okay. Thank you. That's all I have.

3 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Thank you, Mr. Gates. I'm Congressman Raja Krishnamoorthi from
4 Illinois. Did Jeffrey Epstein ever reference a foreign intelligence agency to you?

5 Mr. Gates. He did not.

6 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Did you ever have any evidence, or see any evidence that he might
7 have been a foreign asset?

8 Mr. Gates. I did not.

9 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Did he ever make any threats to you about revealing any particular
10 piece of information about you or your family or your background?

11 Mr. Gates. Well, I viewed the attempt to have me reimburse him for the things he
12 purportedly paid for for the bridge player, I viewed that as taking a step beyond the veiled comments
13 he made during Dr. Nikolic's exit. You know, at that point, although it's kind of trivial sum of
14 money, I thought that, you know, was moving further down the line into being threatening, although,
15 you know, the way he phrased it was this is just a reimbursement for something I did, even going so
16 far as to pretend that I had somehow encouraged him to do so, which is completely false.

17 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. And how much money was that, again, that he asked you to pay back?

18 Mr. Gates. I won't remember the amounts, but it's, you know, thousands of dollars, not
19 tens of thousands of dollars.

20 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Okay. Besides that, did he ever ask you for any other money?

21 Mr. Gates. No. I never paid him. I made it clear he would not be paid, and never paid
22 him.

23 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Okay. In your discussions with any other world leaders, or any other
24 dignitaries, has anybody else referenced Jeffrey Epstein in the context of him having made any
25 threats to them, or comments to the effect that he may be an intelligence asset?

1 Mr. Gates. No mention of Jeffrey Epstein has ever come up in any discussion with the World
2 leaders that I've ever had.

3 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Forbes -- I'm sorry. Wall Street Journal reported that Warren Buffett
4 stopped giving to the Gates Foundation, in part because of the Epstein situation. And in March of
5 this year, he told CNBC that he's going to make his decision in June of this year, so this month, as to
6 whether he's going to give more to the Gates Foundation based on what else he sees with the
7 Epstein files.

8 What did he tell you gives him cause for concern with regard to your relationship with Jeffrey
9 Epstein?

10 Mr. Gates. The last time I talked to Warren directly was in January, where we didn't talk
11 about this. I think it was prior to the release of the Epstein files. We talked about my health
12 challenges and some other things. I'm sure, you know, he's looking at the press. I don't think he
13 has any knowledge other than what he's reading in the press.

14 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. In an interview with Emily Kirkpatrick, your ex-wife, Melinda, said that
15 when she first met Jeffrey Epstein -- I'm sorry. This is an interview with Gayle King of CBS this
16 morning, she said, I regretted meeting Jeffrey Epstein the second I walked in the door. He was
17 abhorrent. He was evil personified. What does she say to you about that first meeting that led
18 her to believe that he was evil personified?

19 Mr. Gates. Yeah, so I believe her only meeting with Mr. Epstein was the dinner that I
20 described that she came to, and she definitely had a very negative impression of him.

21 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Why?

22 Mr. Gates. Her instinct about arrogant men, or I'm not sure what, but she certainly showed
23 better judgment than I did.

24 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. We have in our notes that you met with Jeffrey Epstein 10 times. At
25 least 10 times. What is the number that you -- what is the number of times that you believe that

1 you met with Jeffrey Epstein?

2 Mr. Gates. You know, I think it depends on whether you count Skype calls, or the one time
3 he dropped by my office. You know, there was a dinner, a TED dinner that we both attended, but I
4 didn't talk to him then. You know, I think it's like 12 to 14 times, plus two Skype calls in total over
5 the 4-year period.

6 Mr. Krishnamoorthi. Okay. Thank you very much.

7 Ms. Randall. Thank you, Mr. Gates. I'm Emily Randall from Washington's 6th. I
8 appreciate you being here and answering our questions. And I want to follow up a little bit on a
9 question that Ranking Member Garcia asked to begin with about who the men were in Mr. Epstein's
10 orbit that you may have seen or engaged with in any of these meetings. And you said, you know,
11 that you didn't see anyone engaging in illegal or illicit activities, and you didn't want to cast
12 aspersions of any of these men, which I understand. But I think some of what we've seen in our
13 investigative work and in conversations and in the files is that, you know, it became very easy for a
14 lot of people to say that they didn't see anything, and that's part of how he continued to have such a
15 long history of abuse.

16 And so, I just would like to ask if there are other names of people that you haven't mentioned
17 yet. You mentioned Dr. Nikolic, Larry Summers, Jes Staley, Leon Black, Josh Harris, Mark
18 Zuckerberg, Tom Pritzker. Were there other men that were involved, maybe not necessarily men
19 that he was trying to introduce into the Global Healthwork, but folks in any of these meetings that
20 we should ask follow-up questions on, not saying that you're accusing them of anything, but to make
21 sure that we're uncovering every stone in this work to find transparency and justice?

22 Mr. Gates. Yeah, I believe that today I mentioned the name of every single individual who
23 was in a meeting with myself and Epstein. And, you know, beyond that, you know, all these emails
24 released in January have other names in there, I don't bring any personal knowledge to that. But,
25 you know, I'm here to help in any way I can. I can't think of anyone whose name I haven't

1 mentioned that I knew had some relationship with Mr. Epstein.

2 Ms. Randall. Thank you. And, you know, Ms. Stansbury asked about the women, young
3 women who worked for Mr. Epstein, and we've all established that some of these women who were
4 employed by him were also being trafficked and abused, whether, you know, though that may not
5 have been your knowledge at the time, I understand.

6 I do want to ask, because of my conversations with some survivors who were underage when
7 they were pulled into Mr. Epstein's world, they have relayed to us that no one ever, Mr. Epstein
8 knew how old they were, but, you know, no one in the room at parties, at events, at meetings ever
9 asked how old they were. They assumed they were adults because they looked like adults. A
10 17-year-old young women, you know, is not always spottable as a 17-year-old young woman. Just
11 thinking about any women who were in any of these meetings, who were working at Mr. Epstein's
12 home, who were engaged in any coordination, can you think of, you know, any young women who
13 we should talk to?

14 Mr. Gates. No. The only thing I did with Epstein that was of a casual entertainment nature
15 was when he had David Blaine come over after we had had a dinner meeting. And as I've said, and
16 you've seen in photographs, there were two of the women around Epstein who were standing
17 around during the David Blaine performance. But, you know, you've heard from me everything I
18 know about the women around Epstein. And I'm very sorry to hear some of them were victims.

19 Ms. Randall. Thank you so much for your answers, and for joining us, Mr. Gates.

20 BY MR. [REDACTED]

21 Q Mr. Gates, did you ever meet Ghislaine Maxwell?

22 A I met her one time. I was at a hotel restaurant, and she and Ted Waitt were there, and
23 that was the one time I was introduced to her.

24 Q When was that?

25 A It's a good question. She clearly had left her time with Epstein and was with Ted Waitt.

1 Ted Waitt is someone I knew fairly well because he created a company called Gateway that was in
2 the personal computer business. But, you know, it was just a few-minute introduction because we
3 happened to be in the same place. But other than that, I've never met her.

4 Q And that was simply an introduction rather than a substantive conversation?

5 A Not a substantive conversation, no.

6 Q And was this during the period of your relationship with Jeffrey Epstein, or after?

7 A No, I think it was after, but we would have to dig out the date.

8 Q And did Ms. Maxwell ever come up in conversation with Jeffrey Epstein?

9 A Never.

10 Q Did she ever come up in conversation with Melanie Walker?

11 A Never.

12 Q Okay.

13 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

14 Q Mr. Gates, a few minutes ago, in response to Mr. Krishnamoorthi's questions you
15 mentioned there were two Skype calls. Is that right?

16 A Two?

17 Q Skype calls.

18 A Right.

19 Q And I think we discussed one earlier which occurred on February 27th, 2014. Is that
20 right?

21 A Well, we inadvertently discussed it.

22 Q Sure.

23 A Because there was a question about a February 27th, 2013 thing, and I accidentally saw
24 February 27th and said, oh, that meeting was a Skype call. The February 27th, 2013 meeting is an
25 in-person meeting in New York, and the February 27th, 2013 meeting is a Skype call.

1 Q Understood. And when was the second Skype call?

2 A The second Skype call is May 21st, 2014.

3 Q And what was the purpose of that call?

4 A You know, everything in this time frame is focusing on who are these donors? Is this
5 thing going to be real? And so right after that second Skype call is when he suggests the names of
6 people that we end up meeting in September, which is the second to last meeting I had with Epstein.

7 Q And do you recall the exact discussions of that call with Mr. Epstein?

8 A I do not.

9 Q Was anyone else on that call?

10 A Larry Cohen may have come for some part of that call.

11 [Discussion off the record.]

12 Mr. Gates. Yeah, my notes show Larry as being on the first of the two Skype calls, but not on
13 the second Skype call.

14 BY MR. [REDACTED]:

15 Q Not on the second one. And I have in my notes, and I could have this incorrect, but I
16 believe you testified earlier that it was -- the first Skype call was just you and Mr. Epstein. That is
17 not true?

18 A No. The first Skype call, Larry Cohen is part of that.

19 Q Understood. And who was on the second Skype call?

20 A It looks like just myself and Epstein.

21 Q Just you and Epstein. Okay. Why was this conducted over Skype?

22 A Because we weren't in the same physical location.

23 Q Why the Skype platform?

24 A Microsoft owns Skype.

25 Q Did you suggest Skype?

1 A I mean, I'm capable of using probably seven different video calling platforms. I don't
2 think there's any unique features of Skype that caused it to be used. You know, subsequently I've
3 shifted 90 percent of my use to Teams, and perhaps 10 percent to Zoom. So this may have indeed,
4 the second meeting may have been my final Skype call.

5 Q Understood. And I guess the reason I'm asking is because Jeffrey Epstein does have a
6 demonstrated history of using Skype, and so my question to you is, did he recommend that this
7 meeting be conducted on Skype?

8 A I don't know.

9 Q Okay.

10 Mr. [REDACTED]. We can go off the record.

11 BY MR. SPECTRE:

12 Q We can go back on the record. Mr. Gates, we've briefly discussed your
13 relationship -- or your one interaction that you recall with Ghislaine Maxwell during the last hour.
14 Just to be clear, that's the only interaction with her that you recall?

15 A The only time I've ever met her, yes.

16 Q She did tell the Department of Justice in the interview that she did with them last
17 summer that she met you, it sounds like briefly, at a TED conference. Do you have any recollection
18 of that?

19 A Yeah, there was a TED dinner with about 40 or 50 people, and she was an attendee
20 there. I don't know if I shook her hand, but I didn't have a conversation with her.

21 Q But you recall that she was there in general?

22 A I think she attended a dinner around the TED conference. Yes.

23 Q Do you recall any other, I'll call them interactions, but any other times you were in the
24 same place as Ghislaine Maxwell other than the meeting with Ted Waitt, the brief meeting with Ted
25 Waitt, and this very brief meeting at a dinner at a TED conference?

1 A As I say, on the TED thing, I don't know that I shook her hand. I'm not sure. But I
2 didn't have a conversation with her. Other than those two times, no, I never met her.

3 BY MR. EMMER:

4 Q Mr. Gates, we're at a point in our questioning where unfortunately I do have to make
5 you repeat yourself just to make sure the record is crystal clear. During the first hour, I believe you
6 had mentioned that at some point you were invited to visit Mr. Epstein's island. Is that right?

7 A Yes, several times he issued an invitation.

8 Q And approximately when were you extended those invites?

9 A We can go dig through the emails. I don't know the timing.

10 Q And he himself directly invited you. Is that right?

11 A That's right.

12 Q And you rejected those invites?

13 A That's correct.

14 Q Right? And as far as his other properties go, you've testified numerous times to have
15 had dinners at his Manhattan townhouse. Is that right?

16 A That's right.

17 Q Have you ever visited his Paris apartment?

18 A Yeah, I talked about the one meeting I had there.

19 Q What about Zorro Ranch in New Mexico?

20 A Never went there.

21 Q The Palm Beach home?

22 A Never went there.

23 Q Any other properties owned by Mr. Epstein?

24 A No. It was, as you said, several meetings at his New York residence, and the one
25 meeting in Paris, and then the one time we flew together on a plane from New York to Palm Beach.

1 Q So let's talk briefly about the Manhattan townhome. Did you notice anything unusual
2 during your visits there?

3 A Well, I never went above the first floor. You know, there's kind of a fancy door, and
4 then you go up some stairs, and to the left is the room where we had dinners and most of the
5 meetings, and then to the right is a large area I think he called his office area, and then there's a
6 bathroom on that floor. That's what I remember about his residence.

7 Q And there's been allegations that Epstein had cameras that he would use to blackmail
8 visitors. Did you notice any cameras when you visited those --

9 A I did not.

10 Q During the committee's review of documents produced by the estate, as well as photos
11 that had been released as part of the Epstein Files Transparency Act, this is my own characterization,
12 but it seems that Mr. Epstein had an unusual creepy taste in artwork. Did you notice any unusual or
13 weird artwork when you visited his town home?

14 A I know there was one thing he had that was a bit strange. Was it liking Bill Clinton in a
15 dress? There was one thing that it was like Bill Clinton in a dress, I think, which I think that fits your
16 description.

17 Q Did you ask him about that specific portrait?

18 A I did not.

19 Q And to be clear, did you notice any nude photos displayed at his property?

20 A No. I mean, the only two properties I ever saw were the New York and the Paris one,
21 and I did not see nude photos in either location.

22 Q And back to the photo of Bill Clinton, where was that?

23 A I don't think it was a photo, honestly.

24 Q Or the painting. Excuse me.

25 A Yeah, the artwork. That was on the wall in his office.

1 Q Now, you mentioned that you visited the property in Paris as well. Did you notice
2 anything unusual when you visited that property?

3 A I did not.

4 Q A couple weeks ago the committee interviewed Sarah Kellen, a survivor, and she had
5 mentioned that Mr. Epstein had a painting or a photo or a naked photo of her displayed at that
6 property. You did not see any photo of Ms. Kellen. Is that right?

7 A No. You know, I don't know the extent of that property. We went into this one
8 room, or we sat and the excess food was brought to us there, but we didn't go to other rooms.

9 BY MR. SPECTRE:

10 Q Thank you. Mr. Gates, you already testified in the last hour you gave no financial
11 payments, you had no financial arrangement or payments with Jeffrey Epstein. Is that right?

12 A That's right.

13 Q I just want to clarify a little bit using a document, so I'll enter as majority exhibit 5 a
14 contract from the Epstein-owned entity, Southern Trust Company Inc. dated May 28th, 2013. This
15 is from the DOJ release, and it's marked with Bates number EFTA01111961.

16 [Gates Majority Exhibit No. 5
17 was marked for identification.]

18 BY MR. SPECTRE:

19 Q I'll give you a moment to look at it. It seems to be a contract of some kind for
20 consulting services.

21 A Between who and who?

22 Q So -- yes. If you direct your attention to the second block of texts, the second or third
23 line up from the bottom it says in (d), "Bill Gates and affiliated trusts, partnerships, limited
24 partnerships, and limited liability companies of, and any other entities affiliated with Mr. Gates," and
25 then it says collectively clients because it lists a collection of clients. Do you have any knowledge of

1 whether you were a client of any kind of the Southern Trust Company Inc.?

2 A I was not.

3 Q Have you ever heard of the Southern Trust Company Inc.?

4 A I believe this document was shown to me as part of the Epstein files as one of the
5 documents that my name came up in a dishonest and misleading way.

6 Q So that's your characterization is that this is a dishonest and misleading, you know,
7 mention of you as a client?

8 A That might be a little strong because it doesn't actually say I was a client, but it suggests
9 that I might be one of the clients, and I was never a client in any way of Mr. Epstein, or any of his
10 entities, including this thing that I don't know much about called Southern Trust Company.

11 Q Thank you.

12 Mr. Moran. Sorry, just for my records, that was marked 5.

13 Mr. Grant. Yes, sir.

14 Mr. Moran. Thank you.

15 Mr. Emmer. And prior to reviewing this document, had you ever come to learn during the
16 course of knowing Mr. Epstein that he was representing himself to have you as a client?

17 Mr. Gates. I didn't know that he would represent that, and it would have been a falsehood.

18 Mr. Emmer. Thank you.

19 BY MR. GRANT:

20 Q Mr. Gates, it seems through the course of reviewing documents, and as part of this
21 interview with you here today, that there were more than a few people either associated with
22 yourself and some of your ventures, or Microsoft generally, that also had relationships with Mr.
23 Epstein. At the time, were you aware of all of these associates of yours having relationships of
24 some kind with Mr. Epstein?

25 A Well, I'll mention the three, and then you can tell me if there's more that you are

1 referring to. I thought Mr. Nikolic had a very limited relationship with Mr. Epstein in terms of
2 facilitating meetings that I had with him, you know, the emails show a more extensive relationship.
3 I thought Dr. Walker knew Epstein, and he mentioned her to me one time in our first dinner meeting,
4 and then she sent me an email asking about that meeting.

5 Subsequently I don't think we communicated about Epstein, although apparently there's
6 some possibility of an August 2014 email that I'll -- maybe that's an exception. I'll have to track that
7 down. So the extent of her relationship with Mr. Epstein I didn't know. I think another name that
8 came up was Steven Sinofsky, and I did not know of him having any relationship with Mr. Epstein.

9 Q And what about Mr. Myhrvold? I know he was brought up at some point in an earlier
10 hour here today.

11 A No, I never discussed Mr. Epstein with Mr. Myhrvold.

12 Q And you had no awareness of them having any type of relationship at all at the time?

13 A I know when the Epstein files came out there was some things related to Mr. Myhrvold
14 having some relationship with Mr. Epstein. But before that, I had a vague awareness of some
15 connection, and I don't know where that came from, but we never discussed it.

16 Q And what about Mr. Reid Hoffmann, were you aware of him having a relationship with
17 Mr. Epstein?

18 A I think I did know that through some MIT connection, but I'm not sure that Mr.
19 Hoffmann had met Mr. Epstein. But I was never -- other than -- actually, there is a December
20 breakfast, the final meeting with Epstein where I'm presenting to a group of people about
21 philanthropy and global health, Mr. Hoffmann attended that, and so did Mr. Epstein. So that's the
22 one case where Mr. Hoffmann and Mr. Epstein and I were all together in the same place.

23 Q And did you ever discuss Mr. Epstein with Mr. Hoffmann, other than this one meeting
24 you just mentioned?

25 A It might have come up that, you know, I talked to Mr. Hoffmann about a lot of things,

1 but the fact that he was kind of an unknown, but a person with a bad reputation, that may have
2 come up in one of my conversations with Mr. Hoffmann.

3 Q And Mr. Cohen's, I'll call it a relationship with Mr. Epstein, is that due to his own accord,
4 or is that because of his close proximity to you?

5 A Yeah, I wouldn't call it a relationship. I mean, on my behalf he was involved,
6 particularly in the Dr. Nikolic exit discussions, but I wouldn't call that a relationship.

7 Q Fair enough. And did Mr. Epstein ever ask you to hire someone to either Microsoft, or
8 any of your other ventures?

9 A Never.

10 Q Are you aware of anyone at Microsoft, or any of your other ventures, giving any type of
11 inside investment information?

12 A No.

13 Q Did Mr. Epstein ever ask you for any type of inside investment information to your
14 companies or ventures?

15 A No.

16 Q Did you ever discuss any stocks or trades, or anything related to financial markets with
17 Mr. Epstein?

18 A No.

19 Q Did you ever --

20 A Well, let me amend that. I mean, the general idea of were markets going up or going
21 down, that came up in some discussions, but not any specific company and what was going to
22 happen with its stock.

23 Q So Mr. Epstein wouldn't have a conversation with you, then, about a particular
24 company, say, Tesla, and say you should short this stock, or buy this stock?

25 A No.

1 BY MR. SPECTRE:

2 Q Just one quick question for the last couple of sections here. Did any law enforcement
3 entity of any kind ever approach you or ask you for information about Jeffrey Epstein or Ghislaine
4 Maxwell?

5 A Yeah. I think my lawyers can probably do a better job on this than I can, but I think the
6 U.S. Virgin Islands conducted a voluntary interview with me.

7 Mr. Clare. Yeah. If I could just clarify. The Attorney General of the U.S. Virgin Islands
8 made an informal request to Mr. Gates to cooperate with its investigation. Very much like he did
9 here, Mr. Gates cooperated voluntarily, we turned over some documents to the Attorney General,
10 and Mr. Gates sat for a voluntary proffer with the representatives of the U.S. Virgin Islands.

11 Mr. Spectre. What sorts of documents did the Virgin Islands request?

12 Mr. Clare. They, from recollection, they related mostly to financial documents. It was in
13 connection with a, you know, tax questions primarily, and it related to J.P. Morgan Chase and some
14 banking issues. So it was primarily focused on that.

15 Mr. Spectre. Okay. Thank you.

16 BY MR. GRANT:

17 Q And just so the record is clear, no one from the Southern District of New York ever
18 reached out to you during Mr. Epstein's troubles when he was arrested subsequently in 2019?

19 A No.

20 Q And same question for Ms. Ghislaine Maxwell during her arrest in 2021, I believe it was?

21 A No.

22 Q Thank you.

23 BY MR. SPECTRE:

24 Q Mr. Gates, we do this sort of format in some of our interviews. I'm going to read you a
25 long list of names, the question is the same for each person.

1 A Okay.

2 Q It's simply, have you ever communicated with that person regarding Jeffrey Epstein or
3 Ghislaine Maxwell. And there may be some repetition. I'll try to cut out the ones that we've
4 already talked about for the most part, but -- so the first one, Richard Khan?

5 A No, I never communicated with him.

6 Q Darren Indyke?

7 A Never communicated with him.

8 Q Lesley Groff?

9 A I don't believe so. I mean, she might have been on some email chain, but I don't think I
10 communicated with her.

11 Q Sarah Kellen?

12 A Again, she might have been on some email chain, but I never communicated with
13 her -- or, I don't know, maybe she's one of the women I wasn't introduced to in photos. I'm not
14 sure.

15 Q When you say that Ms. Groff and Ms. Kellen may have been on an email chain, do you
16 mean an email chain along with Mr. Epstein?

17 A Yes.

18 Q Next person, Doug Band?

19 A No.

20 Q Larry Summers?

21 A Yes. As I've discussed, Dr. Summers came to a dinner, which is the second time I met
22 Epstein. And other than that, no.

23 Q Have you ever discussed the -- have you ever discussed Jeffrey Epstein's crimes or
24 allegations against Jeffrey Epstein with Larry Summers?

25 A No.

1 Q Noam Chomsky?

2 A No, I never met Noam Chomsky. I know his work very well. I think he's fairly old
3 now. But I've never met him, or talked to him.

4 Q [REDACTED]?

5 A I don't recognize that name, so, no.

6 Q Alan Dershowitz?

7 A No.

8 Q George Mitchell?

9 A No.

10 Q Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor, formerly Prince Andrew?

11 A Yeah, I never -- nothing connected to Epstein. I encountered him two times in official
12 visits in the U.K. where he was serving as something like the trade representative.

13 Q But never about Jeffrey Epstein?

14 A Never about Jeffrey Epstein.

15 Q Okay.

16 A Weirdly in the set of photos that I guess Epstein kept, there is a photo of me and Prince
17 Andrew at one of those official State meetings. But nothing in connection with Epstein, even
18 though Epstein seemed to have that picture and it shows up in the Epstein files.

19 Q That's right. Do you recall if Jeffrey Epstein was also in attendance at that State
20 dinner?

21 A Never.

22 Q He definitely wasn't in attendance there?

23 A No, no, I never saw him in the U.K., and those were both meetings in the U.K.

24 Q Thank you. Peter Mandelson?

25 A No.

1 Q Karyna Shuliak?

2 A I don't know. Is that one of the assistants?

3 Q She is reported to have dated Mr. Epstein. It's just if you recall having a conversation
4 with these people about Jeffrey Epstein, or Ghislaine Maxwell.

5 A The only time I recall that meeting was earlier today someone sitting on that side of the
6 table said that a person that I couldn't identify in a photo had that name.

7 Q But you don't recall the specifics of any conversation with her if you had one?

8 A No. Apparently, though, I was photographed with her. I think somebody
9 represented that here today.

10 Q Thank you. Ehud Barak?

11 A No.

12 Q Paul Morris?

13 A Yeah, I don't recognize that name.

14 Q Sultan Ahmed bin Sulayem?

15 A No.

16 Q Leslie Wexner?

17 A No.

18 Q Harvey Weinstein?

19 A No.

20 Q Any member of the Rothschild's family?

21 A No. It's a lot of people, but still no.

22 Q There are several names I can read if you would like.

23 A No, no, please.

24 Q Casey Wassermann?

25 A No.

1 Q Stacey Plaskett?

2 A I don't know who that is.

3 Q Howard Lutnick?

4 A No.

5 Q Steve Bannon?

6 A No.

7 Q Elon Musk?

8 A No.

9 Q Abigail Johnson?

10 A No.

11 Q Jeff Bezos?

12 A No.

13 Q Larry Page?

14 A Nope.

15 Q Sergey Brin?

16 A No.

17 Q President Bill Clinton?

18 A No.

19 Q Secretary Hillary Clinton?

20 A No.

21 Q I don't think I said, other than the one meeting where Ted Waitt was with Ghislaine
22 Maxwell, have you ever discussed Jeffrey Epstein or Ghislaine Maxwell with Ted Waitt?

23 A No.

24 Q Mr. Gates, just a couple of final questions for you. So your relationship -- can you
25 remind us, for the record, when your relationship with Mr. Epstein formally -- when you cut off ties

1 with Mr. Epstein, other than his couple of reachouts?

2 A After the December meeting in 2014.

3 Q And during the last hour you discussed a little bit about the final few meetings or
4 discussions with regard to the donor-advised funds with Mr. Epstein. That was in 2014. Is that
5 right?

6 A That's right.

7 Q I'm just trying to understand, after the summer of 2013, and all of the various emails we
8 discussed, again, acknowledging some of them you didn't know about at the time, but, regardless,
9 the interactions you had with Mr. Epstein where he was making veiled threats about personal issues,
10 including your affairs, why did you continue to engage with Mr. Epstein about philanthropy going
11 into 2014?

12 A Well, the Dr. Nikolic exit, you know, ended up exactly as it started with something that I
13 felt was fair, and Dr. Nikolic ended up deciding was fair. And so that was kind of a weird thing, and I
14 admit it should have added to the many negative things about Mr. Epstein. And then in the fall, I
15 have the dinner where my ex-wife took her already somewhat negative view of Mr. Epstein and felt
16 after she had met him in person that one time, she had an even more negative view of him.

17 You know, there were a lot of things saying that, you know, the risk of, even in this very
18 limited role, which was referring me to people, not being paid, not playing any role, that I should
19 have had better judgment to cut it off. And I would say I was a bit stubborn in thinking, Hey, was
20 this completely a dead end, and so I continued through 2014 to try and get meetings with actual
21 donors. And then in September I got that, then there's one more breakfast where I presented
22 philanthropic opportunities, and only then did I completely abandon any connection with him.

23 Q And did you formally tell him at this point that you didn't wish to see or speak with him
24 anymore?

25 A I think my final email to him says, Hey, the raising money isn't going to work. And so

1 because that was clearly the thing I had focused time on, that was clearly the end of the relationship.
2 He continued to email me, and so through Larry Cohen, not in an email, because I sent that one final
3 email and that was it. But Mr. Cohen made it clear to Mr. Epstein that I had severed the
4 relationship completely and he wouldn't be seeing me or hearing from me.

5 Q And one final question for you, when we were discussing earlier about the two initial
6 extramarital affairs, and then we talked about a third one, one of the reasons you gave for those
7 being the only ones that are relevant to the committee's inquiry was because if Mr. Epstein had
8 anything else bad to say about you, any other damaging information about you, then he would have
9 written it elsewhere in his emails. Is that a fair characterization of what you said?

10 A Yeah, he managed to put in some true embarrassing things, specifically the affairs, and
11 then he managed to put in a lot of false things. And so, I think if he had known anything negative
12 about me it would have shown up in those. But that's all speculation based on what I've seen in
13 January of this year. You know, the foolishness of my spending time with him is about 100 times
14 higher after I see the January emails.

15 Q Okay. Thank you.

16 Chairman Comer. Mr. Gates, on behalf of the Oversight Committee, and the entire
17 Congress, I want to thank you for coming in today voluntarily. Thank you for answering all of our
18 questions. And I have to conclude by thanking you for your philanthropy and all the great
19 charitable work that you have done, and will hopefully continue to do. So thank you.

20 Mr. Gates. No, that will be the focus the rest of my life. And I don't know if anything I did
21 today is helpful in your quest, but I hope you can find justice for the victims.

22 Chairman Comer. Thank you.

23 Mr. Spectre. Thank you, sir. We can go off the record.

24 [Whereupon, at 3:43 p.m., the interview was concluded.]

Certificate of Deponent/Interviewee

I have read the foregoing ____ pages, which contain the correct transcript of the answers made by me to the questions therein recorded.

Witness Name

Date